MUMBAI/METRO
Saturday, October 17, 2026
VOL. XXII NO. 245

Hindust

PM likely to visit Canada in Dec, trade deal in focus

Anirudh Bhattacharyya and Rezaul H Laskar
letters@hindustantimes.com

TORONTO/NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi is set to visit Canada in December, people familiar with the matter said on Friday against the backdrop of fast-track negotiations for a trade deal that the two countries are hoping to conclude by the year-end.

Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney told a gathering of the Indo-Canadian community in Calgary on Thursday that Modi is expected to visit in mid-December. "He [Modi] is coming, I think it'll largely be to Ottawa and Toronto but we'll see if we can broaden it out. I know the dates are December 11 and 12," Carney said in an informal chat with community members.

The Indian high commission in Ottawa mentioned the same dates in a social media post regarding the visit, though the people, who spoke on condition of anonymity, said the finer details of the visit are yet to be locked down. The two sides are still engaged in talks to finalise the dates, they said.

When external affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal was asked about the dates for the visit at a regular media briefing, he said Modi's trip to Canada came up for discussion

continued on →14

PM Narendra Modi with Canada's Mark Carney in March 2026. The two leaders spoke on the phone on Tuesday, and agreed to build on the positive momentum in relations. ARVIND YADAV/HT

GOVT DEFENDS RUBIO, EAM MEET IN MUMBAI AMID OPPN CRITICISM

The Union government on Friday dismissed the Opposition's criticism of external affairs minister (EAM) S Jaishankar travelling to Mumbai to meet his US counterpart Marco Rubio next week by saying it has been the practice over the past decade for foreign dignitaries to be hosted outside New Delhi. →P11

'U.S. TEMPLE ATTACK PLOT HIGHLIGHTS RISE IN HATE CRIME AGAINST INDIANS'

The ministry of external affairs (MEA) on Friday said that the alleged mass shooting at a temple near Chicago highlighted "the increasing cases of hate crimes and racial discrimination against the Indian community" in the US as it called upon American authorities to ensure the "safety and well-being" of Indian nationals. →P11

PVT TEACHERS CAN NOW BE APPOINTED FOR CENSUS DUTY

NEW DELHI: The Union government on Friday, through a gazette notification, specified the categories of personnel who could be appointed as Census enumerators, explicitly including teachers from aided and unaided private educational institutions, societies and trusts, alongside those from local authority and government educational institutions.

The changes came in the backdrop of petitions filed in courts challenging the requisition and deployment of teaching staff from private schools for Census duty . →P11

SC STAYS TWISHA TRIAL IN BHOPAL OVER KIN'S PLEA TO SHIFT CASE TO DELHI

Abraham Thomas
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday stayed the trial in the Twisha Sharma death case on a plea by her father to transfer the proceedings from Bhopal to Delhi. In his plea, the father argued that there would not be a fair trial in Madhya Pradesh due to the influence wielded by the accused mother-in-law, a former judge in the state. →P7

WE WELCOME COMPETITION: RELIANCE AMID STARLINK ROW

NEW DELHI: Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL) on Friday said it does not fear competition and welcomes it in satellite communications sector, including from Elon Musk's Starlink, but asserted that every player must abide by Indian laws. The company issued a statement to "place the facts on record", its first direct response after a recent spate of public barbs by billionaire Elon Musk over competition in India's satellite communications market. →P14

{ INSPIRED BY DRISHYAM FILMS }

Class 12 duo murder classmate, take a cue from film to cover it up

Kaptan Mali
kaptan.mali@hindustantimes.com

THE VICTIM'S HALF-BURNT BODY WAS RECOVERED FROM BUSHES NEAR GHODBUNDER RD

THANE: Two Class 12 students allegedly murdered their 17-year-old schoolmate to steal his gold chain to fund a friend's birthday celebration and purchase a motorcycle. The minors were allegedly inspired by the thriller Drishyam 3 and attempted to mislead investigators and destroy evidence, police said.

The victim went missing on September 24 after leaving home at around 7 pm. Following his father's complaint, the Kasarvadavali police registered a kidnapping case. One accused allegedly claimed to have seen the teenager leaving on a white scooter with an unidentified person.

Mobile phone data and further questioning raised suspicions, leading one minor to allegedly confess. Police subsequently recovered the victim's half-burnt body from bushes near Ghodbunder Road.

Investigators said the accused lured him to an isolated location, stabbed him repeatedly, crushed his face with a stone and burned his body the following day. They also allegedly threw his broken phone onto a moving bus to mislead tracking efforts.

DCP Zone V Prashant Kadam said, "The minor accused had very sound knowledge of destroying evidence. They were very active on social media but weak in their studies. They conspired to commit the crime after watching the film Drishyam 3." →P5

CENTRE SEEKS PUNJAB REPORTS ON DRUG-LINKED KILLINGS, SUICIDE

Ravinder Vasudeva
letters@hindustantimes.com

CHANDIGARH: The Union home ministry on Friday sought reports from Punjab government on the deaths of three men who took on the drug trade, a development that was prefaced by Union home minister Amit Shah and CM Bhagwant Singh Mann trading blame over the issue earlier in the day. →P9

WOMAN, PARTNER GET DEATH FOR HER HUSBAND'S KILLING, STAGING SNAKEBITE

Deepak Lavania
letters@hindustantimes.com

MEERUT: A Meerut court on Friday sentenced a woman and her partner to death for murdering her husband and staging it as a snakebite, the second such sentence in the city this week after two people were sentenced to death in a similar murder case. →P9

Tesla Roadster unveiled with aerial tricks

Tesla has unveiled a redesigned Roadster powered with rocket-style thrusters and a suction system, and said it would start production in 2028. The electric sports car was shown jumping and flipping over Tesla's vehicle lineup and performing other aerial stunts. →P14 AFP

{ SWITCHING OVER }

Lost in translation: Hindi MBBS loses appeal as students switch to English

Shruti Tomar
letters@hindustantimes.com

85 STUDENTS HAVE CHOSEN HINDI OUT OF 1,000 WHO ENROLLED FOR MBBS AT BHOPAL'S GMC. OUT OF THESE, 65 HAVE SWITCHED TO ENGLISH

BHOPAL: Ankit Pandey, a final-year student at Bhopal's Gandhi Medical College (GMC), was among the 22 students who enrolled in the inaugural Hindi MBBS programme launched on October 16, 2022, as part of the Madhya Pradesh government's "ease of education" initiative.

He said they thought Hindi-medium school students like him had an easier path to becoming doctors. But the hybrid language use prompted them to switch to the English medium from the second year of the four-and-a-half-year-course or better long-term prospects. The National Eligibility cum Entrance Test (Postgraduate), NEET (PG), for admission to postgraduate medical programmes is held in English.

Pandey said the anatomy book and two others were translated into Hindi, but all the medical terms remained in English. "So, we decided to opt for English books as it would be better for our future," he said.

Other students pointed out that both English and Hindi-medium students were taught together. "When we have to learn in English, what is the use of getting Hindi textbooks?" asked Sandeep Puri, a first-year student.

In the end, every student in the inaugural Hindi MBBS batch in Madhya Pradesh took the

continued on →14

BKC'S CAR-FREE FRIDAY INITIATIVE FIZZLES OUT

Shashank Rao
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The MMRDA has quietly discontinued Public Transport Day in Bandra Kurla Complex (BKC) after the initiative received a poor response from commuters, many of whom continued using their private vehicles. Launched on June 12 to encourage people to switch to public transport every Friday, the initiative was implemented for just 12 Fridays before being shelved by the end of August.

Sources said the campaign failed to attract public participation. Transport experts attributed the initiative's failure to inadequate public transport infrastructure. →P4

Scoring rates soar, bowlers feel the heat in men's T20Is

By howindialives.com

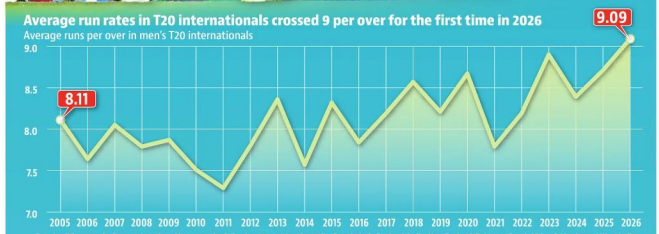
On Saturday, the men's teams of India and West Indies will square off in Bengaluru in the decider of a five-match T20 series that has tormented bowlers. Of the 8 innings in this series, 6 have seen scores of above 200 runs. The average run rate for the series stands at an eye-popping 11.46 per over. It has led India coach Gautam Gambhir to lament that, on flat pitches that are a blessing for batsmen, "careers [of Indian bowlers] are at stake". Indeed, mirroring T20 club leagues, 2026 has seen new advances in scoring rates in T20 internationals, and not just in India.

1 Trending up

The overall data highlights the evolutionary leaps in men's T20 international batting in the last few years. Across matches involving nine major Test-playing nations, average scoring rates surged from 7.79 runs per over in 2021 to a peak of 9.09 runs per over in 2026 — surpassing the 9 runs per over threshold for the first time. This follows the trend in the Indian Premier League (IPL), the main club-based T20 league, where the average run rate has stayed above 9 for three years running. In the early years of T20 internationals, run rates fluctuated mostly between 7.5 and 8.1 runs per over as teams adapted to white-ball tactical dynamics. However, the period following 2018 marked a structural shift towards hyperaggressive batting, especially in the powerplay, deeper batting lineups, and intent-focused middle-over hitting. Although tournament pitch conditions occasionally checked scoring — such as the dips to 7.79 in 2021 and 8.39 in 2024 — the overarching trend remained steeply upward.

Average run rates in T20 internationals crossed 9 per over for the first time in 2026

Average runs per over in men's T20 internationals



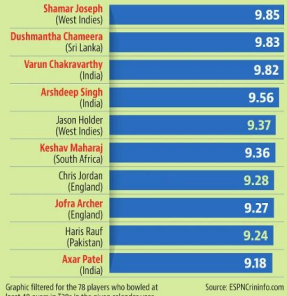
Data in all four graphs for matches played between the following 9 countries: Australia, Bangladesh, England, India, New Zealand, Pakistan, South Africa, Sri Lanka and West Indies.
Source: ESPNCrininfo.com

2 Economy at a premium

The modern T20 batting philosophy has shifted from consolidation to relentless boundary-seeking, making the job of bowlers difficult. Even the more prolific bowlers have suffered. In T20 internationals, of the 78 instances of a bowler delivering at least 40 overs in a calendar year, 7 of the 10 worst annual economy rates came in 2026. Leading this list are Shamar Joseph, Dushmantha Chameera and Varun Chakravarthy. Even frontline wicket-takers such as Arshdeep Singh and Jofra Archer have suffered. There are still exceptions. In the 2026 lot, four bowlers have an economy rate of below 8 runs per over: Jasprit Burmah (7.44), Adil Rashid (7.5), Liam Dawson and Mitchell Santner (both 7.91). This concentration of expensive spells in 2026 demonstrates how aggressive powerplay exploitation, maximised boundary targeting, and deeper batting orders have eroded traditional bowling defences.

Even among prolific T20 bowlers, 7 of 10 worst economy rates are from 2026

Average runs conceded per over in T20 internationals



Graphic filtered for the 78 players who bowled at least 40 overs in T20s in the given calendar year.
Source: ESPNCrininfo.com

3 Small grounds, large totals

Gambhir's lament was about Indian pitches. But India does not have the worst average economy rate among the 9 major nations in matches played between them between 2022 and 2026. Average men's T20 international run rates varied significantly, reflecting pitch conditions and tournament environments. South Africa tops the list as the only nation exceeding 10 runs per over (10.15), followed by England (9.51) and India (9.36). High-scoring venues in South Africa and small English grounds, along with flat Indian surfaces during bilateral series, enabled relentless boundary hitting. These three sides have also had a distinct white-ball batting philosophy, centred around relentless boundary targeting. At the other extreme, there are countries such as Bangladesh and Australia where average run rates reflect a relatively more even contest between bat and bowl. Both averaged run rates below 8 an over.

In the last five years, Indian grounds rank only third in average T20 scoring rates

Average run rate in men's T20s played in country between 2022 and 2026

Source: ESPNCrininfo.com

4 Tons of runs

One of the offshoots of advances in batting has been the dramatic increase in individual centuries scored in men's T20 internationals. Between 2005 and 2021, centuries were rare, rarely exceeding five in a calendar year. However, 2022 through 2026 marked a major breakthrough, peaking with a record 12 centuries in 2023 and 2026, alongside 11 in 2025 and 8 in 2022. The 2026 calendar is looking set to break the record for most T20 centuries in a year. The current India vs West Indies series has seen 3 centuries, with 2 from Shai Hope and 1 from Shreyas Iyer. This surge reflects modern batting advances, where top-order batters score briskly without forfeiting their stay at the crease. Like in the IPL, the boundaries in T20 internationals are being reset at a frenetic pace.

Calendar 2026 looks set to break the record for most centuries in men's T20 internationals

Number of centuries in men's T20 internationals

Source: ESPNCrininfo.com

hindustantimes.com
@hindustantimes @httweets @hindustantimes @hindustantimes
VOL. XXII NO. 245 PRICE ₹5.00 18 PAGES + 6 PAGES OF HT CITY (FOR MUMBAI ONLY). AREA SPECIFIC PAGES EXTRA.

MUMBAI/METRO
Saturday, October 17, 2026

Hindustan Times
FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.

Tricolour march held in Capital amid detentions

Jignasa Sinha, Karn Pratap Singh, Gargi Shukla
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: At least 2,000 people waving the Tricolour filled the inner circle of Connaught Place on Friday evening after police refused them permission to gather at Central Park, the centre of the business and retail district, closed the park itself for two days, and detained Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke hours before the Tiranga Yatra began, less than a week after police detained close to 7,000 people in a sweeping crackdown on the movement, which is demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

Last Saturday, protests broke out across central Delhi despite more than 40,000 police and paramilitary personnel, shuttered metro stations and a mobile internet shutdown, as police filled stadiums and police stations with detainees.

Friday's protest was much smaller than last Saturday's, and while it disrupted traffic to some extent (buses to ferry away detainees were parked on the road, reducing the space for traffic), most shops and restaurants in the area remained open.

Connaught Place remained the centre of the protest, but slogans against Kumar were raised well beyond the market, at Mandi House, Janpath Market, Firoz Shah Road and Kasturba Gandhi Marg, and small groups of protesters were still arriving at 9pm.

The march, called by the CJP, the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and student organisations, was the latest in the protests demanding the resignation of CEC Kumar over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. It came two days after CJP co-conveners Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were arrested for unfurling the national flag at Jantar Mantar, a day after the site was de-notified for protests, and sent to five days' judicial custody.

Police detained 100-150 protesters and activists through the day, among them Dipke and All India Students' Association (AISA) president Neha Bora, said a senior police officer at the Police Headquarters, more than 6,000 security personnel deployed across Lutyens' Delhi. Delhi Police declared the gathering illegal on Thursday, and with the park shut by the New Delhi Municipal Council

continued on →14

(Clockwise, from above) People take part in the Tricolour rally in New Delhi; police detain CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke; women officers detain AISA president Neha Bora on Friday. RAJ K RAJ, SONU MEHTA/HT, REUTERS

Fresh voter declaration concern misplaced: HC

Shruti Kakkar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court disposed of a petition filed by two voters whose names were deleted from the electoral rolls after they could not complete the enumeration process during ongoing the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in the Capital, terming their apprehension of being accused of making a false declaration while submitting Form 6 as "misplaced".

Dismissing the petition, a bench of justices Dinesh Mehta and Aditi Chaudhary, in an October 14 order, said that given that the "suggestion is coming from the learned standing counsel appearing for ECI, that too as per the instructions of the Electoral Registration Officer", the petitioner's "apprehension is...misplaced".

Form 6 is the statutory application for fresh inclusion in the electoral roll. It requires an applicant to fill in their personal particulars. However, applicants are also required to affirm that they are applying for inclusion in the electoral roll for the first time. It further says that giving a false declaration can attract penal consequences.

→P7

US President Donald Trump

TRUMP ADMIN ENDS AUTO RENEWAL OF WORK PERMITS FOR H-4 SPOUSES

WASHINGTON: The US government has scrapped the automatic extension of employment authorisation documents, potentially affecting foreign professionals, including spouses of H-1B visa holders, whose renewal applications remain pending. The US Citizenship and Immigration Services codified the final rule on Wednesday, following an interim rule issued in October last year. The rollback affects several categories, including H-4 spouses, asylum applicants, refugees and adjustment-of-status applicants.

The 540-day automatic extension was introduced in May 2022 under President Joe Biden,

→P2

AAIB blames crew for 2023 Learjet crash at Mumbai airport

Neha LM Tripathi
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: New Delhi: The Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) has blamed the September 2023 Learjet crash at Mumbai airport on the crew's decision to continue an unstable approach in poor weather. It also found lapses in pilot training, record-keeping and internal audits at VSR Ventures, the operator whose Learjet crashed at Baramati in January, killing Maharashtra deputy chief minister Ajit Pawar and four others.

The AAIB also recommended that the DGCA carry out "a one-time check of all the training records of fixed wing pilots specially for Non-Scheduled/General Aviation organizations" to verify that mandatory simulator exercises were completed.

The final report, made public on Friday, comes more than three years after the accident, well beyond the 12 months recommended under International Civil Aviation Organization norms. In January, after the Baramati crash, HT found that the Mumbai report was among those still pending. Experts said then that its findings could have shown whether VSR needed stricter oversight.

The Learjet 45XR, registered

continued on →14

The plane crashed while landing at Mumbai airport on September 14, 2023, in heavy rain. All eight people on board were injured. FILE

Beyond caste lines: Maharashtra plans common student hostels

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: To discourage caste-based politics and mend rifts among the youth of communities competing for reservation and welfare benefits, the state government says it will build "integrated" hostels for students from the SC, ST, OBC, Maratha and other backward communities.

State revenue minister Chandrashekhar Bawankule has asked the state administration to scout for land parcels to build these hostels, which would accommodate 1,000 students each at the divisional level and 500 students each at the district level.

Until now, the government has been running separate hostels for students of scheduled castes and scheduled tribes, according to the administrative department by which they are governed. Matters took a turn in 2017, when the Maratha community started widespread protests under the Sakal Maratha Samaj banner, demanding reservation benefits for Maratha youth.

In response, then chief minister Devendra Fadnavis announced a ₹5-crore grant to build hostels for Maratha students in every district. When the Maratha reservation issue gathered momentum, the OBC community opposed the inclusion of the Maratha community in the OBC category. They also demanded separate student hostels like the ones set aside

continued on →11

Available from 19th October 2026

LIFE AFTER RETIREMENT

LIC's New Jeevan Dhara-II helps you enjoy financial independence with guaranteed income after retirement

PRESENTING
LIC's New Jeevan Dhara-II
UIN: 512N398V01 I Plan No.: 892
A Non-Par, Non-Linked, Individual, Savings, Deferred Annuity Plan

Key Features:
- Guaranteed annuity rates at policy inception
- Lifetime annuity payments after deferment period
- Wide range of annuity options
- Regular Premium and Single Premium options
- Single Life and Joint Life Annuity variants
- Top-up facility - Option to increase the annuity by paying additional premium

Also Available Online

Scan the QR code and Download My LIC App | Visit: licindia.in | Call Centre Services (022) 6827 6827 | Our WhatsApp No. 8976862090 | Say 'Hi'

LIC भारतीय जीवन बीमा निगम LIFE INSURANCE CORPORATION OF INDIA

For details, contact your Agent/Nearest LIC Branch/visit www.licindia.in

Follow us : LIC India Forever I IRDAI Regn No.: 512

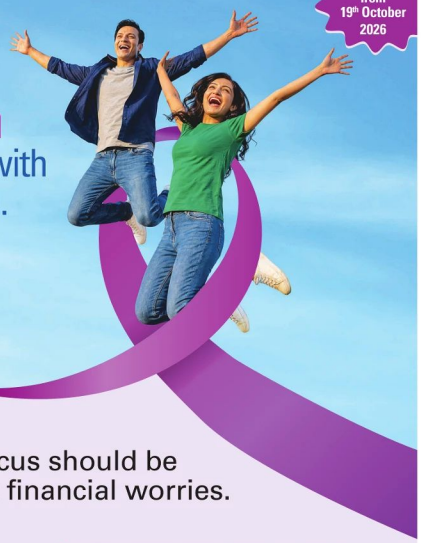
Har Pal Aapke Saath

BEWARE OF SPURIOUS PHONE CALLS AND FICTITIOUS / FRAUDULENT OFFERS. IRDAI or its officials do not involve in any activities of insurance business like selling insurance policies, announcing bonus or investment of premiums, refund of amounts. Policyholders or the prospects receiving such phone calls are requested to lodge a police complaint.
For more details on risk factors, terms and conditions, please read sales brochure carefully before concluding a sale.

LIC/R1/2026-27/1/Eng

Available from 19th October 2026

Now You Can Fight Cancer with Confidence.



Because your focus should be on recovery, not financial worries.

PRESENTING
LIC's New Cancer Cover
UIN: 512N370V01 I Plan No.: 908
A Non-Par, Non-Linked, Health, Individual, Pure Risk Plan

- Financial protection against specified Early Stage and Major Stage Cancer
- Fixed benefit payout irrespective of actual treatment cost
- 25% of the Applicable Sum Assured payable on diagnosis of specified Early Stage Cancer
- 100% of the Applicable Sum Assured payable on diagnosis of specified Major Stage Cancer
- Premium waiver benefit after eligible cancer diagnosis
- Option to choose between Level Sum Assured and Increasing Sum Assured
- Monthly income benefit of 1% of the Applicable Sum Assured for 10 years in case of Major Stage Cancer
- Fixed premiums for the entire policy term

Also Available Online

Scan the QR code and Download My LIC App | Visit: licindia.in | Call Centre Services (022) 6827 6827 | Our WhatsApp No. 8976862090 | Say 'Hi'

LIC भारतीय जीवन बीमा निगम LIFE INSURANCE CORPORATION OF INDIA

For details, contact your Agent/Nearest LIC Branch/visit www.licindia.in

Follow us : LIC India Forever I IRDAI Regn No.: 512

Har Pal Aapke Saath

BEWARE OF SPURIOUS PHONE CALLS AND FICTITIOUS / FRAUDULENT OFFERS. IRDAI or its officials do not involve in any activities of insurance business like selling insurance policies, announcing bonus or investment of premiums, refund of amounts. Policyholders or the prospects receiving such phone calls are requested to lodge a police complaint.
For more details on risk factors, terms and conditions, please read sales brochure carefully before concluding a sale.

LIC/R1/2026-27/1/Eng

From HT Archives

PAKISTAN COUP D'ETAT, OCT 1999

The Kargil War depended tensions between Pakistan Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif and its army chief, General Pervez Musharraf GETTY IMAGES

Sharif overthrown in coup, Musharraf to take Pak's reins

HT's report on the ouster of the elected govt after Sharif sacked Musharraf as army chief

ISLAMABAD/WASHINGTON: Pakistan, which has been ruled by unelected governments for 25 of its 52-year history, on October 12, 1999, opened another chapter of military rule. Prime Minister Nawaz Sharif was dismissed this evening by the man he had sacked earlier in the day: army chief General Pervez Musharraf.

Shortly after General Musharraf's dismissal was announced by the government this morning, troops took positions around Sharif's residence, the state-run Pakistan TV (PTV) building, the main airports and all major government buildings.

The coup came months after India flushed out Pakistani troops from Kargil, in a war that deepened tensions between Sharif and Musharraf, amid allegations that the army had planned the incursion unilaterally and kept the civilian government in the dark.

PTV recommenced its telecasts later in the evening to announce that the Pakistan Muslim League government of Sharif had been dismissed and Musharraf would be addressing the nation "shortly". The PTV announcement about the dismissal of the Sharif government did not specify who had ordered his dismissal.

Sharif and the man he chose to replace Musharraf, General Ziauddin, were under house arrest. Policemen guarding his official residence were disarmed, and the PM was asked not to leave the building.

In Washington, US government spokesman James Rubin said the Clinton administration "naturally hoped" that the Constitution of Pakistan would be adhered to "in letter and spirit".

CNN's Islamabad correspondent Imtiaz Gul reported that there were "spontaneous" shows of public support shortly after it was clear that a coup had been staged and the democratically elected government had been unseated.

Musharraf, who returned from Colombo in the afternoon, was reportedly given a ceremonial welcome by the army at Karachi airport.

An AP report said he was met at the airport by a large contingent of soldiers. He was seen leaving the airport accompanied by several jeeps filled with soldiers. He did not talk to reporters.

Soldiers also have taken over the homes of several Sharif ministers, including information minister Mushahid Hussain, foreign minister Sartaj Aziz and accountability chief Saifur Rehman.

In New Delhi, officials said troops along the border with Pakistan were on "full alert".

In Washington, senior Clinton Administration officials said messages had been sent to the Pakistan army through diplomatic channels that the US does not support any military takeover anywhere, that the Constitution has to be respected, and that it would not be right to presume it would be business as usual after a democratically elected government is overthrown.

Earlier in the day, the official APP news agency said Sharif had "retired" Musharraf "with immediate effect" and that Lt General Ziauddin, chief of the Inter Services Intelligence (ISI), had been promoted to full General and made the new Chief of the Army Staff.

The sacking of the army chief comes barely a fortnight after Sharif publicly gave him a vote of confidence. The announcement on state television gave no reason for Gen Musharraf being "relieved" of his job, but the General has been at the centre of a political storm since late May when tension with India over Kashmir flared up.

When asked what was going on at the PTV headquarters in downtown Islamabad, one of the army officers surrounding the building told Reuters: "You will find out in a short while."

In 1998, Musharraf's predecessor, General Jehangir Karamat, was forced to resign after suggesting setting up a national security council that would give the army greater say in the running of the administration.

Musharraf's removal by the PML government earlier in the day came in the wake of reports of growing differences between him and Sharif and fears of another army coup in Pakistan. This had even prompted the United States to issue a statement late last month that it would strongly oppose any extra-constitutional change in Islamabad.

In an apparent conciliatory move towards the powerful army, Sharif, on September 29, had extended by one-and-a-half years till October 6 next year the additional charge of Musharraf as Joint Chiefs of Staff Committee (JCSC). He was appointed as army chief for three years last October after his predecessor, Gen Karamat, resigned following differences with Sharif. Pakistan's naval chief, Admiral Fasih Bokhari, resigned on October 5, apparently for not being considered for the crucial JCSC's post.

THE HINDUSTAN TIMES

Sharif overthrown in military coup

Turmoil pinched of kargil debacle?

Sonia shoulders blame for defeat

SLEEP TIGHT.

HT covered the military coup in Pakistan in the October 13, 1999 edition. HT ARCHIVE

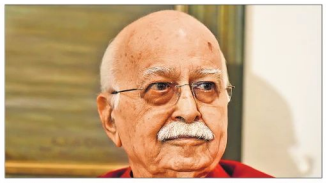
{ WORLD } LESS THAN A WK ON THE JOB

Trump fires new WH press secy Zacharia

White House press secretary Katie Zacharia was fired on Friday, barely a week after President Donald Trump picked her for the post, The New York Times reported. Earlier in the day, Trump said he had spoken to Zacharia and felt she did not deserve what he called negative media coverage. He said he had told her, "I think you're better off being happy," and questioned whether she needed the job, adding that he wanted "her to have a good life" rather than be "brutalised by the media". HTC

{ MY INDIA } CONDITION STABLE, SAY OFFICIALS

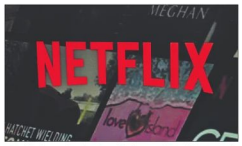
98-yr-old Advani admitted to hospital with chest infection



Veteran BJP leader and former deputy Prime Minister Lal Krishna Advani was on Friday admitted to Apollo Hospital after complaining of a chest infection, officials aware of the matter said. The 98-year-old is admitted to the hospital's pulmonary department, and his condition is stable, officials at the hospital said on condition of anonymity. Advani was admitted to Apollo Hospital in May this year due to age-related health issues. He was discharged after a few days. HTC

{ WORLD } AMID SEARCH FOR HITS

Ex-Disney exec is new Netflix content chief



Netflix is replacing its chief creative officer with a veteran TV and film executive, Peter Rice, accelerating efforts to reinvigorate growth and reverse a slowdown in viewers and revenue at the streaming giant. Rice served as chairman of general entertainment at Walt Disney, He assumes the role on October 26, with a broad mandate, overseeing scripted and unscripted series, film and live events across all regions. Rice replaces Bela Bajaria, who had worked at Netflix for 10 years. BLOOMBERG

HT vital | THE PULSE OF FRONTIER SCIENCE, FOR YOUR HEALTH AND WELLNESS.

Healing lesson from elite sport: Injuries need work, not full rest

Samreen Razzaqui and Binayak Dasgupta
letters@hindustantimes.com

When long jumper Murali Sreeshankar ruptured the patellar tendon in his left knee while training in Palakkad in April 2024, surgeons reattached it with three anchor screws and a wire looped around the kneecap, and early in his recovery, his team already had the knee moving and the muscles around it working.

"We know that the repair heals better when there is some stress placed on it, rather than none," said Wayne Lombard, an athlete performance specialist who has worked on Sreeshankar's comebacks. On July 29 this year, Sreeshankar won silver at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow with a jump of 8.09m and then went on grab a silver at the Asian Games on September 27 with a jump of 8.07m.

The principle behind that recovery now guides the treatment of far more common complaints, from tennis elbow and heel pain to thinning bone after menopause. When a tendon, bone or muscle is put under strain, its cells respond by building more of it, and most of that building happens during the rest that follows; take the strain away and the cells stop building.

For decades, medicine treated an injury as a reason to stop using the injured part. Sport, which needs its athletes back within weeks, showed that the right amount of use, increased in steps, heals better. "Elite sport has showed us that the right load progression in the right way usually is better than outright rest," Lombard said.

Cells build when strained, and rest is key

The cells in a tendon register each pull and respond by making more collagen, the protein that gives tendon its strength, laying the new fibres along the direction of pull. Bone cells respond to the slight bending of bone under impact by adding new bone. The rebuilding takes different lengths of time: muscles grow measurably within weeks of starting resistance training, bones renew in cycles of three to six months, and the tendon is the slowest of all, because, as Lombard and Samuel Pullinger, head of sport science at the JSW-backed Inspire Institute of Sport, point out, little blood reaches it. Much of the repair happens during sleep, when the body releases growth hormone.

"We know that some of the strongest evidence for it comes with ordinary people rather than athletes as well," Lombard said. Tennis elbow, an overloaded tendon on the outer side of the elbow that many people develop without ever holding a racquet, shows what the old approach costs. In a 2013 trial of 165 patients published in JAMA, researchers at the University of Queensland found that more than half of those given a steroid injection had a relapse within a year, against about one in eight of those given a placebo injection, even though the steroid had relieved pain far better at four weeks. General practitioners still often prescribe steroid injections, Lombard said, "but exercise is not prescribed."

The bone responds more to a hard jolt than to a long workout, because what matters is size and speed of the force. Gymnasts tend to have denser bones than swimmers, and walking does little for the spine. In the LIFTMOR trial at Griffith University in Australia, 101 postmenopausal women with low bone mass did supervised heavy lifting and impact training twice a week for eight months, and their spine bone density rose by 2.9%, while a comparison group on a gentle home programme lost 1.2%.

"A massive portion of what we called 'aging' was simply the clinical manifestation of advanced disuse syndrome," Pullinger said. People in their fifties and sixties who start training regain muscle, strength and aerobic fitness, though some losses continue regardless: maximum heart rate, for instance, falls with age at the same pace whether people exercise or not.

Too much, too soon undoes the gain

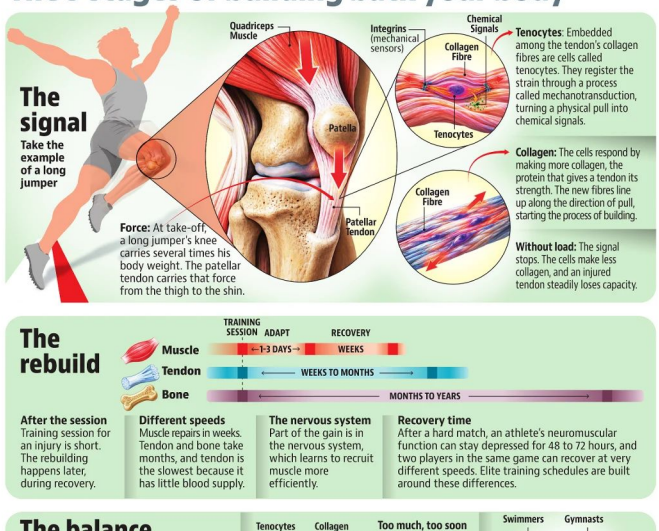
Hurried use causes the very injuries — tendinopathy, muscle strains and stress fractures — that careful use heals. Lombard sees this most often in sedentary people who attempt a fun run or a hike without preparing for it. Elite athletes also have coaches, physiotherapists and nutritionists tracking their recovery every day, Pullinger pointed out, support that most patients do not have.

In 2013, researchers at the University of Copenhagen used carbon released by nuclear weapons tests in the 1950s and 1960s to date the collagen in human Achilles tendons. They found that the core of the tendon is laid down by the end of adolescence and essentially never renewed, so an adult's Achilles is built around much the same collagen they had as a teenager. Yet Lombard has seen patients with chronic tendon pain who "often recover well while their scans barely change." Researchers have not yet established whether that recovery comes from new collagen at the edges of the tendon, from stronger muscle, or from a nervous system that has learned to share the work differently.

Vital explains the science and the conversations at the frontier of healthcare and wellness. It isn't medical advice — what to do with it is a conversation for you and your doctor.

Access HT Vital online for the full story and more

The 3 stages of building back your body



US ends auto renewal of work permits for H-4 spouses

Press Trust of India
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: The US has scrapped a policy to grant automatic extensions to work permits, including those of spouses of H-1 B visa holders, a move that could affect several foreign professionals, including Indians, while their applications for extension of employment authorisation documents (EADs) remain pending.

An interim rule to this effect was issued on October 30 last year and the US Citizenship and Immigration Services codified the final rule on Wednesday.

The 540-day automatic extension for EAD permits was introduced during President Joe Biden's tenure in May 2022 to reduce the number of renewal applicants to avoid processing delays by USCIS. The rule was re-issued as a temporary measure in April 2024 and granted an indefinite extension in December 2024.

The interim rule issued last October removed the automatic extension of EADs for categories including adjustment of status applicants, H-4 spouses, asylum applicants, refugees and asylees, and temporary protected status (TPS) beneficiaries.

Students on F-1 applying for a STEM extension of employment authorisation are not affected by the elimination of the maximum 540-day auto-extension. This category continues to receive a 180-day auto-extension upon timely filing of their STEM EAD application.

Spouses of persons on L and E category visas remain work-authorised "incident to status" and do not require an EAD. The Trump administration also proposed a new rule eliminating a longstanding practice of giving deference to prior approvals when adjudicating extension petitions for certain nonimmigrant workers.

The move could significantly increase scrutiny of previously routine visa extensions – including H-1B visas – and lead to longer wait times.

If the proposed rule is implemented, USCIS officers would be instructed to independently evaluate each extension petition on its own merits rather than giving deference to prior determinations. Employers may need to approach extension petitions much like initial filings, ensuring that eligibility is fully documented regardless of prior approvals.

EXEC OF HONG KONG COMPANY BOOKED FOR EXPLOITING INFLUENCER

Megha Sood

megha.sood@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The Versova police have booked a senior executive of a Hong Kong-based consumer electronics and personal computer manufacturer for allegedly stalking and sexually exploiting a social media influencer under false promise of marriage.

The FIR was registered after the 34-year-old woman approached the police, stating she had been engaged in an online clothing business—with an individual who worked as west regional head of the marketing division of the multinational company.

In his police complaint, she said she met the accused in 2023, and after a brief acquaintance the two got involved in an intimate relationship, as the man claimed that he was unmarried. The two travelled to Dubai and Thailand together where they engaged in physical relationship for around two years, up to May 2026.

The woman said later she found out that the accused was married and had been lying to her about his marital status and therefore tried to end the relationship, but the accused assured her that he would divorce his wife and marry her. The accused had also promised her that he would transfer 100% ownership of their retail business to her. The woman said that she had trusted the accused and continued with their relationship; however in April 2026 she discovered that the accused had been convincing his wife not to divorce him. The complainant claimed that she then on May 2, 2026 blocked his mobile number after which he began stalking and harassing her.

She approached the Versova police after which the police registered a case under Sections 69 (sexual intercourse obtained through deceitful means or a false promise to marry) and 351 (assault) of the BNS.

Bandra luxe tower developer under SRA fire for building plan breach

Gets SRA notice for not constructing the required PTC tenements on 6 floors in the 22-storey bldg

Linah Baliga

leena.baliga@htlive.com

Actor Mala Sinha's bungalow originally stood on the plot where the building is located.

The developer of the Palmera building, located on Turner Road in Bandra, deviated from the approved construction plan. SATISH BATE/HT

MUMBAI: A 22-storey luxury tower on a prime plot in Turner Road, Bandra, has come under the scrutiny of the Slum Rehabilitation Authority (SRA) as the builder has allegedly deviated from the approved plan to construct permanent transit camp (PTC) tenements on six of its floors. The building — a redevelopment property — stands on the plot where the 1960s actor Mala Sinha's bungalow, Mala Albert Sinha House, once stood.

One of Mumbai's most coveted real estate destinations, Turner Road commands premier residential prices ranging from ₹70,000 to ₹1 lakh per sq ft, with ultra-luxury properties scaling even higher.

The SRA on October 6 issued a notice to developer NVK Realty LLP for allegedly deviating from the approved plans of the building, now called Palmera, under Sections 53(1) and 53(2) of the Maharashtra Regional and Town Planning (MRTP) Act, 1966. The notice directs the developer to restore the 7th to 12th floors in accordance with the approved plans within a month, failing which the firm could face prosecution.

The alleged deviations were detected during a site inspection by SRA officials on September 30, following an RTI application filed by social activist Santosh Daundkar six months ago.

The case raises questions about the implementation of Development Control and Promotion Regulations (DCPR) 2034, particularly Regulation 33(11), under which developers can receive incentive floor space index (FSI) in return for providing built-up area for PTCs to the SRA free of cost.

According to the plan approved on September 12, 2023, the six floors of the 22-storey building were reserved for PTC tenements, and once the project was completed, it was to be handed over to SRA. However, an inspection of the building by authorities showed the lacuna.

A senior SRA official confirmed that the notice had been issued to NVK Realty LLP, explaining that Regulation 33(11)—used to secure higher FSI through PTC-related provisions—provides PTCs to accommodate people displaced by infrastructure projects such as the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation's (BMC) road widening, railway works, and Metro construction.

"The developer altered the units in Bandra without approval. Hence, we issued the notice," the official said, adding that given Mumbai's many ongoing infrastructure development projects, the city requires at least 2 lakh such PTCs for various projects.

Under the regulation, developers earn incentive FSI by constructing PTC tenements. The permissible FSI scales from three for roads at least 12 metres wide to four for roads 18 metres or wider. Alternatively, subject to approval, developers may fulfil their PTC obligations at a different site by paying a premium equivalent to 40% of the difference in ready reckoner values.

In NVK Realty's case, the PTC facility was initially planned within the Bandra building. Although a standard operating procedure was prepared to shift it to Andheri, the relocation had not yet been approved, the official said.

Activist and advocate Y P Singh said the arrangement raised broader concerns about the use of regulation 33(11) for projects that ultimately comprise sale of buildings. "The irony of Regulation 33(11) is that, although the building is meant for sale, it is treated as a rehabilitation building during construction. This enables the developer to claim additional FSI and concessions, including reduced open spaces and garden areas, which are otherwise associated with SRA schemes. The transit camp obligation can subsequently be fulfilled in another building," Singh said.

Singh also questioned the SRA's role as the planning authority for projects under Regulation 33(11), arguing that the BMC was better equipped to scrutinise building proposals and coordinate with other departments.

NVK Realty said it had received the notice and would comply with the requirements. Viren Shah, project manager from the NVK team said, "We have received the SRA's MRTP notice just today. Our architect is handling the matter with the SRA. We have been told it is a minor compliance issue, and we will address it and submit the compliance."

THE NOTICE DIRECTS THE DEVELOPER TO RESTORE THE 7TH TO 12TH FLOORS IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE APPROVED PLANS WITHIN A MONTH

The whistle-blower Daundkar said: "This revelation raises serious questions about regulatory compliance and the issuance of incentive FSI." He alleged that "other developers and affluent property owners could be benefiting from such an access which would enable construction of luxury towers with additional development rights".

"The principal beneficiaries appear to be builders and property owners, while the government and the BMC could lose legitimate revenue through premiums and other statutory charges. The additional FSI also puts enormous pressure on Mumbai's already strained infrastructure, particularly water supply and electricity," he said, adding that he would approach the court if the practice continued.

Meanwhile, in a separate communication, the SRA has put NVK Realty LLP's application submitted on September 10, to club the Letter of Intent (LOI) for a separate scheme on hold. SRA said the application would not be processed until the developer complied with the directions in the October 6, notice.

When HT contacted Junaid Rokad, Mala Sinha's son-in-law, on the matter, he said: "I am not aware of the SRA notice to the builder. However, I was aware of the six floors allotted for PTC tenements."

→WHY PTCs HAVE BECOME BIG BUSINESS FOR DEVELOPERS P4

Maha bans two firms over substandard police gear supply

MUMBAI: The Maharashtra government has permanently blacklisted two telecom equipment suppliers from all state government contracts after an inquiry flagged substandard equipment supplied to police units and irregularities in tenders for wireless communication gear. Vertel Infotel Pvt. Ltd and Vertel Digital Pvt. Ltd have been barred from participating in future state government procurement, according to a government resolution issued on Friday.

The action follows findings of poor-quality supplies, fraudulent original equipment manufacturer (OEM) authorisations and unfair, non-transparent practices during the tendering process.

The government resolution states that Vertel Infotel had supplied VHF high-band equipment to the Mumbai Railway Police, Ratnagiri Police and Sindhudurg Police, as well as 400 MHz communication equipment to the Thane City Police. The equipment was flagged for poor quality and substandard performance.

The company also repeatedly failed to provide satisfactory technical support and servicing during the mandatory warranty period, the resolution states.

Following adverse reports from the Additional Director General of Police and Director of Police Communication, IT and Transport, Pune, the state suspended both companies from participating in police department tenders in January 2026.

The action comes amid efforts to modernise the Maharashtra Police wireless communication network. The state has been pursuing the procurement of digital communication equipment, including ultra-high frequency (UHF) and very high frequency (VHF) digital sets, walkie-talkies and digital repeaters, to maintain operational readiness across police units. HTC

50 BMC school students to visit Singapore, ISRO

THE STUDENTS WILL BE SELECTED BASED ON THEIR PROJECTS AT SCIENCE EXHIBITIONS ORGANISED AT THE SCHOOL, WARD AND CENTRAL LEVELS

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: Fifty meritorious students from municipal schools will visit Singapore and the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO), inspiring them to dream and hopefully see a future in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM).

The students will be selected based on their projects at science exhibitions organised at the school, ward and central levels.

The cost of the educational visits will be borne by the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC), the BJP's Mumbai president, Ameet Satam, announced on Friday.

Satam was speaking at an event at a civic school in Dadar, to launch various initiatives for students.

These included two initiatives aimed at promoting constitutional values and inspiring students, and the release of 'Smart Nagrik', a set of ten books prepared by teachers for students across 10 classes. The books aim to create awareness about the Constitution, citizens' rights and duties, and the values needed to become responsible citizens.

The Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation also launched 'Vidyarthi Prerana', a book for Class 6 students that introduces them to the life and struggles of Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar.

Chief minister Devendra Fadnavis applauded the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation on the books and said they could be taught in schools affiliated with international boards as well.

Fadnavis stressed the importance of introducing children to the Constitution at an early age.

The event was presided over also by former Chief Justice of India Bhushan Gavai. Both leaders addressed questions on civic issues, including when they would get open playgrounds and why separate cycling tracks were not available.

Fadnavis said, "The Constitution gives people the right to protest. However, it also lays down rules on how to deal with protests that go beyond its limits. Some people are now saying that issues will be resolved on the streets and not in parliament. They are trying to create chaos in India, similar to what is happening in neighbouring countries."

However, the Constitution makes India different from these countries and keeps its democracy strong. All issues can be resolved within the framework of the Constitution and through Parliament," Fadnavis said, in an oblique reference to the opposition's protests currently raging in Delhi and elsewhere.

BKC's Public Transport Day a dud; 3-point redressal plan in pipeline

Transport experts said the drive was bound to fail as it was launched without the necessary planning

Shashank Rao
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: Nineteen weeks since the Mumbai Metropolitan Region Development Authority (MMRDA) launched a drive to curb the use of private vehicles within the Bandra Kurla Complex (BKC) on Fridays, the initiative has been silently discontinued due to lack of adequate response from commuters, companies and auto and cab drivers.

"We launched the drive to observe Public Transport Day at BKC every Friday on June 12. But people continued to bring their vehicles to work, and even auto drivers were not very supportive as they continued parking haphazardly. So the drive fizzled out by August end," an MMRDA official said, requesting anonymity.

Transport experts said the drive was bound to fail as it was launched without the necessary planning and ground work.

"Before starting, the authorities should have strengthened the public transport system in the BKC. One cannot expect people to leave their vehicles and wait in the harsh sun or rain for autos and buses, which are very irregular," said AV Shenoy, a member of the Mumbai Mobility Forum.

Dhaval Desai, Vice President, Observer Research Foundation, said the MMRDA should have conducted a rigorous assessment before implementing such grand plans and making tall claims. "The metro rail has provided great connectivity, but the BKC station should have been planned somewhere in the G Block not at the mouth of the business district. People travelling to G Block have to rely on paratransit modes but the auto rickshaws are never around and mostly refuse trips," he said.

Why the drive failed

- Entry/ exit points outside Bandra and Kurla railway stations are perennially congested
- Auto rickshaws park haphazardly, blocking other vehicles and pedestrians
- Traffic snarls are common on roads leading towards WEH, Kalanagar, LBS Marg, BKC G-block
- Several stretches of roads are out of bounds due to ongoing work on metro and other projects
- Internal roads are blocked due to ongoing work on pod-taxi services, affecting movement of cars
- Footpaths have barriers at several places and there have hardly any shade

BKC's last-mile connectivity put to test on public transport day

JUNE 13: HT report on the first day of the drive

Prep before launch

To implement the drive, the MMRDA collaborated with the Brihanmumbai Electric Supply and Transport (BEST), the Mumbai Metro Rail Corporation Limited (MMRCL), the traffic police, auto-rickshaw unions and World Resources Institute (WRI) India, a nonprofit. It also reached out to more than 60 companies which have their offices in the BKC, and surveyed more than 1,200 regular commuters.

MMRDA officials said several additional measures were taken to ensure a hassle-free Public Transport Day. Among these was a pedestrian infrastructure assessment and walking audit spanning 16.5 kilometres, covering accessibility, crossings and footpath conditions. A public transport assessment survey was also conducted over three days at four locations near the Bandra and Kurla railway stations. Depot managers at BEST, which operates 33 buses exclusively on four feeder routes to the BKC, were directed to operate all scheduled BKC-bound services and divert buses from other routes if required to meet additional demand.

Lukewarm response

Sources in the MMRDA said that despite all efforts, first- and last-mile connectivity from the Bandra and Kurla railway stations and the BKC metro station continued to remain poor, auto rickshaws continued to torment commuters, and pedestrians rarely used footpaths for long stretches as there was hardly any shade or other amenities.

"We held meetings with auto rickshaw drivers in the BKC ahead of implementing the drive, to curb the menace of unregulated share autos. But auto drivers still refused to ply on meter, haphazardly parked their vehicles and continued seating more passengers than allowed," an official said.

Accessibility barriers and lack of shade along footpaths also played a key role in the lukewarm response, officials said.

"Since there is no shade or tree canopy in most footpath stretches, walking under the scorching sun and heavy rains is very tedious," the official said. Nearly 33% of the street length in the BKC has no shade while 40% has only partial shade, the official noted.

Lessons for future

Sources in the MMRDA said that over the 12 weeks when the drive was implemented, they identified three key gaps that needed to be addressed.

"With regards to pedestrian connectivity, we have identified barriers at 23 spots spread over 3.7 km. There are 11 property gates which can be opened to the public, and six new routes which can be established through office complexes. We have asked the companies concerned to break walls that block free access," an official said.

There is a need to develop all-weather footpaths with shading, dry-mist, and vertical greening, and more buses need to be pressed into service along feeder routes to reduce vehicular congestion, officials said.

"We will start implementing remedial measures starting this month itself," the official quoted earlier said.

TWO-YEAR-OLD BOY DIES AFTER FALLING INTO OPEN DRAIN

Megha Sood
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: A two-year-old boy died after falling into an open drain behind his house in Vasai, in Maharashtra's Palghar district, on Thursday night, police said.

His father pulled him out and took him to a hospital, where doctors declared him dead on arrival, officers said.

Police said that Shahdev Turiya, 27, had returned home from work on Thursday and was having dinner when his son, Ankush, went outside to play.

Around 11.35pm, Turiya heard locals screaming that the boy had fallen into a drain behind their house. He jumped into the drain and pulled his son out, but water had entered the child's nose and mouth, officers said.

Police inspector Pravin Jagtap of the Waliv police station said Ankush was taken to a Vasai-Virar City Municipal Corporation hospital in Nagindas-pada, Nalasopara (East). The hospital authorities informed the police, following which they registered an accidental death report.

The police have sent the body for a post-mortem examination and are investigating the sequence of events leading to the child's death.

Why permanent transit camps have become big business for developers

Ateeq Shaikh
ateeq.shaikh@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The Slum Rehabilitation Authority's (SRA) notice to the developer of a luxury tower built on the site of yesteryear actor Mala Sinha's bungalow in Bandra West, over alleged deviations from approved plans for permanent transit camp (PTC) tenements, has drawn attention to one of the latest businesses quietly unfolding in Mumbai's real estate market.

PTCs are buildings constructed by private developers to accommodate project-affected persons (PAPs). Developers hand over these units free of cost to government agencies such as the SRA in exchange for additional development rights to construct a large luxury building or commercial project. There are currently 412 PTCs across Mumbai at various stages of construction, involving 25,733 housing units, a senior SRA official revealed.

"With the government pushing cluster slum redevelopment alongside major infrastructure projects, Mumbai needs substantial accommodation for families affected by these developments. Finding suitable space to relocate them is a significant challenge, and PTC housing can help address that requirement," said Kaivalya C Shah, director of Marathon Group, a Mumbai-based developer.

The incentive comes from Regulation 33(11) of Mumbai's Development Control and Promotion Regulations (DCPR) 2034. It allows developers to build larger buildings than originally permitted, with the floor space index (FSI) on a PTC plot going up to 4.

Vishal Ratanghayra, founder and CEO of Platinum Corp, said the incentives also encourage development of slum-occupied land reserved for public amenities such as roads, hospitals and recreation grounds, which might otherwise be commercially unattractive. "If we provide 30 square metres constructed, then we will get equivalent FSI that can be utilised either on the same plot or can be clubbed elsewhere," he said.

While developers must comply with planning requirements, including provisions for amenities and facilities such as gardens and schools, they say the PTC scheme is a potential win-win: the government can secure housing for project-affected families, while builders gain access to development rights that can support their projects.

Marathon Group is among the developers tapping into these benefits. The company is constructing over 1,200 homes in Bhandup and Kanjurmarg, where it has several ongoing projects. "Over the next few years, this inventory will serve eligible redevelopment requirements within the S ward and neighbouring wards," said Shah.

According to Parthh Mehta, chairman and managing director, Paradigm Realty, a PTC project's success will depend on the right land acquisition cost, efficient construction and a commercially attractive location.

Paradigm Realty is developing a PTC project in Oshiwara involving over 200 housing units. The FSI is planned to be utilised by K Raheja Group for its project at Bandra West, illustrating how transit housing and development rights can be linked across projects involving different developers.

Valambhia said PTC transactions generally follow three models: developers buy ready transit units to meet their obligations, construct the units themselves on eligible plots, or complete the transit housing requirement and commercially exploit the additional development rights generated.

A prominent example of a transaction involving two developers is the Lodha Developers-Arihant Superstructures deal in Mankhurd. Lodha reportedly acquired 945 units in Mankhurd for about ₹567 crore to fulfil SRA-mandated PTC obligations linked to its Vikhroli project.

The deal works out to roughly ₹60 lakh per PTC apartment, demonstrating the substantial sums developers are prepared to spend on transit housing.

How the system works

BUILD
Developers construct permanent transit camps (PTCs)—buildings to temporarily house families displaced by slum redevelopment and infrastructure projects.

HAND OVER
The housing units are handed over free of cost to a government agency such as the Slum Rehabilitation Authority (SRA).

GET INCENTIVES
In return, developers receive additional floor space index (FSI), allowing them to build a large luxury building or commercial project elsewhere.

Maha orders hospitals to put treatment charges on display

Surendra P Gangan
surendra.gangan@htlive.com

MUMBAI: Patients visiting private hospitals across Maharashtra will have to be provided easier access to information on treatment costs, with the state government directing hospitals and other clinical establishments to prominently display their rates in Marathi and English. A circular issued by the Public Health Department on Friday requires establishments to keep their rate lists visible, update them whenever charges change and help patients understand service charges and treatment packages.

The directive comes as the Maharashtra Clinical Establishments (Registration and Regulation) Bill, 2026, remains under consideration and awaits scrutiny by a Joint Select Committee of the state legislature. The government has issued the circular under existing provisions of the Maharashtra Nursing Homes Registration Act and Rules, 2021, rather than waiting for the proposed legislation to be passed.

Hospitals must display their charges at clearly visible and accessible locations on their premises, the circular states. Registration desks, enquiry counters and billing counters must help patients and their relatives access and understand the information to reduce confusion and billing-related complaints.

Institutions treating foreign patients arriving on medical or AYUSH visas must also clearly display the special package rates applicable to them, the circular states. The directive follows a communication from the Union Health Ministry dated October 12, 2026. Civil surgeons, district health officers and municipal medical officers of health have been asked to monitor compliance. The authorities must periodically review whether hospitals are following the directions and take appropriate administrative or legal action against establishments that violate the rules.

Hospitals have been directed to help patients understand service charges and treatment packages. PIC FOR REPRESENTATION

Bill proposes website disclosure

The proposed Maharashtra Clinical Establishments Bill, tabled during the state legislature's monsoon session in July, contains similar provisions. It has been referred to a Joint Select Committee comprising members of both Houses. Section 11 of the Bill proposes that clinical establishments display the rates ordinarily charged for their principal services, facilities, procedures and investigations at a conspicuous place on their premises.

The proposed legislation further states that hospitals cannot charge more than the rates displayed for services rendered. Patients would have to receive itemised bills. A Public Health Department official said the circular would enable immediate implementation of the rate-display requirement while the Bill and the rules to be framed under it go through the legislative process.

However, Dr Avinash Bhondwe, former president of the Indian Medical Association, said displaying every possible charge could be challenging, especially when additional procedures or services become necessary during treatment.

{ FAKE SPORTS CERTIFICATE RACKET }

19 Pune police recruits face action over fake Kurash certificates

Shrinivas Deshpande
shrinivas.deshpande@htlive.com

PUNE: Nineteen personnel recruited to the Pune city police force under the sports quota may lose their jobs for allegedly using fake Kurash sports certificates, police officers said. The police have also directed nine recruits undergoing training at various centres to return, while the candidates could face legal action following a detailed investigation into the alleged fraud.

Of the 19 personnel recruited under the Maharashtra government's 5% reservation for sportspersons, 10 are yet to join the force, while nine had been sent to police training centres.

"Ten are yet to join the force, and nine were attached to training centres. They have been called back, and after the detailed investigation, they are likely to face legal action," an officer involved in the investigation said on Friday.

The alleged fraud came to light during an investigation into the use of fake sports certificates to secure government jobs. So far, Pune police have arrested four people, Shivaji Salunkhe, secretary of the Maharashtra Kurash Association; its president, Ankush Nagar; and Kolhapur-based couple Shruti Punagavkar and Dhairyashil Punagavkar.

According to information received from the Directorate of Sports, the investigation has revealed that 71 players have secured recruitment in the police and other government departments under the sports quota since 2023 on the basis of Kurash certificates.

Police have also found that an estimated 1,200 to 1,500 such certificates were distributed. Investigators are examining the extent of the alleged irregularities and identifying those who benefited from them.

Police suspect that certificates purportedly showing participation or achievements in national- and international-level Kurash competitions were used to claim benefits under the sports reservation quota. The inquiry is examining the role of office-bearers of the Maharashtra Kurash Association, players and others allegedly involved in issuing or using the certificates.

Investigators have also found discrepancies in the certificates and related correspondence. Some documents refer to Dharashiv and Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar in connection with events allegedly held before 2023, when the districts were officially known as Osmanabad and Aurangabad. Names of male candidates were also listed for women's competitions.

The investigation began after Pune police received confidential information about an alleged racket in which certificates were prepared by showing that state-level Kurash competitions had been held, enabling candidates to seek government jobs under the 5% sports quota.

BPP's tenancy rights dispute reaches Charity Commissioner

Osama Rawal
osama.rawal@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The protracted dispute within the Bombay Parsi Punchayet (BPP)—the apex body of the Parsi Zoroastrian community in India and Mumbai's largest private landlords -- over converting leave-and-licence agreements into tenancy has escalated. Three of its dissenting trustees approached the Charity Commissioner on Friday to initiate proceedings against the four majority trustees over the decision to grant tenancy rights to long-standing residents.

Minority trustees Anahita Desai, Adil Malia and Hoshang Jal initiated proceedings against BPP chairperson Viraf Mehta and the other three trustees—Armaity Tirandaz, Maharukh Noble and Xerxes Dastur—challenging the process adopted for the proposed conversions.

The move follows a June 9 decision by the majority trustees to allow long-standing residents of BPP colonies to seek conversion of their leave-and-licence agreements into tenancy – a decision that could benefit nearly 1,900 licensees across 22 baugs, accounting for approximately 40% of the trust's housing stock in Mumbai.

In a joint statement to the community, the three minority trustees said the move resulted from an impasse in discussions, noting that 38 of their questions remained unanswered and essential documents and letters were withheld.

They also alleged that the majority trustees proceeded with registering tenancy agreements for three applicants despite these unresolved concerns. The registrations were completed on October 5, covering one occupant in the Dadar colony and two in the Goregaon colony. While about 100 applications have come in so far.

"Left with no alternative, we sought the Charity Commissioner's intervention to protect the Trust's properties, the intentions of its donors and the Parsi-only covenants attached to them," Malia told HT.

In their proceedings, the minority trustees argued that the proposed conversion raises questions about protection of BPP's Parsi-only housing covenant and the trust's obligation to preserve properties in accordance with the original intentions of donors and settlers.

They questioned whether covenants will remain legally enforceable under tenancy arrangements, given the statutory eviction protections of the Maharashtra Rent Control Act, 1999, and flagged the potential risks to the trust's control over its properties during redevelopment, specifically concerning rehabilitation and future ownership rights.

The majority trustees defended the conversion, arguing that it would provide long-term housing security to community members while retaining safeguards to protect the Parsi-only housing covenant.

Mehta termed the dissenting group's move unfortunate and rejected the allegation that their concerns had not been addressed.

"Whatever pertained to the matter has been explained in detail. They are demanding certain documents which cannot be traced, as some of them are nearly a century old. Making the absence of these documents the basis for approaching the Charity Commissioner is not right," said Mehta.

Meanwhile, the first tenancy agreements were registered earlier this month, with the initial exercise covering flats allotted without security deposits.

One of the three occupants who received tenancy rights earlier this month defended the majority trustees' decision. "The move (of the dissenters) does not make any sense – the proposal to grant tenancy was approved by four trustees, including the chairperson. In principle, the minority should respect the majority decision instead of derailing the process," the occupant told HT.

"Our primary prayer is that the process be stayed and no further tenancies be granted until the matter is decided," Malia said.

Three minority trustees, including Adil Malia (left) initiated proceedings against BPP chairperson Viraf Mehta (right)

Kabutarkhana gets a revamp

Dadar Kabutarkhana, which was closed over concerns about pigeon-related diseases, is being revamped by the BMC. Workers removed the plastic covering installed over the structure as work began on a new iron installation at the site on Friday. SATISH BATE / HT PHOTO

Class 12 duo kill 17-yr-old for gold chain, take a cue from Drishyam

Motive behind crime was their desire to buy a motorcycle and fund a birthday party for a friend: Police

Kaptan Mali
kaptan.mali@hindustantimes.com

On September 24, the victim was called to an isolated location near Ghodbunder Road. He was stabbed multiple times with a knife and his face was crushed with a stone. The duo then set his body on fire in an attempt to destroy evidence. PRAFUL GANGURDE/HT PHOTO

THANE: A birthday bash and a dream of buying a motorcycle allegedly led two Class 12 students to murder their 17-year-old schoolmate, burn his body and attempt to cover their tracks by throwing his mobile phone onto a moving bus. The two minors, both residents of Azad Nagar in Thane, allegedly killed the teenager to steal his 7-gram gold chain, worth around ₹1 lakh, hoping to use the proceeds to fund a birthday party for a friend and buy a motorcycle, police said.

The Kasarvadavali police arrested the two minors after an investigation into the teenager's disappearance led them to the murder. The accused, who police said had recently watched Ajay Devgn-starrer suspense thriller Drishyam 3, allegedly drew inspiration from the film while planning the crime and attempting to mislead the police.

According to the officers, the victim left his home at around 7pm on September 24 but did not return. His father approached the police the next day, following which a case of kidnapping was registered.

During the initial investigation, one of the accused allegedly told the victim's family and the police that he had seen the teenager leaving on a white Activa scooter with an unidentified youth from a road opposite Brahmand Circle. He also allegedly pretended to appear sad in order to avoid any suspicion, police said.

The police officers examined footage from at least 80 to 90 CCTVs but initially failed to find any trace of the missing boy. As the probe continued, however, the police began suspecting that the two minors were withholding crucial information. They analysed mobile phone data and questioned the suspects again. Upon fresh questioning on Thursday, one of the minors allegedly confessed to the crime, leading the police to the spot where the body had been dumped.

The accused allegedly told investigators that they had lured their schoolmate to an isolated location near Brahmand Phase 2 on Ghodbunder Road on the night of September 24, on the pretext of smoking cigarettes. Once there, they allegedly stabbed him multiple times with a knife and crushed his face with a stone before concealing his body in the bushes.

The following day, the duo allegedly returned to the spot with petrol and set the body on fire in an attempt to destroy evidence. Acting on their disclosure, the police found the half-burnt body on Thursday.

Officers said the alleged plan extended beyond the killing. The accused broke the victim's mobile phone and threw it onto a moving bus, hoping that its changing location would mislead the police while they tracked the missing teenager's phone and tower-location data.

"The minor accused had very sound knowledge of destroying evidence. But they were weak in their studies. We found that the alleged motive behind the crime was the minors' desire to celebrate one of their friends' birthday and purchase a motorcycle. They conspired to commit the crime after watching the film Drishyam 3," Deputy Commissioner of Police (DCP), Zone V, Prashant Kadam said.

The Kasarvadavali police have booked the two minors under Sections 103(1) (murder) and 238 (destruction of evidence) of the BNS.

Fortis hosp kitchen licence suspended over roaches

Hepzi Anthony
letters@hindustantimes.com

Food and Drugs Administration officers found cockroach infestation and fungus-infested containers during inspection.

MUMBAI: Cockroaches in the food preparation area, food waste clogging the drainage, fungus-infested containers used to transport meals and rusted knives in use — these were among the food safety violations that led the Food and Drugs Administration (FDA) to suspend the licence of the kitchen at Fortis Hospital in Mulund on Friday.

The suspension, following an inspection of the hospital's kitchen, comes amid a wider crackdown by the state FDA on food establishments found flouting safety and hygiene norms. The food business licence, held in the name of M/s Sodexo India Services Pvt. Ltd, which operates the kitchen as a third-party dietary service provider, has been suspended.

In a statement, Fortis Hospital, Mulund, said patient safety, quality of care and hygiene remained paramount. "We have taken note of the communication from the FDA concerning the on-premise kitchen operated by our third-party dietary service provider, which holds the relevant food business licence. We take the observations raised by the FDA seriously and have directed the service provider to promptly address them and ensure compliance with all applicable food safety requirements," the hospital said.

It added that it was coordinating with the service provider to review the corrective measures being undertaken. "Appropriate alternative arrangements are being made, wherever required, to ensure the uninterrupted provision of safe, nutritious meals to patients and their attendants," the statement said.

The FDA also suspended the licence of the canteen at Sophia College for Women on Bhulabhai Desai Road over similar violations. The college said it had acted immediately after the inspection. "This took place today and necessary modifications and improvements are being undertaken right away. The college consistently prioritises the wellbeing of its students above all else," said Anagha Tendulkar Patil, principal of Sophia College for Women.

{ INVESTMENT FRAUD CASE } MONEY-LAUNDERING PROBE BY ED

Thanawala fraud: 100 bank accounts under lens

Vikrant Jha
vikrant.jha@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) is probing the alleged Thanawala Wealth Management investment fraud separately under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), and investigators are examining more than 100 bank accounts and transactions that may have been routed through 12-15 agents allegedly as per instructions from Dipen Rashmikant Thanawala, according to orders passed by a special PMLA court.

In the order dated October 9, the special court permitted the ED to record Thanawala's statement at Arthur Road jail between October 19-29, excluding October 20, after the ED said it needed additional time to scrutinise voluminous financial records.

Thanawala is in judicial custody in a ₹18.35-crore fraud case registered by the Mumbai police's Economic Offences Wing (EOW). The ED's case is based on the same first information report (FIR).

On October 6, the special court had allowed ED assistant director Mukul Jain to record Thanawala's statement on October 19-20, after the agency alleged that Thanawala was a key suspect in its investigation as he had played a significant role in money laundering. The court's order recorded the prosecution's allegation that approximately 83 investors had been defrauded of ₹17.05 crore.

DIPEN THANAWALA IS IN JUDICIAL CUSTODY IN A ₹18.35-CR FRAUD CASE REGISTERED BY THE EOW; THE ED'S CASE IS BASED ON THE SAME FIR

According to the ED's submission, investors were induced to part with money through promises of lucrative returns, with small initial payouts allegedly used to build their confidence before repayments were stopped. The agency's investigation is examining the financial trail in the alleged fraud.

Separately, complainants have cited an alleged fraud of more than ₹150 crore in a representation to the police, seeking a wider investigation into the investment scheme.

Dipen Thanawala and his father, Rashmikant Thanawala, were arrested by the EOW in April this year, in connection with the alleged ₹18.35-crore investment fraud. He has since moved the court seeking bail in the EOW case.

The ED's proceedings are separate from the EOW investigation. The ED has sought to record Thanawala's statement to investigate the alleged laundering of proceeds linked to the scheduled offences.

The October 9 order records the ED's submission that scrutiny of more than 100 bank accounts and possible transactions involving 12-15 agents would require additional time.

vijay sales
Trust Matters
www.vijaysales.com

Why wait? Beat the Rush, Buy now
GRAND ELECTRONICS SALE
Buy & Fly upto ₹5,000 paytm EMI
INSTANT DISCOUNT UP TO ₹15,000/- ON CREDIT CARD EMI TRANSACTIONS
UP TO ₹45,000/ CASHBACK ON PAPER FINANCE

BAJAJ FINANCE CASHBACK UP TO ₹20,000*
HDB FINANCIAL SERVICES CASHBACK UP TO ₹31,000*
IDFC FIRST Bank CONSUMER DURABLE LOAN CASHBACK UP TO ₹45,000*
1 EMI OFF

43 (109 cm) 4K QLED powered by webOS Hub
PRICE ₹65,000
EFFECTIVE PRICE (AFTER EXCHANGE VALUE) ₹26,490
FINAL PRICE ₹23,490 (AFTER CASHBACK AND EXCHANGE VALUE)

VISE
ZERO DOWN PAYMENT
EMI ₹3,499 x 8 Months

boAt 2.1 SOUNDBAR RHYTHM PLUS
OFFER PRICE ₹3,000*

SIDE BY SIDE U/E* EMI STARTING FROM ₹4,499* UPTO 20% CASHBACK* UPTO ₹20,000
FROST FREE U/E* EMI STARTING FROM ₹1,799* UPTO 15% CASHBACK* UPTO ₹8,100
DIRECT COOL U/E* EMI STARTING FROM ₹1,249* UPTO 5% CASHBACK* UPTO ₹2,500
REFRIGERATORS RANGE AVAILABLE FROM 180 LTRS TO 800 LTRS U/E*
WASHING MACHINES RANGE AVAILABLE FROM 6 KG TO 25 KG U/E*
FRONT LOAD U/E* EMI STARTING FROM ₹1,922* UPTO 20% CASHBACK* UPTO ₹6,000
TOP LOAD U/E* EMI STARTING FROM ₹1,222* UPTO 10% CASHBACK* UPTO ₹5,000
SEMI AUTOMATIC U/E* EMI STARTING FROM ₹991* UPTO 8% CASHBACK* UPTO ₹1,000

AIR CONDITIONERS RANGE AVAILABLE FROM 0.8 T TO 3 T
FREE STANDARD INSTALLATION*
CASHBACK UPTO ₹3,000*

Best Deals on Laptops
OMNIBOOK, VICTUS, OMEN
• Cashback Upto ₹18,000/-*
• Extended Warranty + ADP + Antirus Starting @ ₹2,999/-*
• One EMI Free
Lenovo LENOVO GAMING, LOQ SLIM 5 & FLEX 5, YOGA SERIES
• Cashback upto ₹10,000/-*
• Exchange Bonus upto ₹15,000/-*
• Upto 24 Months Paper Finance Offer
• 3 Years Warranty + 3 Years Premium Care + 3 Year ADP ₹1,499/-*

OnePlus N6 Lite Massive 7000mAh Battery Powerfully Big Starting at ₹15,999*

SAMSUNG BEST TIME TO BUY NOW Industry's best* Galaxy S26 | S26 Ultra Galaxy AI

HDFC BANK INSTANT DISCOUNT UP TO ₹15,000* WITH EASY EMI ON HDFC BANK DEBIT / CREDIT CARDS
HSBC INSTANT DISCOUNT UP TO ₹12,000* ON CREDIT CARDS EMI & NON EMI TRANSACTIONS
ICICI Bank INSTANT DISCOUNT UP TO ₹15,000* ON CREDIT CARDS EMI TRANSACTIONS
UP TO ₹15,000/- INSTANT DISCOUNT ON CREDIT CARD / DEBIT CARD
IndusInd Bank RBL BANK BOBCARD YES BANK IDFC FIRST Bank HSBC standard chartered

VIJAY SALES (INDIA) PVT. LTD.
MUMBAI | PUNE | AHMEDABAD | SURAT | GANDHINAGAR | VADODARA | DELHI | GURUGRAM | NOIDA | INDIRAPURAM | FARIDABAD | GHAZIABAD | HYDERABAD | WARANGAL | ANDHRA PRADESH | BENGALURU
MUMBAI • WESTERN: Operahouse | Prabhadevi | Mahim | Khar-West | Santacruz-West | Andheri-West: Infiniti Mall | Andheri-West: S.V. Road | Andheri-East | Goregaon-East | Goregaon-West | Malad-West | Borivali-West | Miraroad -East | Vasai-West | Nallasopara-West | Virar-West | Boisar-West | Palghar-West • CENTRAL: Sion | Ghatkopar-West: R City Mall | Ghatkopar-West: L.B.S. Road | Bhandup-West | Thane-West: Ghodbunder Road | Thane-West: Tip-top Plaza | Dombivli-East | Bhiwandi | Kalyan-West | KALYAN West Khadakpada | Mumbra-Bellamonte | Ulhasnagar | Badlapur-East • HARBOUR: Chembur | Vashi | Belapur | Kharghar | Panvel
PAREL - One Avighna Park, M. P.Marg, Lower Parel (E) Near Currey Road Station
KANDIVALI WEST - Shiv Shrushti CHS LTD, New Link Road, Mahavir Nagar, Kandivali West Only For Mobiles, Laptops & TVs
SCAN FOR STORES
Scan to Shop Online www.vijaysales.com
*Conditions apply. This offer includes all other discounts also. No other offer can be clubbed with this offer. Images shown are for illustrative purpose only. Offer till stocks last. Finance offer applicable at the sole discretion of Financier. #Processing Fees and other charges is applicable as per Financier. Offer is based on minimum transactions slabs defined by Financer . Convenience fees may be charged by the respective financer. Kindly speak to our store sales staff for the "Terms and Conditions" of all the bank offers, and for the respective Instant Discount/Cashback amounts applicable on each Bank. *Cashback Applicable on Select Banks & Cards. Up to off on select brands and models only.

DEATH PENALTY FOR MAN WHO RAPED, KILLED MINOR GIRL

Nadeem Inamdar
puneletters@hindustantimes.com

PUNE: A Malegaon additional district and sessions court on Friday sentenced Vijay Khairnar to death by hanging for sexually assaulting and murdering a four-and-a-half-year-old girl in Dongrale village in Nashik district. The court termed it a 'rarest of rare' case and directed that ₹10 lakh be paid as compensation to the victim's family.

The case was heard by a fast-track POCSO court which deals with offences under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act. Judge K G Paldewar pronounced the sentence nearly 11 months after the November 16, 2025 incident that sparked widespread outrage after Khairnar, 21 years' old at the time of committing the crime, was accused of sexually assaulting the girl and strangling her to death.

The prosecution was represented by SPP Ujjwal Nikam, assisted by advocates Sneha Sharma Thakare and Sanjay Sonawane. Whereas advocate Rathi represented the accused.

Nikam said that the brutality of the crime and the circumstances in which the girl was found were central to the prosecution's plea for maximum punishment. "The crime was macabre and the victim was soaked in blood," Nikam said. He said that the prosecution examined 24 witnesses during the trial, including police personnel, villagers, members of the victim's family and medical officers. The prosecution argued that the nature and brutality of the offence did not warrant any concession in punishment, and sought the death penalty for Khairnar.

PANVEL TO GET ITS FIRST CIVIC BUS SERVICE, ₹288-CR PLAN APPROVED

G. Mohiuddin Jeddy
letters@hindustantimes.com

PANVEL: Panvel is set to get its first municipal bus service, with the Panvel Municipal Corporation (PMC) approving a ₹287.55-crore plan to introduce 100 to 130 buses on 16 routes in the first phase. The proposed network will have 68 bus stops, five depots, 76 charging stations and an intelligent transport management system to improve connectivity across the rapidly expanding civic area.

The proposal was unanimously approved at a special general body meeting on Thursday, October 15, chaired by mayor Nitin Patil. It comes after a feasibility study found that existing services operated by Navi Mumbai Municipal Transport (NMMT) and BEST were inadequate to meet the growing public transport needs of the area. "The objective is to provide Panvel residents with affordable and safe bus services. We will complete the administrative process and follow up for the necessary government approval," Patil said.

The planned routes will connect old Panvel, CIDCO-developed nodes, railway stations and villages, including areas with limited public transport. The estimated cost includes ₹150 crore for 100 buses, ₹8.15 crore for 68 bus stops, ₹30 crore for depots, ₹8.4 crore for 76 charging stations and ₹86 crore for an intelligent transport management system.

{ MANKHURD T-JUNCTION REVAMP }

4.66 acres of mangroves to go for power lines

Shifting of six major electricity transmission lines will allow two new flyovers to be built

Yogesh Naik
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The plan to decongest the T Junction at Mankhurd can finally move forward, with the state environment authorities giving the go-ahead to clear 203,040 sq feet (4.66 acres) of mangrove land to enable the shifting of six major electricity transmission lines that bring power to Mumbai.

Shifting the lines will allow two new flyovers to be built, linking the Ghatkopar-Mankhurd flyover to the Sion-Panvel highway. Large volumes of traffic will then bypass the T-Junction and ease massive traffic bottlenecks during peak hours on the Ghatkopar-Mankhurd Link Road (GMLR) towards Navi Mumbai.

The Maharashtra Coastal Zone Management Authority (MCZMA) approved the BMC's proposal to permit the construction of 13 new towers to accommodate the six transmission lines in the ecosensitive zone of the Thane Creek. The go-ahead was given in September but formally recorded on October 14.

The six transmission lines are the 110 kV Old Waghivali-Chembur Line, 110 kV Waghival-Chembur Line, 110 kV Parel-Mankhurd Line, 220 kV Waghivali Dharavi 8 Line, the 220 kV Waghivali Dharavi-linked Antop Hill 1 Line, and 110 kV Waghivali Mankhurd Line.

At the meeting, the BMC said shifting the Extra-High Voltage transmission towers would provide vertical clearance for the construction of the two flyover arms along the GMLR. Considering the fixed alignment of the flyover, dense urban conditions and the construction of transmission towers being a site-specific activity, no alternatives had been examined, said the civic body.

Even though the alignment of the towers passes through the Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary, the EIA report claimed no flamingoes or other birds were recorded within the project site. HT ARCHIVES

In its environment impact assessment (EIA) report, the BMC said mangrove clearance would be restricted to tower-footing locations and essential working areas. The area, in Mankhurd, is bounded by dense slum habitation on one side and the Sion-Panvel Highway on the other, resulting in continuous high noise levels and human activity, according to the report. Even though the alignment of the towers passes through the Thane Creek Flamingo Sanctuary, the EIA report claimed no flamingoes or other birds in large congregations were recorded within the project site.

The BMC said each of the 13 transmission towers will require 225 sq m for foundation and erection of the tower. The MCZMA noted that mangrove clearance within these footprints will result in localised habitat modification within the core zone and 0.44 hectares within the notified Eco-Sensitive Zone (ESZ) of the flamingo sanctuary. Additional temporary disturbance may occur due to the creation of tower access routes for transportation of construction materials and machinery, the MCZMA has noted.

The MCZMA has also underlined that sufficient ground clearance and vertical distance must be maintained for safe passage of birds and animals and to avoid electrocution of birds with a large wingspan.

Additional municipal commissioner Abhijit Bangar said, "This will help us expedite the project and help us in early completion."

Environmentalist D Stalin of NGO Vanshakti said, "It is a new norm that all projects go through mangroves and all agencies and institutions which are supposed to protect the mangroves are complicit in their destruction. The farcical mitigation has been exposed in other projects."

Wave of dissent

Supporters of the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) waved the national flag and raised slogans demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar during the 'Lehra Do Tiranga' protest at Azad Maidan on Friday. The protest was organized to express solidarity with CJP leaders Ashutosh Ranka and Saurav Das, who were sent to five-day judicial custody on Wednesday after they entered Jantar Mantar in New Delhi and raised slogans. ANSHUMAN POYREKAR/HT PHOTO

Parents keen to mark 1 month of son's death on IIT campus

Niraj Pandit
niraj.pandit@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: Parents of the IIT-Bombay (IIT-B) student who died by suicide have sought permission to visit the campus on October 18 to pay tribute to their son, marking one month since his death. The parents, who are currently protesting at Azad Maidan, are demanding the arrest of professor Suryanarayan Doolla and justice for their son.

The father said they met joint commissioner of police (crime) Anil Kumbhare on Thursday. "He assured us he would give us permission to visit the campus on October 18," he said. He told the media the family would continue their protest until the professor was arrested. However, IIT-B sources said they haven't received any request from the student's family for permission to pay tribute to the boy.

The student's father also said, "The system is trying to damage my son's image by leaking a video and claiming he was copying before the inquiry is completed. This is wrong," he said.

Meanwhile, students protesting on campus claimed the professor's alleged caste bias was not an isolated case. They mentioned earlier complaints filed by students against him, claiming IIT-B's SC/ST Cell had failed to provide proper assistance.

Parents of the deceased student have resumed their hunger strike at Azad Maidan. ANSHUMAN POYREKAR/HT PHOTO

In one such case, a student was suspended by the institute for violating rules. A protester alleged that when the student approached the administration to understand the appeal process, he received no response and was allegedly humiliated when he visited the office of the dean of student affairs. The student later approached the SC/ST Cell, which assured him of assistance, but allegedly failed to provide the required support. The matter is pending in the High Court

The students also raised concerns about there being no communication from the administration with students sitting at the IIT-B's main gate for the last 29 days. They also said they were unhappy with faculty representation at the institute. According to RTI data cited by the protesters, only 84 of the 775 filled faculty positions at the institute are held by teachers from SC, ST, OBC and EWS categories.

The protesters demanded a comprehensive law against caste discrimination in higher education, and called for the introduction of a Rohith Act. Institute authorities did not respond to requests for a comment.

Malaria and dengue cases on the decline in October, says BMC

Hepzi Anthony
hepzi.anthony@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: While doctors across the city have raised concerns about a surge in malaria and dengue cases in recent months, senior officials from the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) claim the numbers have begun to decline in October.

"The number of malaria and dengue cases have fallen in the first half of October compared with September. Malaria cases seem to have declined as per the corresponding year-on-year comparison from the first half of October last year," said executive health officer at BMC, Dr Santosh Gaikwad, without revealing the actual figures.

According to the BMC, Mumbai recorded 7,422 malaria cases and 2,941 dengue cases between June and September this year. During the same monsoon period last year, the city recorded 5,144 malaria cases and 3,356 dengue cases. While malaria cases have risen sharply year-on-year, dengue cases have declined.

BMC officials said the civic body has already ordered improved pest control operations and increased fogging operations across the city to prevent the spread of vector-borne diseases. Gaikwad added that public health centres were equipped to treat patients of malaria and dengue.

BMC officials said the civic body has already ordered increased fogging operations across the city. HT ARCHIVE

Harish Bandirge, chairperson of the BMC's health committee, said he has proposed that fever clinics at civic hospitals operate 24x7. "In case severe cases of illness are detected, they are directed to the casualty ward of the hospital for testing and admission," he said.

Even as the civic body reports a decline in infections, doctors say the severity of some cases this year is a growing concern.

Dr Deepak Baid, founder of Nulife Hospital in Ghatkopar, said around 80% of patients at his 50-bed multispeciality facility were being treated for fever-related illnesses.

"This year, particularly in the past three months, we found that in the case of dengue, the fall in platelet count has been very swift, with the disease becoming severe in a matter of days. Also, these days, the fall in blood pressure and severely low blood platelets is accompanied by the shutdown of the kidneys, resulting in patients being taken to the ventilator," he said.

Baid also said that dengue cases are particularly being found among young adults in the age group of 20-30 years. "Unlike earlier, when instances of haematological dengue were on the rise, these days the Shock Syndrome Dengue has been on the rise, where dengue is accompanied by high blood pressure, which makes it difficult to treat," he said.

Dr Ajanta Yadav, a practising doctor and corporator from Kandivali, accused the BMC of being inadequately prepared to deal with the rise in monsoon-related illnesses. "Although 45 staffers have been contracted for every city ward specifically for fogging and pest control services this monsoon, the operations were inadequate and irregular. Besides, Aapla Dawakhana, run by the BMC, does not operate throughout the day. Results of dengue tests are also given after many days," she said.

RUCKUS AT STN AFTER TC TRIES TO CHASE PASSENGER

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: A woman chief ticket inspector fell on the platform at Kandivali railway station on Friday evening after a passenger allegedly tried to flee when caught travelling without a valid ticket. The incident escalated when a crowd gathered outside the ticket-checking office and allegedly pressured the railway official to apologise, prompting the GRP and RPF to intervene.

According to Western Railway officials, the incident took place around 7.30pm when Priya Ambavade, chief ticket inspector at Kandivali, caught a woman travelling without a valid ticket. The passenger allegedly requested that she be let off without paying a penalty, but Ambavade proceeded with the ticket-checking process.

{ FIRST PRINCIPLES }
Charles Assisi

Every week, find the best take on stories at the intersection of tech, policy and business here

Telephony and the missing human touch

TRAI READS THE RISE IN DISSATISFACTION AS PROBLEMS WITH THE OPERATORS' OWN SYSTEMS

Most of us, when we call our telecom service provider, are used to a variation of a message like this:

Press 1 for billing.
Press 2 for recharge.
Press 3 for anything else.

Personal experiences suggest that if we press 3, a subhuman voice will ask to choose from another tree of options. If nothing fits the problem that needs to be resolved, the voice will apologise, and either disconnect or go back to the beginning of the options. This loop continues until the exasperated caller hangs up.

This isn't a uniquely Indian problem. That is why lawmakers in California have stepped in to address it. On September 28, the California governor signed a law that requires large companies to make a good-faith effort to connect a caller to a human within 15 minutes. Public prosecutors will enforce it. This move was triggered during the pandemic when a policy maker was put on hold for four hours to procure medicines for his ailing mother.

Meanwhile, Spain has moved the needle more dramatically. Its customer-service law, as one trade source reports, comes into effect on December 28. It insists that 95 per cent of all calls that include essential services and companies which employ over 250 people must answer calls within three minutes if human intervention is called for. This is why what is happening in India deserves scrutiny. The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) released a draft paper earlier this year on May 7 that discussed bringing in human intervention. As things are, it is status quo since the last comments were made in July this year. What makes this worse still is that this paper is the second one on the theme this year. The first was released on March 12.

TRAI's own note says complaints reaching it rose from 44,733 in 2023-24 to 73,081 in 2025-26. But it has no mandate to handle individual complaints. What this means is that people who approached TRAI, knocked on the wrong door. TRAI reads the rise in dissatisfaction as problems with the operators' own systems.

The draft's remedies are real: round-the-clock complaint centres, and a human option on the phone menu. But unlike California or Spain, India's draft does not specify things like the wait times for a human intervention. On penalties, this paper suggests operators be fined ₹1,000. But this money is to be deposited in a government account—and not with the aggrieved customer. What do the operators think of these guidelines? Responses on TRAI's website indicate they want the fines dropped. Airtel wants more time to comply. For complaints that no other TRAI rule covers, the draft gives an operator three days to resolve it. Airtel says that it's too short a time. The company writes this is because some problems need a technician others may need the network checked. A hard deadline, they warn, "may lead to premature closure, repeated reopening, and poorer customer outcomes."

The TRAI draft wants complaint centres open round the clock, up from 8 am to midnight. Operators say no. Airtel argues the phone menu and the app already take complaints at any hour. COAI, the industry body, cites the cost of night shifts. Jio sees no urgency for a human at night, since urgent cases go to the government's Sanchar Saathi portal. The shared argument is that a machine answering counts as access.

Without getting into the minutiae, the operators argue that it is in their own interest to do the best they can for the customers. Both argue that in India, it is easy to lose customers and losing customers is the real penalty. Mumbai-based Varnika Goel, co-founder and CX lead at Twimbit, a research firm, broadly agrees: "I say a lost customer is the right way to see the problem, but don't think it should be left to the market alone"

She warns against over-regulating. Some customers travel, run up a large bill and then complain. No resolution will please them. Regulators, she says, cannot fix that. "If a telco has failed to deliver the right service despite repeated requests, it should not be treated as a routine grievance." Such a complaint, she says, "should be flagged as a kind of complaint that can trigger action."

The draft has no such flag. Jio's filing lists customers who keep re-raising the same issue among its sources of negative feedback. The operator sees noise. The analyst sees the signal. India counts 1.32 billion telecom subscribers. Each will, sooner or later, press 3. When a complaint is closed, the draft requires a survey, scored one to five. But there is no box for "I Gave Up".

HC orders BMC to pay developer ₹1,062 crore more for Oshiwara land acquisition

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The Bombay High Court on Thursday ordered the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) to pay additional compensation of ₹1,062 crore to SN Desai Hospitalities and Developers LLP for acquiring 48,897 square metres of land in Oshiwara and Ambivali for public amenities, including gardens, a recreation ground and a road.

A division bench of justices Manish Pitale and Shreeram Shirsath passed the order after both parties challenged the compensation proceedings. While the civic body had sought to reduce the compensation, the developer had argued that it was entitled to a higher amount.

The dispute dates back to July 2011, when the developer asked the BMC to acquire its land in Oshiwara and Ambivali in Andheri West, as the plots had been reserved for a garden, recreation ground and a 27.45-metre road under Mumbai's 1991 development regulations. The Maharashtra government subsequently issued a notification for their acquisition in June 2012.

On May 3, 2017, the land acquisition officer, a deputy collector, fixed the compensation amount at ₹511.48 crore. Dissatisfied with the amount, the developer approached the high court seeking higher compensation. The case was later transferred to the Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement (LARR) Authority, established under the Right to Fair Compensation and Transparency in Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act, 2013.

On March 30, 2021, the authority increased the total compensation to ₹2,101.2 crore, awarding the developer an additional ₹1,591.12 crore. Both sides then challenged the decision before the high court.

The BMC sought restoration of the original award of ₹511.48 crore, arguing that referring the case to the LARR Authority was legally impermissible. The civic body also raised several other technical grounds to reduce the claim.

The developer, meanwhile, claimed that it was entitled to more compensation than the amount awarded by the authority. It contended that the land's size, location and potential for development should have been considered while determining its market value.

The high court rejected the BMC's objections, but held that the LARR Authority had wrongly calculated the land's value. The court said that the authority had applied the same ready reckoner rate of ₹90,600 per sq m for both parcels of lands. It held that this rate was applicable only to the smaller plot in Oshiwara, measuring 1,895.62 sq m, while the rate for the larger 47,002 sq m plot in Ambivali should be ₹72,100 per sq m.

After recalculating the land valuation, the court held that the developer was entitled to total compensation of ₹1,572 crore. Since the developer had already received around ₹511 crore, the court ordered the civic body to pay the balance of around ₹1,062 crore in 12 weeks.

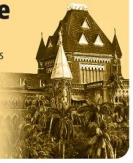
15-year land acquisition dispute

2011 Developer asks BMC to acquire the land reserved for public amenities.

2017 Land acquisition officer (district collector) fixes compensation amount as ₹511.48 crore.

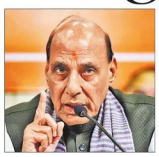
2021 Land Acquisition, Rehabilitation and Resettlement (LARR) Authority enhances compensation to ₹2,101.2 crore.

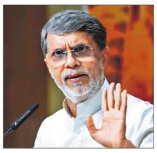
2026 High court revises the total compensation to ₹1,572 crore and orders BMC to pay the balance — ₹1,062 crore.



BJP, Oppn trade barbs over protests against CEC, SIR

Pawan Dixit and Pragati Chawla
letters@hindustantimes.com





Rajnath Singh and Pawan Khera

LUCKNOW/NEW DELHI: Defence minister Rajnath Singh on Friday attacked the Congress over protests against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar and alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, accusing it of trying to seize power by spreading anarchy, even as the Opposition party hit back, saying it wanted to defeat the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) through democratic means and not extra-constitutional methods.

"This fight is not for electoral reforms, not for SIR, not against Gyanesh Kumar, not for bright future of youth. It is a conspiracy to grab power. In democracy there is no licence to spread anarchy and attack constitutional institutions," Singh said while addressing a press conference in Lucknow.

Congress MP Pawan Khera rejected the allegations, accusing the BJP of treating protests as antinational when it faced public criticism. "The BJP is not used to democracy when it is on the receiving end of it. When it has to face the heat of democracy, answer questions and confront protests, democracy suddenly begins to look like treason and anti-national activity to them," he said.

Tens of thousands of people have taken to the streets seeking Kumar's removal and the scrapping of SIR, even as authorities ordered Metro closures, Internet shutdowns, imposed prohibitory orders and deployed 40,000 security personnel to turn Delhi into a virtual fortress. Many protesters were dragged, allegedly manhandled and detained as the ruling BJP accused the Opposition of trying to deflect attention from its electoral failures.

Singh accused the Congress and its allies of seeking a change of government along the lines of Bangladesh, saying they were using the energy of young people to spread anarchy and undermine democratic institutions.

"The youth of the country are being made pawns in the politics of anarchy," he added.

"They openly say at press conferences that they have drawn inspiration from Bangladesh for regime change, while another speaks openly about bringing down the government. This makes it clear that their only agenda is to dismantle democratic institutions and set the country on fire," he said, referring to the uprising in Bangladesh in 2024 that toppled the Sheikh Hasina government.

Khera said the Opposition wanted to change the government through elections, citing the change of government in 1977 after the Emergency. "How does regime change happen in a democracy like India? Through elections. Changing the regime through elections is precisely the Opposition's objective," he said.

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh invoked former president Pranab Mukherjee's words on the Opposition's role. "The Defence Minister needs to be reminded of what the former President Pranab Mukherjee, who was awarded the Bharat Ratna in 2019, would often say: the job of the Opposition in a democracy is to oppose, expose and depose," he said.

Echoing similar sentiments, Samajwadi Party MP Iqra Hasan said, "Look, it is the BJP that is plundering the nation and setting the country ablaze. If they have such a major problem, why are they causing distress to the youth of the entire nation to protect one individual? They should ensure the resignation of that person — Kumar."

Singh, meanwhile, said the Congress was hurting the Constitution, constitutional values and institutions. Referring to the Emergency in 1975, he said, "In 1975 [Prime Minister] Indira Gandhi put democracy behind bars [during the state of Emergency]. Today Rahul Gandhi keeps the Constitution in his pocket and tries to spread anarchy."

BJP president Nitin Nabin echoed Singh's charge, saying the Opposition's use of "regime change" exposed its agenda. "The use of terms like 'regime change' has clearly exposed the true agenda of the opposition before the nation. This nefarious attempt to destabilise India in collusion with foreign powers is part of the agenda of 'urban Naxals'. The opposition's fight is not for electoral reforms, the SIR, or the future of the country's youth, but rather to spread anarchy in the country and seize power at any cost.," he said.

Singh urged Gandhi to introspect and respect constitutional institutions. "We have chosen a path of dialogue, not confrontation, for nation building," he said, adding that democracy did not give anyone a licence to unleash violence.

(With inputs from PTI)

SC TO HEAR PLEA SEEKING F.I.R AGAINST RAHUL ON OCTOBER 26

Abraham Thomas
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday agreed to hear on October 26 an application seeking registration of an FIR against Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi over the alleged pushing and injuring of a pregnant woman journalist during an Opposition march to the court premises on October 12.

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant said the application would be heard alongside other petitions concerning the protests.

The application, filed by advocate Digant Mishra and others, referred to an incident involving Richa Parashar, a journalist with news website OneIndia. The plea alleged she was pushed by Gandhi's security personnel when she approached him for a statement, and later hospitalised.

It also sought preservation of the complete CCTV footage of the gates, steps, driveways and approaches within the Supreme Court premises for October 12, along with access-control logs, entry passes and visitor records for the day. The CJI said the application would be heard along with Mishra's petition, which was heard on Thursday.

{ SEEKS RESPONSE ON TRANSFER PLEA }

Apex court stays Bhopal trial in Twisha death case

Abraham Thomas
letters@hindustantimes.com

Twisha Sharma

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday stayed the trial in the unnatural death case of former model and actor Twisha Sharma in Bhopal and issued notices to the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI), her husband Samarth Singh and mother-in-law Giribala Singh on a plea seeking transfer of the proceedings to Delhi.

A bench of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi passed the order on a petition filed by Twisha's father, Navnidhi Sharma, who expressed apprehension that his daughter would not receive a fair trial in Madhya Pradesh because of the influence wielded by her mother-in-law, a retired district judge.

Navnidhi's lawyers told the court that he sought the transfer as he was based in the Delhi-NCR region. The case is pending before an additional district and sessions judge in Bhopal.

The Supreme Court had taken suo motu cognisance of Twisha's death in May amid concerns over the fairness of the investigation by the Madhya Pradesh Police.

The probe was subsequently transferred to CBI.

Twisha's body was found at her matrimonial home in Bhopal on May 12. Her husband took her to AIIMS Bhopal, where she was declared dead.

Her family alleged that she had faced mental and physical harassment by her husband and his family since their marriage on December 9, 2025. Her in-laws, meanwhile, claimed that she suffered from drug addiction.

CBI subsequently filed a charge sheet against Samarth and Giribala, accusing them of dowry harassment, cruelty and abetment to suicide. The charges include Sections 80(2), 85, 108 and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), along with Sections 3 and 4 of the Dowry Prohibition Act.

CBI dropped the dowry-death charge against Giribala and invoked Section 108 of the BNS, which deals with abetment to suicide. The prosecution alleged that she abetted Twisha's suicide by taunting and harassing her.

The Supreme Court had earlier expressed concern over allegations that the judiciary was "shielding the accused" and said it would ensure a fair, independent and impartial CBI investigation.

Giribala was granted anticipatory bail by the Bhopal trial court on May 15. The Madhya Pradesh government and Twisha's parents challenged the order, which was subsequently set aside by the high court on May 27.

SC issues contempt notices to Raut, Wagle in CJI remarks case

Abraham Thomas
letters@hindustantimes.com

Sanjay Raut

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Friday issued contempt notices to Shiv Sena (UBT) Rajya Sabha MP Sanjay Raut and journalist Nikhil Wagle over their allegedly scandalous social media posts against Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant and the judiciary.

"Issue notice as to why contempt of court proceedings should not be issued against them," said a bench of CJI Surya Kant and Justice Joymalya Bagchi, posting the matter for hearing after two weeks.

It exempted the two from personal appearance, expressing hope that "better sense prevails".

"We are giving a show-cause as of now. Of course we are granting exemption for personal appearance. Let us see," the bench said.

Calling their comments "very unfortunate", the bench said both had approached the court for relief and their pleas had been heard.

The notice followed a petition by the Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA), whose president, senior advocate Pradeep Kumar Rai, sought contempt proceedings, saying the remarks by Raut and Wagle went beyond the bounds of fair criticism and were capable of undermining public confidence in the Supreme Court.

Solicitor general Tushar Mehta supported the plea, saying some people "deliberately" attempted to pressure courts.

The SCBA filed the petition under Article 129 of the Constitution and the Contempt of Courts Act, 1971, after Attorney General R Venkataramani granted consent.

The petition said the posts followed the CJI's refusal to meet Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Mallikarjun Kharge over matters concerning the Election Commission and alleged electoral-roll irregularities.

It also cited Raut's allegations about judges attending ruling-party events. The SCBA called the claims false.

Meanwhile, Wagle on Thursday shared on X a letter addressed to the attorney general in which he tendered an unconditional apology to the CJI and the Supreme Court.

The journalist said he had deleted the earlier post and requested that the contempt matter not be pursued further.

The SCBA has also sought directions to X Corp, Meta, Google and others to preserve relevant posts, videos and account records. It has also sought a direction that Raut and Wagle be restrained from making similar allegations against the CJI and SC judges while the proceedings remain pending.

Concerns over fresh voter declaration misplaced: HC

Shruti Kakkar
shruti.kakkar@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court disposed of a petition filed by two voters whose names were deleted from the electoral rolls after they could not complete the enumeration process during ongoing the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in the Capital, terming their apprehension of being accused of making a false declaration while submitting Form 6 as "misplaced".

Dismissing the petition, a bench of justices Dinesh Mehta and Aditi Chaudhary said that given that the "suggestion is coming from the learned standing counsel appearing for ECI, that too as per the instructions of the Electoral Registration Officer", the petitioner's "apprehension is...misplaced".

Form 6 is the statutory application for fresh inclusion in the electoral roll. It requires an applicant to fill in their personal particulars. However, applicants are also required to affirm that they are applying for inclusion in the electoral roll for the first time. It further brings to the applicant's attention that giving a false declaration can attract penal consequences.

VOTERS' FEAR OF BEING ACCUSED OF MAKING A FALSE DECLARATION WHILE SUBMITTING FORM 6 WAS MISPLACED, THE COURT SAID

In their petition, the two voters said they were not able to fill their enumeration forms because they had shifted out of their old addresses.

They urged the court to direct the ECI to revise the procedure for existing voters who could not complete enumeration, to be able to restore their names in the electoral rolls through Form 8, required for those who want to update their voter ID or electoral roll details, instead of through fresh entries using Form 6.

ECI's lawyer, Sanjay Vashishtha, submitted that the petitioners' grievances could be addressed if they filled out Form 6, as prescribed under the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960.

The voter argued that submitting Form 6 would amount to making a false declaration.

Taking note of ECI's stand, the court said, in its order, "Petitioners, if so desired, may fill Form 6, which shall be processed in accordance with law."

Ladakh adds Sankoo as 8th distt; five new tehsils announced

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

JAMMU: Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena on Friday announced the creation of Sankoo as Ladakh's eighth district and five new tehsils to decentralise administration and improve access to government services.

Carved out of Kargil district, Sankoo will comprise the tehsils of GM Pore, TSG and Taisuru. The announcement comes less than six months after the administration announced five new districts — Changthang, Drass, Nubra, Sham and Zanskar.

Addressing a gathering in Sankoo, Saxena said "The creation of Sankoo district fulfils a long-standing aspiration of the people of the area and marks another important step towards bringing administration closer to citizens. Our objective is to ensure that people in every part of Ladakh can access government services more easily and that the benefits of development reach every village and household. I express my sincere gratitude to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah for their continued support towards the development of Ladakh."

The five new tehsils are Aryan Valley in Sham, Sodh in Kargil, Phey in Zanskar, Thasgam in Drass and Hemya in Changthang.

Their creation follows the announcement of 17 new tehsils on July 12. With the latest additions, Ladakh's total number of tehsils has risen to 37.

Saxena said administrative requirements for the new district would be addressed at the earliest.

LAB, KDA REJECT MHA DRAFT, ALLEGE PUSH FOR OUTDATED MODEL

JAMMU: The Leh Apex Body and Kargil Democratic Alliance on Friday rejected the Union home ministry's draft governance proposal for Ladakh, alleging that officials had proposed an outdated North-East Frontier Agency (NEFA)-style model that would offer fewer powers than the existing hill development councils.

At a joint press conference, LAB and KDA leaders, including Chering Sonjay Lakrook, Sonam Wangchuk and Asghar Karbalai, accused the Centre of backtracking on agreements reached in principle during meetings on May 22 and September 9. "At yesterday's subcommittee meeting in Leh, the MHA officials not only backtracked from minutes of the May 22 meeting but also tried to impose NEFA type model upon us that existed 70 years ago," said Karbalai, KDA co-chairman. Sonam Wangchuk warned that the groups would agitate if necessary to safeguard Ladakh's interests.

RAVI KRISHNAN KHAJURIA

AADHAAR NORMS FOR CHILDREN IN ADOPTION EASED UNDER PM CARES

NEW DELHI: The Centre has eased Aadhaar enrolment and update requirements for children in adoption and institutional care, seeking assistance under the Special Scholarship Scheme under the PM CARES for Children Scheme, allowing alternative documents to be submitted in specified circumstances, according to a notification issued by the ministry of social justice and empowerment.

The notification, published on Wednesday, lays down provisions for Aadhaar-related procedures for children whose biological parents may not be available to provide the documents ordinarily required for enrolment or updates.

Applications for Aadhaar enrolment or updates must be supported by adoption order or other document to evidence legal guardianship.

For children in institutional care, documents by competent authorities will be applicable.

SANJEEV K JHA

RLM MLAs CLOSE RANKS, BACK NDA CANDIDATES

PATNA: Rashtriya Lok Morcha (RLM) rebel leader Ramapukar Sinha on Friday withdrew from the Saran Teachers' Constituency election after filing his nomination, which had led to his six-year suspension from the party. He will now campaign for NDA-backed JD(U) candidate Anand Mishkar.

All three RLM MLAs who had backed Sinha — Madhav Anand, Rameswar Mahto and Alok Singh — also announced their support for NDA candidates, saying their decision was never intended to weaken the alliance.

The party's state president has indicated that Sinha could be reinstated, the MLAs said.

Elections to eight Bihar Legislative Council seats will be held on October 23, with counting scheduled for October 27.

ARUN KUMAR

HC permits RSS marches across TN, criticises police

Ayesha Arvind
letters@hindustantimes.com

BENGALURU: The Madras high court on Friday permitted the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) to conduct route marches across Tamil Nadu on October 25 and November 1, while criticising the state police for repeatedly rejecting applications on grounds that the court had already disapproved.

A bench of justice V Lakshminarayanan directed the police to coordinate with RSS organisers and finalise the timings and locations of the marches and subsequent public meetings by Monday, October 19.

"One thing must be said to the credit of the Tamil Nadu police. They have not come up with any novel reasons for rejection. They have consistently given the very reasons which this Court found as lame," justice Lakshminarayanan said.

The court was hearing a petition by RSS north Tamil Nadu secretary VG Jagadeesan, who through senior advocate NL Rajah, had challenged police orders denying permission for the organisation's annual route marches and public meetings as part of its Vijayadashami celebrations.

The RSS had sought permission for processions on October 18, 25, and November 1 as alternative dates. The state police rejected the applications citing places of worship belonging to other communities along the proposed routes, statues of rationalist leaders, traffic congestion, loudspeakers and possible law and order problems.

The court noted that it had considered and disapproved these grounds in earlier proceedings.

It noted that the RSS had been moving the court for permission for route marches since 2022. It referred to its previous decisions recognising the RSS's right to conduct route marches, subject to lawful restrictions. The high court also cited a 2023 order one of its benches had passed saying that public roads remain secular spaces accessible to everyone irrespective of religion, caste or creed. "It is a classic case of using a scalpel, not for the purpose of an operation, but to kill the patient on whom the operation is sought to be performed," the high court said.

HC STAYS ORDER ALLOWING CPI(M) TO SET UP BOOKSTALL

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

KOLKATA: A division bench of the Calcutta high court on Friday stayed an order a single-judge bench passed 24 hours earlier to let the Communist Party of India (Marxist) set up a bookstall in North 24 Parganas district's Bongaon during the Durga Puja festival, lawyers who attended the hearing said.

The division bench, which allowed the single bench to hear the CPI(M)'s petition on Thursday, ruled on Friday that roadside stalls can operate only with permission from competent authorities.

The division bench of chief justice Ravindra V Ghuge and justice Shabbar Rashidi ruled that the CPI(M) cannot set up a stall stall outside its party office on Jessore Road ordering a stay on justice Sougata Bhattacharya's single bench order.

{ TILL CAA CASE IS HEARD }

HC directs govt not to deport B'deshi woman

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

KOLKATA: The Calcutta high court on Thursday directed the Centre and the West Bengal government not to deport a Bangladeshi woman, who entered India in 2011 out of fear of religious persecution, till her application for Indian citizenship is disposed of.

Around 230,000 applications under the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019, are pending in West Bengal, chief minister Suvendu Adhikari said in August.

"The appellant shall not be deported to her country Bangladesh till her application for Indian citizenship is disposed of," stated the order passed by the bench of justice Jay Sengupta. The bench ordered that Oishe Biswas, 23, be shifted to a holding centre after completing her prison sentence on October 21, or earlier, if released, and be provided necessary amenities.

"She was arrested from Gaighata in North 24 Parganas under sections 14 and 14(C) of the Foreigners Act, and sent to jail. She is now lodged in the correctional home," said a lawyer aware of the developments.

Biswas, who married and settled in North 24 Parganas, was arrested in 2024 under the Foreigners Act. In January 2025, a court sentenced her to two years in prison and fined her ₹10,000. She applied for citizenship under the CAA in September while in jail.

The CAA provides a fast-track route to citizenship for eligible Hindus, Sikhs, Buddhists, Jains, Parsis and Christians from Bangladesh, Pakistan and Afghanistan who entered India by December 31, 2024.

BJP working group to fine tune Gen Z outreach

Sunetra Choudhury
letters@hindustantimes.com

Ravi Kishan and Smriti Irani

NEW DELHI: The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) has put together a new 80-member internal working group to fine tune its strategy and messaging for Gen Z, people aware of developments said on Friday, adding that plans by the team were already incorporated in the party's efforts to push back against ongoing street protests.

Gorakhpur MP Ravi Kishan, New Delhi MP Bansuri Swaraj, Bengaluru South MP Tejaswi Surya, Vadodara MP Hemang Joshi and Bharatiya Janata Party general secretary Smriti Irani are part of the team's deliberations – called yuva samvad (youth dialogue), said the people cited above.

The team – guided by Union youth affairs minister Mansukh Mandaviya – is divided into six working groups and met thrice in the last few months to prepare an extensive report, which explores questions such as – Do the young connect to Hindutva? What kind of language should be used to communicate with them? Should the term Gen Z be used?

The development was prompted by the party's miscalculation of the scale and reach of the July student protests against examination paper leaks, which eventually forced the resignation of the then Union education minister, said the people cited above.

"I've been saying you just have to be yourself. If you make mistakes, it doesn't matter. You have to own up to it but make sure you don't repeat them," Kishan told HT, when asked about his suggestions. In recent months, Bhojpuri actor Kishan has become an internet sensation with Netflix shows, podcasts and reels.

The party's youngest president, 45-year-old Nitin Nabin, presided over the first meeting and heard many suggestions, some of which have now been effected as part of the BJP strategy.

One such instance was in deciding the party strategy on countering the Opposition protests. The working group concluded that if the Opposition protest had 10,000 people showing up, the government's protest must have a much bigger show of strength, say 50,000.

This week, when Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and others were marching towards the Supreme Court, the BJP was organising protests in Gujarat, Assam and other parts of the country against Gandhi. They alleged that Gandhi was ignoring sexual harassment allegations against Congress MP Bimol Akoijam, who was removed as a professor at Jawaharlal Nehru University.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi's September 8 meeting in Vadodara was one of the first events held after these deliberations. Party leaders played a mix of Queen's We Will Rock You and tracks from blockbuster Dhurandhar, while Modi walked along a long L-shaped stage, generating reels for the party.

The working group also preferred using more Indian names for Gen Z, such as yuva or youth, and touched upon young people's views on Hindutva. "They are born Hindu so I don't think there's any need to stress on it," said Kishan, adding, "It's better to focus on spiritual power and sanskar (tradition)."

"You have to credit the BJP with the fact that they are acknowledging that something needs to be done," said one of the coordinators of the meeting, refusing to speak on record.

HT reached out to Mandaviya whose office confirmed his role. but said he was too busy to speak about it. All other leaders said they played minor roles and only gave suggestions when asked for it. "They wanted to know what young people are thinking about in our constituency," said one MP, who didn't want to be quoted. He had attended one of these meetings.

In the coming days, the team might reach out to two specific groups – fence-sitters or neutral observers, and young women. "Women are half the population, we must talk to them," said Kishan. It's something the other side is doing too.

During the Opposition rally last Monday, Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra were surrounded by Gen Z women leaders such as Neha Bora, Aishe Ghosh and Jannat Bishnoi.

कार्यालय नगर निगम जयपुर

पश्चिम रीनपास उपाध्याय भवन, जालकोरी, जयपुर
क्रमांक :– जसा / 2026 / 259 दिनांक: 13.10.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना क्रमांक :- 20/2026-27

OPERATION AND MAINTENANCE OF 07 No's VEHICLE MOUNTED VACUUM BASED LITTER PICKER AS PER TENDER CONDITIONS हेतु पंजीकृत फर्म्स से ई–निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा प्रपत्र, विस्तृत सूचना एवं शर्तें आदि सम्पूर्ण विवरण वेबसाइट www.jaipurmc.org, www.sppp.raj.nic.in and www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in पर स्टेट पब्लिक प्रोक्यूरमेन्ट के **UBN No. JMC2627WSOB00527** पर देखी जा सकती है।

अधिशाषण अभियन्ता (गैराज)
राज.संवाद / वी / 26 / 12116 नगर निगम जयपुर

भारतीय विज्ञान शिक्षा एवं अनुसंधान संस्थान मोहाली

(शिक्षा मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार के अधीन)
सेक्टर–81, नॉलेज सिटी, पो.ओ. मानौली, एस.ए.एस. नगर, मोहाली, पंजाब–140306
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF SCIENCE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH MOHALI
(Ministry of Education, Govt. of India)
Sector-81, Knowledge city, PO-Manauli, SAS Nagar Mohali-140306, Punjab
PAN No.- AAAAI1781K GST No. 03AAAAI1781K2ZS
• Phone : +91-172- 2240121, 124, Extn: 1127 • Fax : +91-172-2240124
• http://www.iisermohali.ac.in • Email: tenders@iisermohali.ac.in/Institute Website

NOTICE INVITING TENDER Date : 17.10.2026

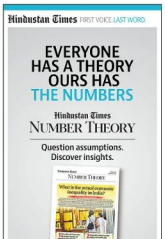
Sr. No.	Tender Ref. No.	Description	Type of Tender	Last date & time for upload of tender
01	IISER M/1716-2/26/27Pur	Catering Service for Hostel Mess No. 6 and 8 on Pay and Eat basis in IISER Mohali	Domestic Tender	02.11.2026 up to 2.30 PM
02	IISER M/1724-2/26/27-Pur-GTE	Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of Maskless Direct-Write Lithography System with accessories	Global Tender	11.11.2026 up to 2.30 PM
03	IISER M/1725-2/26/27-Pur-GTE	Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of Cryogen free platform for the measurement of physical properties under varying Magnetic fields and Temperature	Global Tender	11.11.2026 up to 2.30 PM

For details and apply online, for participation, please visit the website **"http://www.iisermohali.ac.in"** https://eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app सहायक कुलसचिव (क्रय तथा भंडार)

WESTERN RAILWAY
PAY AND USE NORMAL TOILET BLOCKS

E-auction for the contract for operation and maintenance of Normal Pay and use toilet blocks over Mumbai Division has been invited by **ACM (R) - MMCT**. **Auction Catalogue No: MMCT-PnUT-26-33. Type of Contract:** ROMT-contract. **Category:** Pay and Use Toilet blocks. **Station and Location:** ROMT - Deluxe/Modern Standard Pay & Use Toilet Complex at Borivali station (SG-1) west circulating area. **Contract Period**: 10 Years. **Date of E-Auction:** 29.10.2026. **Time of E-Auction:**15:00 hrs. **Note:** Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction leasing module on IREPS website **(www.ireps.gov.in)** The lot wise details are available there in under the mentioned catalogue. Initial cooling off period is 30 minutes. Successive Lot closing interval is 10 Minutes. Lot wise closing times can be viewed in e-auction module of IREPS. 0716

Like us on: facebook.com/WesternRly

Hindustan Times FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.
EVERYONE HAS A THEORY OURS HAS THE NUMBERS
Hindustan Times NUMBER THEORY
Question assumptions. Discover insights.

LOOK FOR NUMBER THEORY IN HINDUSTAN TIMES

WESTERN RAILWAY
RATLAM DIVISION
E-AUCTION NOTICE

E-Auction for the contract of Non-Fare Revenue (NFR) at various location of Ratlam Division has been invited. The Catalogue has already been published on **www.ireps.gov.in**. The details are furnished as under. **Auction Catalogue No.:** ADVT-RTM-26-35 **Type of Contract:** Advertising **Lot No. :** ADVT-RTM-LMNR-OSN-174-26-1 (Advertising - On Station Premise (Non-Digital) / ADVT-RTM-RJQ-OSN-175-26-1 (Advertising - On Station Premise (Non-Digital) **Contract Period :** 05 Years **Date of E-Auction :** 30.10.2026 **Time :** 12.00. Initial cooling off period is 30 minutes. Successive Lot Closing Interval is 10 minutes. Lot wise closing time can be viewed in E-Auction module of IREPS.
Apasc/300

Like us on: facebook.com/WesternRly

WESTERN RAILWAY
SIGNALLING WORK

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer (South), 2nd Floor, Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Mumbai Central, Mumbai-400 008, invites **E-Tender No: W_468_2025_VR_SG_WA Dated: 14/10/2026. Name of Work:** Signalling work in connection with Improvement & Upgradation of Yards at Virar station of Mumbai Division Western Railway. **Approx. Cost of Work:** ₹.1,41,03,015.09. **EMD:** ₹.2,82,100/-. **Date & Time for Closure for Submission of E-Tender Documents:** Till 05.11.2026,15:00 hrs. **Date & Time for Opening of E-Tender:** On 05.11.2026 at 15:30 hrs. The tender can be viewed at website **www.ireps.gov.in** 0711

Like us on: facebook.com/WesternRly

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA **25001/1354/2627**
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, SAMBALPUR
E-Mail - serwcirclesbp@yahoo.com

E-PROCUREMENT NOTICE
BID IDENTIFICATION NO. PMGSY ONLINE RWCSBP-28 / 2026-27

1. Name of the Work :- Road Works
2. Total No. of works :- 01 no Road work
3. Estimated cost :- Rs.192.97 lakhs
4. Class of contractor :- 'B' & 'A'
5. Other details :- As mentioned in DTCN

Procurement Officer	Procurement Officer	Availability of Tender On-line for bidding	
		From	To
1	2	3	4
Chief Construction Engineer, Rural Works Circle, Sambalpur.	PMGSY ONLINE RWCSBP-28 / 2026- 27	27.10.2026 11.00 A.M	12.11.2026 05.00 P.M

Further details can be seen from the website **www.pmgsytenders.gov.in**

Chief Construction Engineer
Rural Works Circle, Sambalpur
OIPR - 25001/25091/1/26-27/0036

25001/1356/2627

ग्रुप सिर्कल वर्क्स अर्थोरटी, बुहाम
(ओफिस ऑफ दि चीफ कंस्ट्रक्शन इंजिनियर, बेरहमपुर, गंजाम, ओडिशा)
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, RURAL WORKS CIRCLE, BERHAMPUR
(At/Po :- Ambapua, Near Income Tax office, Berhampur-760011, Ganjam, Odisha)
(E-Mail:- serwbpr2004@yahoo.com . Tel/Fax:- 0680-2404287)

E-Mail / E-despatch

NO. e-tender // 6213 // RWC // BAM // Date. 16.10.26
2nd Corrigendum to Bid Identification No. Online Tender/16-2026-27/BPR

1) The partial modification of Road works under MMSY-IMPVT. TO EXISTING RD ROADS for the year 2024-25 & 2025-26 & MUKHYA MANTRI SADAK YOJANA (MMSY) for the year 2026-27 vide above identification has been made as follows

1	Date of availability of tender	: 03.11.2026 upto 5.30 PM instead of 26.10.2026 upto 5.30 PM.
2	Last Date & Time of seeking tender clarification	: **02.11.2026 at 5.30 PM instead of 23.09.2026 at 5.30 PM**
3	Date of opening of Technical Bid.	: 04.11.2026 at 11.00 AM instead of 27.10.2026 at 11.00 AM
4	Date of opening of Financial Bid	: Will be intimated later on.

All other contents will remain unchanged

Chief Engineer,
R.W. Circle, Berhampur
OIPR - 25001/2507/1/1/26-27/0042

एम एम आर डी ए MUMBAI METROPOLITAN REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
MMRDA
(A Government of Maharashtra Undertaking)

7th floor, Transportation & Communication Division, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai – 400 051.
Tel. 022-65967511 / 7556, **Fax:** 26594139.
Email : siddharth.gondhale@mailmmrda.maharashtra.gov.in **web:** https://mmrda.maharashtra.gov.in

e-Tender Notice

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Cost of Blank Tender Form (Per work)	Bid Document Download		Last Date of Online Submission	Contract Period
			From Date/Time	To Date/Time		
1)	Appointment of Contractor for Construction of Foot Over Bridge Connecting Vikhroli Metro Station & Kanjurmarg Railway Station – Part A at Metro Stations of Mumbai Metro Line-6	₹ 5000/- Plus 18% GST	17/10/2026 (18.01 Hrs)	12/11/2026 (18.00 Hrs)	12/11/2026 (18.00 Hrs)	24 Months (including monsoon period) + 60 Months DLP (Including monsoon period)
2)	Appointment of Contractor for Construction of Foot Over Bridge Connecting Jogeshwari Metro Station & Jogeshwari Railway Station – Part B at Metro Stations of Mumbai Metro Line-6					

Note: The e-Tender can be downloaded from e-Tendering portal: **https://mahatenders.gov.in/nicgep/app** For any additional information, corrigendum and help for uploading and downloading the e-Tender, you may contact e-tendering service desk at the following id: **support-eproc@nic.in, mahatender@mailmmrda.maharashtra.gov.in** or call us on **022-65967511 / 7556.**

Sd/-
Chief (a/c)
Transport & Communications Division
Date: 17/10/2026
Place: Bandra (E), Mumbai

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA **25001/1344/2627**
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER
RURAL WORKS CIRCLE BOLANGIR
e Procurement Notice

1.	Name of work	: Construction of Road works under MMSY/TRIP Scheme in the district of Subarnapur for the year 2026-27
2.	No. of works	: 5(Five) works
3.	Time for completion	: 9 (Nine) Calendar months
4.	Approximate estimated cost varies from	: Rs. 296.42 lakhs to Rs. 499.25 lakhs
5.	Mode of Submission of tender	: Tender should be submitted online in www.tendersodisha.gov.in
6.	**Other details are as follow**	

Procurement Officer	Bid Identification No	Availability of tender On-line for bidding		Last Date & Time of seeking Tender Clarification	Date & time of opening of tender	
		From	To		Technical Bid	Financial Bid
Chief Construction Engineer, R.W. Circle, Bolangir	BLGR-Online-25/2026-27	28.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M	11.11.26 upto 5.00 P.M.	10.11.2026 upto 5.00 P.M	12.11.2026 at 11.00 A.M.	The date will be intimated later on

* Further details can be seen from the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in**
* Any Corrigendum/Addendum will be displayed in the above e tender website only.

Chief Construction Engineer,
R.W. Circle, Bolangir
OIPR - 25001/25118/1/26-27/0027

WESTERN RAILWAY
CONTRACT WORK FOR PROVISION OF MANPOWER FOR TRAIN PASSING ACTIVITIES

Sr.DME(Co.)/Mumbai Central invites **Tender Notice No: Mech-TPA-2026 Dtd.14.10.2026. Name of Work:** Contract work for provision of manpower for Train passing activities at Coaching Depots-Mumbai Central, Bandra Terminus, Jogeshwari (AT), Vasai Road, Valsad, Bilimora, Udhna Junction, Surat & Nandurbar for a period of 4 (four years) due to shortage of manpower for core Train maintenance (Primary & Secondary). **Approx. Cost of Work:** ₹.52,26,15,823.34 (All inclusive). **Bid Security:** ₹.27,63,100/-. **Tender Submission Closing Date & Time:** On 12.11.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. For further details please visit our website **www.ireps.gov.in** 0713

Like us on: facebook.com/WesternRly

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

e-Tender Notice No. E-E70-BRAKEPANEL-2026-27 dated 13.10.2026. For and on behalf of the President of India, Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/RS-PQ(W)/KGP, S. E. Railway invites e-tender for the following work before 15.00 hrs. on the date mentioned against item and will be opened at 15.30 hrs. **Name of the work :** Repair/Rehabilitation of E-70 Brake Panel of 3-Phase Electric locomotive. **Approx. Cost of work :** ₹.4,27,45,103.94 including GST@18%. **Quantity :** 22 No. Loco. **Earnest Money :** ₹.8,54,900.00. **Date & time of closing e-tender :** 10.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs. **Website particular : www.ireps.gov.in** Interested Tenderers may visit **www.ireps.gov.in** for full details/description/specification of the tender and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for this work will be accepted. **(PR-907)**

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

Tender No. : SER-OL-HQ-TR-W-USFD-09-26. Dy.Chief Engineer/Line, South Eastern Railway, Kolkata, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites Open E-Tender for the following work : **Name of the Work:** Ultrasonic Testing of Rails including through testing of Rails and welds with contractor's own B-Scan Machines equipped with 9 channels SRT/DRT and two extra 37 degree probes and Operators on nominated routes over South Eastern Railway including hand probing (flange testing) of welds as per Indian Railway Standard Specification for Ultrasonic Testing of Rails/Welds, Revised-2020 (Document No. T-53) and Manual for Ultrasonic testing of Rails and Welds, Revised 2022 (with latest amendment) issued by RDSO. **Approx. Cost of the Work:** ₹.6,02,27,220.09. **Earnest Money:** ₹.12,04,600.00. **Date and time of Closing of Tender:** 12.11.2026 at 15:00 Hrs. **Website particulars:** Complete details for e-tendering and online participation for the above work are on website **www.ireps.gov.in** **(PR-911)**

CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE

Digitally signed online open E-Tenders are invited by Sr. DEE/TRD/Nagpur, from established Contractors for execution of the following work on Nagpur Division of Central Railway. **E-Tender Notice No.:** NGP-ELECT-TRD-2026-27-14, dated 13.10.2026. **Name of work:** Bonding & Measurement of Contact Wire Height after Engineering Track Machine working in connection with CTR (P), TRR (P), TBR (P), TSR (P) & TFTR under Nagpur Division of Central Railway. **Estimated Cost of work:** ₹.2,62,59,615.24/- (Rs. Two Crore, Sixty Two Lakh, Fifty Nine Thousand, Six Hundred Fifteen & Twenty Four Paise Only). **Earnest Money Deposit:** ₹.5,25,200.00/- (Rs. Five Lakh, Twenty Five Thousand, Two Hundred Only). **Last Date & Time for submission of tender:** 16.11.2026 at 15.00 Hrs. **Web site address:** The relevant details about this E-Tender & online participation in E-tendering are available on Railway website **www.ireps.gov.in**
EXP/95/471 *Sr. DEE(TRD), Nagpur*

RailMadad Helpline 139

DIRECTORATE OF INDUSTRY, CHHATTISGARH

Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No. 1,Telibandha, Raipur (C.G.) – 492 006
Phone: (0771) 2583652-54

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

For establishment, through private investment, of (1) Mini-Mall with Multiplex and (2) Private CBSE School

EOI No. 01/DOI/Mini-Mall/2026 and 02/DOI/CBSE-School/2026 Raipur, dated 16.10.2026

Under the Industrial Development Policy 2024-30, the State Government has notified the Chhattisgarh Mini-Mall Investment Promotion Rules, 2025 (Notification No. GENS-2101/5153/2025-COMM. & INDUS. dated 14.10.2025) and the Rules for promotion of private investment in schools (Notification No. GENS-2101/5121/2025-COMM. & INDUS. dated 14.10.2025). Expressions of Interest are hereby invited from interested private investors for the in-principle approval of investment promotion under the Industrial Development Policy 2024-30 on establishment of the following projects:–

EOI-1: Mini-Mall with Multiplex	EOI-2: Private CBSE School
• Carpet area of not less than 8,000 sq. ft. (excluding common area and parking)	• School from class 1 to class 12 recognised by the CBSE
• Multiplex with screen of minimum 35 ft. x 16 ft. and minimum 100 seats	• Minimum capacity of 500 students
• Minimum 5 retail stores in addition to the food court, parking and fire safety mandatory	• In an unserved urban area or within a radius of 10 km from a development-block headquarters
• Minimum fixed capital investment of ₹5.00 crore, excluding cost of land	• Hostel, library, smart class, laboratories and sports facilities in the premises
• On leased land/building, lease period of not less than 11 years	• CBSE recognition up to class 12 within 5 years of first operation
• Incentives — full stamp duty exemption, 100% exemption in diversion fee, reimbursement of land registration fee and infrastructure grant	• Incentives — investment promotion under Annexure 7/8 of the Industrial Development Policy 2024-30

Eligible districts and blocks

Mini-Mall: Khairagarh-Chhuikhadan-Gandai (Khairagarh, Chhuikhadan), Koriya (Sonhat), Balrampur (Balrampur, Ramchandrapur, Ramanujganj, Wadraifnagar, Rajpur, Kusmi, Shankargarh), Kondagaon (Kondagaon, Farasgaon, Keshkal, Baderajpur, Makdi), Manendragarh-Bharatpur-Chirmiri (Manendragarh, Bharatpur, Khadgawan), Kabirdham (Kawardha, Pandariya, Bodla, Sahaspur Lohara), Gariaband (Gariaband, Chhura, Mainpur, Devbhog, Fingeshwar), Narayanpur (Narayanpur, Orchha), Mohla-Manpur-Ambagarh Chowki (Mohla, Ambagarh Chowki, Manpur), Dhamtari (Dhamtari, Nagri, Magarlod, Kurud), Rajnandgaon (Chhuriya, Dongargaon, Dongargarh), Sukma (Sukma, Konta, Chintalgarh), Raigarh (Pusour, Kharsiya, Lailunga, Gharghoda and Dharamjaygarh).

In each eligible block one application (H-1) will be approved.

CBSE School: Khairagarh-Chhuikhadan-Gandai (Chhuikhadan), Koriya (Sonhat, Patna), Kondagaon (Kondagaon, Farasgaon, Keshkal, Baderajpur, Makdi), Surajpur (Premnagar, Ramanujnagar), Manendragarh-Bharatpur-Chirmiri (Bharatpur, Khadgawan), Kabirdham (Sahaspur Lohara, Bodla, Pipariya), Gariaband (Fingeshwar), Narayanpur (Orchha), Mohla-Manpur-Ambagarh Chowki (Mohla, Ambagarh Chowki, Manpur), Dhamtari (Magarlod), Rajnandgaon (Chhuriya), Sukma (Sukma, Konta, Chintalgarh).

In each eligible block maximum 3 application (based on proposed investment) will be approved.

How to apply

Applications shall be submitted ONLY online through the Single Window System at **https://invest.cg.gov.in**. The applicant shall upload two PDF documents — Document-1 (Pre-Qualification, not password protected) and Document-2 (Financial, password protected). The password of Document-2 shall be sent by the applicant from the registered e-mail address to **invest-support@cg.gov.in**. Applications received by post, by hand or by e-mail shall not be entertained.

Important dates (same for both EOIs)

Particulars	Date and time
Pre-application (pre-bid) meeting — Udyog Bhawan, Raipur (Hybrid Mode)	22.10.2026, 11.30 A.M. and 29.10.2026, 11.30 AM
Commencement of online submission of application on **invest.cg.gov.in**	23.10.2026, 10.00 A.M.
Last date and time for online submission	07.12.2026, up to 5.30 PM.
Last date for sending the password of Document-2 (After closing of application window)	14.12.2026, up to 5.30 PM.
Meeting of SLC for approval	Date will be published on **invest.cg.gov.in**

Note: The detailed terms of the EOIs, the complete list of eligible locations and the annexures are available at **https://invest.cg.gov.in**. Applicants are advised to read the relevant Rules and the EOI document before applying. Every corrigendum or amendment will be published on that website only. Contact: (0771) 2583652-54, e-mail: **invest-support@cg.gov.in**

Additional Director, Industries
Chhattisgarh, Raipur
G-26270401 1/3

TENDER
Sale of Scrap
HT Media Group
E-Waste Equipment (AC, LT Panel, UPS & Others)

Asset	Make	Quantity
RDS	Innovonics RDS	1
Patch Panel	AVR PATCHING SYSTEMS	1
Sound card	Midiman	1
Amplifier	Hafler	1
Digital Detangler	Zsys	1
Remote control	Zsys	1
Delay Unit	Eventide	1
Audio Processor	Telos	1
Hybrid Engine	Telos	1
Firewall	Sonicwall	3
Sound card	Focusrite	1
Audio Mixer	Behringer Ultralink Pro	1
Tuner	Dennon	1
Distribution Amplifier	Behringer Power Play Pro-8	1
Audio Distribution	Telos	1
Audio Codec	Sonifex	1
Audio Codec	Netstar	1
Sound card	Focusrite	1
Router	Maipu	1
Mixer Amplifier	Bosch	1
Switch	Cisco Systems	1
Hybrid Engine	Telos	1
Pcom	Pcom	1
Pcom	Pcom	1
Hybrid Engine	Telos	1
Router	Router	1
Sound card	Sound craft	1
Router	Techroutes	1
Digital Maximizer	T. C. Electronic	1
Router	Techroutes	1
Audio Codec	CCS Musicam	2
Digital Audio Monitor	Wohler	1
HDSL	PairGain	1
RDS	Innovonics	1
Speaker	Yamaha	2
Speaker	Tannoy	2
Thruline Wattmeter	Bird	1
Epabx	Alacatel	1
Radio Reciever	Panasonic	2
Audio Processor	Telos	1
Distribution Amplifier	Behringer Power Play Pro-8	1
Distribution Amplifier	Behringer Power Play Pro-8	1
Hotkey keyboard	Tipro	3
Handset	Telos	2
Vaccum	Eureka Forbes	1
Audio Mixer	Yamaha	1
PA Module	Broadcast Electronics	2
Dummy Load	Electro Impulse	1
Main LT Panel	Local Make	1
UPS Panel	Local Make	1
Air conditioner 3 ton	Bluestar	4
UPS	Emerson Liebert	1
SMPS	Compaq	1
Digital Audio Tape Deck	Tascam	1
Home Theater	Sony	1
Speaker	Sony	1
Digital Amplifier	Sony S-master	1
Air conditioner 5.5 ton	Hitachi	3
Surge Suppresor	Lea International	1
Main LT Panel	Local Make	2
Battery	Rocket	2
UPS-60 KVA	Liebert	1

Address: Doordarshan Kendra, Worli, Radio One and Radio Nasha CTI rooms, Mumbai.

Terms & Conditions

For inspection, please contact **Mr. Rakesh (9910056518)** or **Mr. Sumit (9619405522)** at the **Doordarshan Kendra, Worli, Radio One and Radio Nasha CTI rooms, Mumbai.**

Inspection Date: 19.10.2026, between 11 am and 4 pm.

1. GST will be charged extra. Only the basic price will be accepted.
2. The tender must be accompanied by an interest-free, refundable **Security Deposit of Rs 25,000/-** in the form of a Demand Draft in favour of "Next Radio Limited", payable at New Delhi.
3. Items must be lifted only after depositing 100% advance payment, including GST.
4. Next Radio Limited reserves the right to reject any or all tenders without assigning any reason whatsoever.
5. The successful tenderer shall remove the equipment (AC, LT Panel and others) within 2 days of confirmation from Next Radio Limited, at their own cost, using their own staff. The e-waste equipment is offered on an "AS IS WHERE IS" basis.
6. The tenderer shall follow all security and safety measures as per the law, regulations and building norms, and shall comply with the workmen's policy and safety norms.
7. Next Radio Limited will not be responsible for any mishap or claim suffered by any workman or staff of the tenderer.
8. **Last date for submission of tender: 21.10.2026.**

SLUM REHABILITATION AUTHORITY, BRIHANMUMBAI

No. SRA/ADMIN/Desk-I/T-2/923/2026 **Date: 16.10.2026**

ADVERTISEMENT FOR RECRUITMENT

As per Government of Maharashtra, General Administration Department, Government Resolution dated **10.06.2025,** it is proposed to appoint the following officers in temporary manner on contract basis for 11 months in the Slum Rehabilitation Authority.

Sr.No.	Designation	No. of Posts	Qualifications
1	Junior Geologist	1	Should be a retired Government and Semi Government Geologist.

Qualification and Experience:-

1. The candidate's age should not be more than 65 years as on 01.10.2026.
2. The retired officer should be physically, mentally and healthily fit.
3. No departmental inquiry proceedings should be pending or proposed against the retired officer or no punishment should have been awarded in such inquiry case.
4. Eligible candidates should submit their applications along with necessary documents by 26.10.2026 at the Slum Rehabilitation Authority, Brihanmumbai Administrative Building, Prof. Anant Kanekar Marg, Bandra East, Mumbai-400 051. or the application should be sent to the e-mail ID of this office.
5. Remuneration/salary will be paid as per the government Resolution.
6. The rights are reserved to increase, decrease and cancel the said posts while implementing the said recruitment process.

Sd/-
(Dattu Nawale)
Secretary
Place :- Mumbai **Slum Rehabilitation Authority, Brihanmumbai**

Administrative Building, Prof. Anant Kanekar Marg, Bandra (East), Mumbai-400 051.
Tel.: 022-2656 5800/6912 5800 Email: info@sra.gov.in

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Website: www.ner.indianrailways.gov.in, Email: cos@ner.railnet.gov.in
Tender Notice No.-14, Date 15-10-2026

Invitation of tenders through e-Procurement System

Principal Chief Material Manager, North Eastern Railway, Gorakhpur-273012 and on behalf of the President of India, invites tenders through e-procurement system for the supply of the following items. Complete description of the item and other condition are available on website ***www.ireps.gov.in***

Item No.	Tender Number	Due on	Brief Description of Stores	Qty.
1	22261773	15-12-2026	Secondary spring inner for Non AC etc	228 Nos.
2	24265006	30-11-2026	2 X 130 KVA Static Converter etc.	20 Nos.
3	24261159	23-11-2026	Oil Cooler radiator 165 KW etc	27 Nos.
4	22261445	19-11-2026	Circuit board MB04B for LHB coaches etc	52 Nos.
5	22261703	17-11-2026	Distributor Valve including Adapter etc.	193 Nos.
6	26255133B	16-11-2026	Elastic Rail Clip(ERC) J Clip Etc.	61714 Nos.
7	24260295	13-11-2026	AOH Kit for ELGI Compressor etc	225 Nos.
8	24261130	10-11-2026	IOH Kit for Pantograph Assly Type IR-03H etc.	78 Sets.
9	26265190	10-11-2026	Composite Grooved Rubber Etc	2911094 Nos.
10	26265187	10-11-2026	Nylon Cord Reinforced GRSP etc	5549 Sets.
11	30260518G	06-11-2026	Hermitically Sealed Scroll Compressor etc.	192 Nos.
12	28261954	03-11-2026	Inj. Insulin degludec (r-DNA origin) etc	4182 Nos.
13	26265061C	31-10-2026	Elastic Rail Clip (ERC) etc	5103843 Nos.
14	26265061B	30-10-2026	Elastic Rail Clip (ERC) etc	3382362 Nos.

CPRO/S-74 **Principal Chief Material Manager, Gorakhpur**

Never travel on roof and foot boards.

GOVERNMENT OF CHHATTISGARH
WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
WATER RESOURCES DIVISION, KORBA (C.G.)

e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
eProcurement Portal: https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in
(FIRST CALL)

NIT No.: 05/SAC/2026-27 **Dated: 14.10.2026**

Online Tenders are invited for the following works up to 04.11.2026 at 1730 Hour

System Tender No. NIT. No/Date	Name Of Work	Amount
System No.-201537	**Construction of Lemru Anicut Scheme on Chornai River.**	**Rs. 990.31 Lakhs** (Excluding GST) **Tender Invited As Per S.O.R. Dated 01.05.2025 amended on dated 08.08.2025**

The details can be viewed and downloaded online directly from the Government of Chhattisgarh Integrated e-Procurement Portal **(https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in)** from **Date 21.10.2026, at 1731 Hours. (IST) onwards.**

NOTE:- All eligible/interested contractors/bidders are mandated to get enrolled on the Integrated e-procurement portal **(https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in)** and get approval on specific vendor class from PWD under Centralized Contractor/Supplier Registration in order to download the tender documents and participate in the subsequent bidding process.

Sd/- **Executive Engineer**
Water Resources Division
Korba (C.G)
G-262703987/4

HT Classifieds (Saturday)
www.htclassifieds.com

NOTICES

AUCTION NOTICES

E- AUCTION NOTICE
(ACCIDENTAL DAMAGED 13 NOS. OF TATA VEHICLES TO BE SOLD AS SCRAP AND CANNOT BE REGISTERED)

E- Auction forms are invited from interested buyers for disposal, strictly on "As Is Where Is" basis, on **"LUMP-SUM" BASIS,** for Accidental Damaged 13 Nos. of Tata Vehicles bearing Chassis Nos. as mentioned below To Be Sold As Scrap And Cannot Be Registered **(Form No. 21 & 22 will not be provided)** belonging to M/s. The New India Assurance Company Limited. Salvage of the above materials can be inspected as mentioned below between **17-10-26 to 27-10-26**, after taking prior appointment from respective inspection details below.

1.Chassis No. MAT632241RLH13080, MAT876040TAE84233, MAT876301AFB97068, MAT876301TAE69927, MAT627505SAG62425, MAT627631SAG62607, MAT627612SAG62007, MAT878024SANB4428, MAT635345TAE78998, MAT879029TAF96169, MAT635347TAGA3984, MAT876004TAE73312, MAT876009TAE75923 Address – **M/s. Tata Passenger Electric Mobility Limited,** 6, Village Northkotpura, Taluka Sanand, Dist. Ahmedabad, Gujarat - 382170. **Inspection Coordinator Mr. Naresh Sharma** at Contact Number at **7096014084**.

E-Auction will be held on 28-10-26

Kindly contact **Mr. Amit Mishra - 9266315793** to obtain the form containing terms & conditions of e-Auction or download from website **https://www.sealthedeal.co.in/.**

Auctioneers: Seal The Deal having registered office at Fifth Floor, Office No. 2, Kings Mall, Plot No. 181, District Centre, Rohini Sector 10, New Delhi, Delhi - 110085.

Last date of Submission of form & EMD Demand Draft is 27-10-26.

HT

Readers are recommended to make all enquiries and seek appropriate advice before acting on any advertisement appearing in this publication. Any subscriber sending money, incurring any expenses or acting on any medical recommendations or entering into any commitment in relation to any advertisement published in this publication, shall do so entirely at his/ her discretion, intelligence and risk. The Company, Publisher or any of its employees do not vouch for any claims made by the Advertisers of products and services and shall not be held liable for any damages, loss, consequences, suffered by any person on account of relying on such advertisements.

For Advertisement Call
Manish Shirke
9820748750

{ DEATHS OF ANTI-DRUG VOICES }

MHA seeks reports on 3 Punjab deaths

Ravinder Vasudeva
letters@hindustantimes.com

CHANDIGARH: The Union home ministry on Friday sought reports from Punjab's Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government on the recent deaths of three men who took on the drug trade, a development that was prefaced by Union home minister Amit Shah and chief minister Bhagwant Singh Mann trading blame over the issue earlier in the day.

In three separate letters to the state chief secretary, the home ministry sought reports from the Punjab government over three cases: the murder of anti-drug activist Parvinder Singh "Jhota", who was shot dead in a pharmacy in Mansa; the death by suicide of a 50-year-old man in Dirba, Sangrur, after facing allegedly harassment and casteist slurs for questioning the state finance minister about local drug supplies; and the killing of a 40-year-old man who objected to drugs being peddled in Madi Pannwan village near Sri Hargobindpur in Batala.

The Centre's move comes even as the drug issue takes centre stage in Punjab in the run-up to assembly elections due early next year.

"Punjab is today grappling with a rising threat of drugs, gangsterism, and organised crime," Shah posted on X earlier, adding that Jhota's father had levelled grave allegations against the ruling AAP government.

Addressing Mann directly, Shah declared: "Bhagwant Mann ji, the people of Punjab do not want promises, they want answers; not announcements, but results; decisive strikes against drug networks; and an impartial investigation into any political patronage received by criminals."

Soon after Shah's remarks, Chief minister Bhagwant Mann gave a riposte, also on X, targeting the Centre over border control and maritime security.

"Amit Shah ji, you should have consulted your advisers before speaking about me. The 50-km range (from the international border) is with the Border Security Force (BSF). 3,000 kilos of 'chitta' (heroin) is being seized from Kandla port in Gujarat," Mann wrote.

He added, "Before blaming Bhagwant Mann, handle your own responsibility. Don't copy-paste pre-written tweets through your sycophants."

AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal joined the debate. "If you care even a tiny bit about Punjab, then stop the drugs coming into the country through Gujarat's Mundra and Adani ports," he said. He said that the drug problem grew under previous regimes and argued that a vast majority of illicit substances entering Punjab flow through ports controlled under central oversight.

Protesters stage a bike rally during a 'Punjab Bandh' called over activist Parvinder Singh's killing in Jalandhar on Thursday. PTI

Faceoff amid Batala killing

The exchange between the BJP-led Centre and the AAP government came a day after

Reinforcing the BJP's attack, party president Nitin Nabin said that the drug crisis has reached an "alarming level". "What has Punjab come to when leading voices in society fighting against drugs must fear for their lives? The people of Punjab deserve accountability and a government that can keep them safe," he said.

Shah's intervention follows the BJP's 13-day, 4,000-km 'Nasha Mukt Punjab Yatra', which covered all 117 assembly constituencies and culminated in a rally he addressed in Jalandhar. Shah pledged that if the BJP is voted to power, it will eliminate the state's drug trade by December 31, 2029.

Pjb govt launches plan to dismantle drug network

Meanwhile, facing sharp criticism following the murder of Parvinder Singh Jhota, the Punjab government on Friday launched a targeted 60-day plan to dismantle drug networks in the state, primarily focusing on 435 identified hotspots.

CM Bhagwant Mann chaired a high-level review of the state's Yudh Nasheen Virudh (War Against Drugs) campaign at the Punjab Police Academy in Phillaur, bringing together deputy commissioners, senior superintendents of police, sub divisional magistrates, and deputy superintendents of police.

DGP Gaurav Yadav said, "Over the next two months, the state's strategy will shift from an arrest-centric approach to a network-centric model designed to disrupt supply chains and neutralise financial incentives."

Intelligence inputs, village defence committees (VDCs), and district assessments helped identify the 435 hotspots, where police said they have mapped 2,913 listed peddlers and 312 major suppliers.

(With inputs from Navrajdeep Singh)

Meerut court gives death penalty to woman, lover for killing husband, staging snakebite

Deepak Lavania
letters@hindustantimes.com

MEERUT: A court in Meerut on Friday sentenced a woman and her lover to death for killing her husband and placing a live snake beside his body to make the murder look like a snakebite. The court found the crime to fall under the "rarest of rare" category, said Meerut district government counsel Krishna Kumar Chaubey.

This is the second instance of a Meerut court awarding the death penalty in a murder case this week. In a similar case, a court on October 14 sentenced Muskan Rastogi and her lover Sahil Shukla to death for murdering her husband, merchant navy officer Saurabh Rajput, and concealing his dismembered body in a blue drum filled with cement.

Additional district and sessions judge Jaiveer Singh Nagar awarded the death penalty to Ravita, 24, and Amardeep, 26, for murdering Amit Kashyap alias Mikky, 25, and destroying evidence, 547 days after the incident, the DGC added.

Amardeep, 26 and Ravita, 24. This is the second instance of a Meerut court awarding death penalty for murder this week.

Chaubey said the judge began the 131-page judgment by quoting a verse from the Manusmriti on a ruler's duties and the importance of maintaining order.

"Fear of punishment keeps society under control. Without punishment, the wicked would prey upon the righteous," the judgment stated.

Amit, a resident of Akbarpur Sadat village, was found dead on a cot at his home on April 13, 2025, with a live snake beside his body. His family initially suspected a snakebite. However, the post-mortem examination found that he had died of strangulation, with injuries to his neck and nose, said police.

According to investigators, Ravita and Amardeep allegedly developed a relationship eight to nine months before the murder. Amit learnt about it and this led to frequent disputes between the couple. The prosecution said Amardeep then arranged a snake from a snake charmer for ₹1,000 on the pretext of using it at a religious gathering. On the night of April 12, 2025, the two allegedly strangled Amit while he slept and placed the snake beside his body to mislead investigators.

Police also found that the two had spoken on the phone 51 times within 24 hours of the incident.

The victim's brother filed an FIR against them on April 16, 2025. The prosecution examined 12 witnesses during the trial, including family members, the snake charmer and the investigating officer, said additional district government counsel (ADGC) Farzana Maqsood.

According to ADGC Maqsood, before pronouncing the sentence, the judge heard both convicts through video conferencing.

Ravita cited her three young children and requested that their welfare be ensured, while Amardeep said his elderly parents had nobody to look after them.

Both broke down after the verdict, said Viresh Raj Sharma, senior superintendent of Chaudhary Charan Singh District Jail in Meerut.

CHANDIGARH INSTITUTE FOR TRANSFORMATION

Appointments

Planning & Evaluation Organization, Finance Department, Chandigarh Administration, under SSM, invites contractual applications:

No.	Post	Monthly Remuneration
1	Team Leader	Rs. 1,50,000
2	Sector Expert I (Urban Infrastructure, Planning, Transport & Mobility)	Rs. 1,00,000
3	Sector Expert II (Environment, Climate Action & Eco-Tourism)	Rs. 1,00,000

Eligibility criteria and application forms available on the website: **https://www.chandigarh.gov.in/information/public-notices**

CENTRAL RAILWAY

REPAIR AND MAINTENANCE WORK

Sr.DEN/Co. Floor, Parcel Office Building, above P.F.No. 14 & 15, Central Railway, Mumbai CST 400 001, for and on behalf of the President of India Invites Open tenders from the reputed contractors. **Name of work:** Repair and maintenance of outdoor signalling gears such as Signals, Location boxes, Point machines, Track circuit connections, AFTC outdoor connections in Kalyan section under SSE/Sig/KYN of Mumbai Division. **Tender No.:** CR-BB-SNT-North-2026-97. **Approximate Cost:** Rs. 97.56 Lakhs. **EMD:** Rs. 195100/-. **Validity:** 60 days. **Date of Opening:** 12.11.2026. **Completion Period:** 12 Months. This tender complies with Public Procurement Policy (Make in India) Order 2017, dated 15/06/2017 Complete details of tenders are available at Central Railway. Official website www.ireps.gov.in the complete tender documents can be downloaded from the website. The complete details of tenders are also available in the "Notice Board" of the Divisional Railway Manager (S&T)'s Office, Mumbai CST.

Traveling with dangerous and explosive goods is a punishable offense

CENTRAL RAILWAY

CORRIGENDUM

The Principal Chief Material Manager for and on behalf of the President of India, will hold an additional e-auction programme for the month of October-2026 for Sr.DMM/NGP, sale of scrap as follows:- **Sr.No. 1. Depot/Division:** Sr.DMM/NGP. **Addition e-Auction date & day:** 23.10.2026 (Friday) **Note:** (a) Railway reserves the right to withdraw any lot from e-auction. Railway also reserves the right to auction any lot of any depot/divisions in any subsequent auction in any suitable manner. Also, unsold lots of any Depot/Division can be sold in subsequent auctions of other Depot/Division of Central Railway. (b) As per Govt. policy, where recycling of scrap material involves environment and pollution issues, such lots will be sold only to the authorised bidders having valid licenses issued by the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB)/State Pollution Control Board (SPCB). (c) e-auction catalogue will be available on the website - www.ireps.gov.in (d) In case any assistance is required regarding e-Auction, digital signature, Registration procedure and participation etc., please contact respective Auction Conducting officers as above or Dy.CMM/Sales/HQ, mobile no. 8828110761, email address - dycmm.s.cstm@gmail.com or dycmms@cr.railnet.gov.in

Traveling with dangerous and explosive goods is a punishable offense

बिहार पशु विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, पटना
बिहार पशुचिकित्सा महाविद्यालय परिसर, पटना-800014, बिहार

दिनांक: 16.10.2026

रोजगार सूचना संख्या: 07 / 2026

बिहार पशु विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, पटना अंतर्गत विश्वविद्यालय मुख्यालय, एवं इसके अन्तर्गत अंगीभूत महाविद्यालयों के विभिन्न **19 गैर–शैक्षणिक पदों के कुल 34 रिक्ति** पर सीधी भर्ती के आधार पर नियुक्ति हेतु सुयोग्य अभ्यर्थियों से आवेदन आमंत्रित किए जाते हैं। आवेदन प्रपत्र एवं विस्तृत जानकारी विश्वविद्यालय वेबसाइट **www.basu.org.in** से डाउनलोड किया जा सकता है। आवेदन प्रपत्र **कुलसचिव, बिहार पशु विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, पटना–800014 कार्यालय में पहुँचने की अंतिम तिथि 25.11.2026 अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक है।**

कुलसचिव (प्रभारी)
बिहार पशु विज्ञान विश्वविद्यालय, पटना

सी.एस.आई.आर.–भारतीय रासायनिक जीवविज्ञान संस्थान
CSIR-INDIAN INSTITUTE OF CHEMICAL BIOLOGY
(COUNCIL OF SCIENTIFIC & INDUSTRIAL RESEARCH)
4, Raja S. C. Mullick Road, Jadavpur, Kolkata – 700032 (W.B.) India

Advertisement No. R&C/592/2026 Dated-17.10.2026

Walk-in-Interview for the position of Project Assistant-II, Project Associate-I, Project Associate-II, Senior Project Associate

A Walk-in-Interview will be conducted at CSIR-Indian Institute of Chemical Biology, Jadavpur campus on **3rd November, 2026 (Tuesday)** to select around 41 (forty-one) nos. [may increase or decrease] suitable candidates for temporary engagement under different Projects as Project Assistant-II, Project Associate-I, Project Associate-II, Senior Project Associate with Ph.D./Master's/Bachelor's degree in relevant disciplines are invited to appear for the walk-in-interview.

For detailed information regarding essential qualifications, experience, remuneration, disciplines, vacancies, eligibility criteria, age limit, tenure, reporting time for the Walk-in-Interview, application procedure, and other terms and conditions, interested candidates may visit the Institute's official website: **https://www.iicb.res.in > Careers > Temporary / Contract Positions > Active Positions**

Controller of Administration

केन्द्रीय भण्डारण निगम
(एक नवरत्न सीपीएसई)
CENTRAL WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
(A NAVRATNA CPSE)

Start Date: 17.10.2026 at 00:00 Hrs End Date: 15.11.2026 at 23:59 Hrs

Advertisement No CWC/I-Manpower/DR/Rectt/2026/01

Central Warehousing Corporation, a "Navratna" Central Public Sector Undertaking under the administrative control of Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution, providing scientific storage facilities for agricultural inputs, produce and other notified commodities besides providing logistics infrastructure like CFSs/ICDs, Land Custom Stations, Air Cargo Complexes etc. for import-export cargo, invites online application from eligible candidates (Male/Female/Transgender) for the following posts:

Post Code	Name of the Post	No. of Vacancies
01	Assistant Manager (General)	70
02	Assistant Manager (Technical)	60
03	Assistant Manager (Finance)	10
04	Assistant Manager (Engineering)- Civil	22
05	Assistant Manager (Engineering)- Electrical	05
06	Assistant Manager (Engineering)- Mechanical	04
07	Junior Executive (General)	78
08	Junior Executive (Technical)	78

Please visit CWC's Website (www.cewacor.nic.in/https://cwceportal.com/cwc_careers.html) or scan the QR code for detailed information on eligibility criteria including qualification and experience, selection process, general conditions etc. from **17.10.2026** onwards. Eligible candidates have to apply online through CWC's Website www.cewacor.nic.in/https://cwceportal.com/cwc_careers.html which will start from **17.10.2026 at 00:00 Hrs** and will end on **15.11.2026 at 23:59 Hrs.** No other mode of application shall be accepted.

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
CABINET SECRETARIAT
Vacancy Notice

Applications are invited from Indian Nationals possessing prescribed eligibility criteria and having qualified GATE Exam in the year 2024 or 2025 or 2026 with valid GATE Score Card in one of the specified subjects for Direct Recruitment to fill up 250 vacancies [tentative] in the grade of Deputy Field Officer (Technical) [Level-7 of Pay Matrix, Group 'B', non-Gazetted] in Cabinet Secretariat, Government of India. Total initial monthly emoluments including all allowances will be Rs. 1,00,000/- (approx) in the case of posting at New Delhi. Eligibility criteria, as on closing date, are as under: -

Age Limit	Educational Qualification
Not exceeding 30 years	Bachelor's degree in Engineering or Technology or Masters' degree in Science from a recognised University or Institution in one of the notified subjects [specified in detailed advertisement for DFO(Technical)]

For detailed information and application format, please refer to Employment News dated 17.10.2026.

Closing Date - 15.11.2026

CBC 58101/11/0012/2627

Government of India
Ministry of Minority Affairs
11th Floor, Deendayal Antyodaya Bhawan, CGO Complex, Lodhi Road, New Delhi-110003

Vacancy Notice

Applications are invited for filling up of the **post of Secretary in Central Waqf Council, New Delhi,** a Statutory Body under the Ministry of Minority Affairs. The post is to be filled up on deputation basis (including short-term contract) from amongst eligible serving officers of the Central Government or the State Government or Union territory Administration or public sector undertaking or autonomous or statutory body, **or** retired officers of the rank of Deputy Secretary or Director or above in the Central Government.

2. Detailed advertisement, application format etc. are available on the website of the Ministry and Central Waqf Council, New Delhi i.e. **minorityaffairs.gov.in** and **centralwaqfcouncil.gov.in**.

3. The last date for submission of duly filled up applications is 45 days from the date of publication of this advertisement in Employment News.

CBC 27101/11/0001/2627 **Under Secretary (Waqf)**

₹600-cr share price manipulation case: Docus, devices seized

Abhishek Sharan
abhishek.sharan@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) on Friday carried out searches in six cities including Mumbai and Nashik as part of its money laundering investigation linked to the alleged manipulation of share prices of two listed companies, which led to more than 100,000 small investors losing ₹600 crore, the suspected proceeds of crime in the case.

Searches were conducted at 29 premises across Ahmedabad, Gandhinagar, Surat and Bhavnagar in Gujarat and Mumbai and Nashik in Maharashtra, ED officials said. The premises included offices of the two listed companies, RM Drip and Sprinklers Systems Ltd and R&B Denims Ltd, whose share prices were allegedly manipulated; residences of the promoters of these companies; the persons to whom shares were allotted allegedly at low prices; offices of some stock broking and finance firms; and premises of persons suspected to have operated promotional WhatsApp groups.

According to ED officials, during the search, various allegedly incriminating documents, digital devices, records of share transactions and property documents were found and seized. The ED is probing the role of a market manipulator, who was earlier under the agency's scanner in a separate investigation related to illegal/unethical trading, officials said. The ED's probe is based on two police cases. Separately, the alleged manipulations in share prices are under the scanner of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) which had carried out searches a few months ago.

The ED's investigation has found that between April 2023 and March 2024, the two companies allegedly issued over 3.5 crore shares and convertible warrants (the right to purchase a company's shares at a fixed future price) to select persons and entities. A large chunk of the payment for these shares was allegedly sourced from a small circle of connected persons, firms and lenders, after which share prices were allegedly "steadily pushed up" over months.

From end-December 2025 till February 2026, gullible retail investors were advised to buy these shares via WhatsApp communities, which were operated from Bhavnagar in Gujarat using SIM cards allegedly obtained in the names of people in Mumbai and Haryana, ED officials said. Lured by the tips provided via WhatsApp, the number of buyers of shares of the two firms rose to more than 100,000.

Scan this QR code to read today's e-paper for this week's Books page

EU sanctions Mumbai shipping head, 2 others over Russia trade

Rezaul H Laskar
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI : A Mumbai-based commercial ship manager was among three individuals and nine entities sanctioned by the European Union for being involved in the import of sanctioned goods to Russia and circumventing EU sanctions related to oil and financial transactions.

Vigor Marine Services LLP was sanctioned because its two vessels were allegedly involved in transporting crude oil or petroleum products originating in Russia and "practicing irregular and high-risk shipping practices", the European Council said in a statement.

The high-risk activities included having "inadequate liability insurance, engaging in ship-to-ship transfers and manipulating the vessels' Automatic Identification System", the statement said. The latest sanctions also targeted Hurus Trade FZE, a Dubai-based trading intermediary in the crude oil sector "supplying Russian-origin crude oil to India, in particular to Nayara Energy Limited, an entity listed under [EU] restrictive measures". The EU also sanctioned United Stream LLC and its founder.

SAINIK SCHOOL KODAGU (KARNATAKA)
(Under Ministry of Defence, Govt. of India)
VILLAGE - KUDIGE, KUSHALNAGAR, PIN: 571 232

RECRUITMENT NOTIFICATION NO: 07/OCT 2026

1. Sainik School Kodagu, an autonomous institution functioning under Sainik Schools Society, Ministry of Defence, invites applications from the eligible candidates (Indian Citizens Only) for the Regular and Contractual posts as mentioned below:-

Ser. No.	Name of the Post	Category	No. of Posts
1	PGT- Physics (Regular)	UR	1
2	TGT- English (Regular)	SC	1
3	TGT- Hindi (Regular)	UR	1
4	TGT- Social Science (Regular)	OBC	1
5	Nursing Sister (Contractual)	UR	1
6	Ward Boy (Contractual)	UR	2

2. For detailed Notification including reservation criteria, pay & perks and Application Form, visit School website **www.sainikschoolkodagu.edu.in** from **17 Oct 2026.** The School administration reserves the right to cancel the vacancy due to administrative reasons. Last date of receipt of filled in applications is **06 Nov 2026 (Friday).**

-Sd/- PRINCIPAL

ಸಿಎಸ್ಐಆರ್–ಕೇಂದ್ರೀಯ ಆಹಾರ ತಂತ್ರಜ್ಞಾನ ಸಂಸ್ಥೆ
ಸಿಎಸ್ಐಆರ್–ಕೇಂದ್ರೀಯ ಆಹಾರ ತಂತ್ರಜ್ಞಾನ ಸಂಸ್ಥೆ, ಮೈಸೂರು – 570020, ಭಾರತ
CSIR-CENTRAL FOOD TECHNOLOGICAL RESEARCH INSTITUTE, MYSURU-570020, INDIA

Advertisement No. Rec. 02/2026

Start Date for Online Applications: 19.10.2026 (Monday) at 10.00 AM
Last date for submission of Online Applications: 18.11.2026 (Wednesday) upto 11.59 PM
Last date for Receipt of Hardcopy of Online applications: 26.11.2026

CSIR-Central Food Technological Research Institute (CFTRI), Mysuru, a constituent laboratory of Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR), Ministry of S&T, Govt. of India, invites online applications from eligible Indian citizens for filling up **28 posts of Technician (1),** in the Pay Matrix: Level-2, on a direct recruitment basis.

For detailed advertisement, Terms & Conditions, and to apply ONLINE, please visit the official CFTRI website **https://cftri.res.in** under Recruitments or **https://recruitment.cftri.res.in** and all further announcements/details pertaining to this process/updates/corrigendum/addendum etc. will be published/provided only on CFTRI official website **https://cftri.res.in** from time to time.

Sd/-
Senior Controller of Administration

CBC 36228/11/0003/2627

DELHI ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION
Viniyamak Bhawan, C-Block, Shivalik, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi - 110 017
Telephone: 41080416, 41080417

RECRUITMENT NOTICE

SENIOR RESEARCH CONSULTANTS (TARIFF-ENGG.), (TARIFF-FINANCE), (ENGINEERING), (LAW) AND CONSULTANT (HR) IN DERC.

DELHI ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION invites applications for engagement of Senior Research Consultants/Consultant in the following domains on contract basis:-

Sl. No.	Name of post	Number of post(s)
1.	Senior Research Consultant (Tariff-Engineering)	02
2.	Senior Research Consultant (Tariff-Finance)	02
3.	Senior Research Consultant (Engineering)	02
4.	Senior Research Consultant (Law)	02
5.	Consultant (HR)	01

For further details, such as eligibility, qualifications, experience and other terms & conditions of engagement including compensation, facilities etc. please refer to DERC website **www.derc.gov.in** and for submitting the application **https://www.derc.gov.in/app/home/openings**

The last date for submission of application is **24.11.2026.**

Prashasti De
Dy. Director (Pers.) DERC

DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0257/26-27

The Hindustan Times
ESTABLISHED IN 1924

{ OUR TAKE }

A possible balm for SIR pain

Special summary revision could help those left out of electoral rolls by SIR, but questions still remain

The Election Commission of India's (ECI) decision to conduct a special summary revision (SSR) of electoral rolls in 17 states and Union Territories and implement a slew of changes to the procedure fulfil long-pending demands and are welcome. But it is difficult to ignore the fact that the announcements came only after sustained street protests that have roiled the national capital and reached the Supreme Court.

Usually, ECI conducted SSR every year to allow citizens turning 18 an opportunity to enter the rolls. In the past two decades, SSR was held 19 times. Yet, it was not conducted over the last two years as ECI shifted its attention to the controversial special intensive revision (SIR) — where every entry on the electoral roll had to be verified and backed by documentary evidence. This departure was not only unexplained — just as ECI had not given any concrete reason why it revived SIR for the first time since 2002-03 — but it also denied young people a chance to enter the rolls. This was particularly egregious given that Gen Z is set to form the largest voting cohort of India's population (about a fourth) by 2029. ECI's belated realisation here is a relief but its earlier reticence remains to be explained.

Even more curious, albeit in a positive way, are the changes effected by the poll body.

ECI directed electoral registration officers to provide recognised political parties with two copies of the draft and final electoral rolls for each polling station. This includes one hard copy and one soft copy in a machine-readable PDF format. ECI also directed officials to share addition, deletion and modification lists to help parties track changes in voter records. This is a big departure for ECI, which used to provide political parties with image PDFs earlier. Machine-readable digital copies can be searched and analysed easily, helping political parties check voter names and scrutinise changes. ECI will also share weekly lists of claims and objections with political parties.

The changes will ensure transparency and boost confidence in the electoral process at a time when uncomfortable (and entirely avoidable) questions are being asked of Indian democracy across the globe.

The changes addressed key concerns raised by the Opposition over the past two years, including in June 2025, when Rahul Gandhi and Mallikarjun Kharge demanded digital, machine-readable voter rolls for the 2024 Lok Sabha and Maharashtra assembly polls, along with version histories and timestamps showing changes to the rolls. At the time, ECI argued that providing voter lists in machine-readable formats was legally forbidden, citing a Supreme Court ruling. Raising privacy concerns, it noted that statutory rules did not mandate supplying draft rolls in searchable formats. What changed? What caused ECI to shift its stance? The body must consider explaining this.

Coming against the backdrop of protests demanding the resignation of chief election commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, the decisions are likely to have two fallouts. One, since SSR is being conducted in all poll-bound states, their electoral rolls are likely to look very different from the post-SIR numbers. In addition, the process might itself become an electoral factor, like it did in Bengal. And second, SSR is likely to help many people — left out of SIR for one reason or another — to re-enter the rolls. If this happens, not only will this raise fundamental questions about the efficacy of a process that has caused unnecessary hardships to citizens, but also underline the futility of chasing statistically perfect rolls in a country as large and diverse as India.

{ MINOR HINTS }

Rahul Sagar

Indian democracy: Views of voters and experts at variance

The disagreement can be traced to paradoxes in four areas: Mandates, authority, institutional autonomy, and competence

A premise of democracy is that every individual deserves an equal vote because they have equal worth. HT ARCHIVE

A striking feature of global surveys on democracy is the disconnect between how democracy is viewed in theory and in practice. In its 2023 survey of 24 countries, Pew found that the median share of respondents who considered representative democracy to be a "good system" was 77%, while the median share dissatisfied with the way it was functioning was 59%.

India has bucked this trend. In Pew's 2025 survey, 74% of Indian respondents said they were satisfied with how democracy was working — the second-highest share among the countries surveyed. But this is not how "experts" consulted by organisations like V-Dem and Freedom House see it. Citing concerns about press freedom, the treatment of Opposition figures, and the independence of investigative agencies, they argue that an excessive concentration of power has transformed Indian democracy into an "electoral autocracy". The discrepancy between the views of ordinary citizens and those of experts offers a useful illustration of why people disagree so sharply about democracy in practice.

This disagreement can be traced to four paradoxes in democracy. The first concerns mandates. Citizens must rely on some method to make collective decisions. Since democracy assumes that individuals are equal, this method usually takes the form of voting in elections. This entitles the winner of an election to say that they have a mandate to govern. But no selection procedure is beyond question. For instance, money may give a party an unfair advantage over its rivals. Consequently, when individuals and groups dislike a policy that is being enacted by an elected government, they can question whether it "truly" embodies the will of the people. Meanwhile, elected officials take the opposite view — that the mandate they have been given is being "sabotaged" by those who have lost the election, or worse still, by unelected bodies beholden to private or sectional interests.

The second paradox concerns authority. Because unrestricted authority can lead to the abuse of power, democratic governments are subject to checks and balances.

The idea is to compel even a government elected by a sizeable majority to slow down and build broad consensus. But this arrangement generates a dilemma. A government that fails to deliver what most voters want runs the risk of losing their support. Seeking to satisfy them, it will press against the limits of its authority, leading to accusations of overreach. The end result is disenchantment — either of the majority, if the government dithers, or the minority, if it acts decisively.

A third paradox relates to institutions. In the modern era, governance is conducted through a range of independent institutions. These institutions, such as universities, central banks, and regulators, are granted autonomy to insulate them from political interference. However, because they are staffed by people with ideas and interests of their own, their impartiality cannot be taken for granted. They are, therefore, subject to political oversight by elected officials. Consider what happens when a university offers a class on a topic, such as the "occupation" of Kashmir, that most of the electorate considers wildly improper. Elected officials may demand investigations to rule out "systemic bias" or insist upon a change of personnel to secure suitably "diverse perspectives". They will see this as holding institutions accountable; their opponents will see it as undermining institutional autonomy.

Conversely, should the university agree to incorporate the alternative perspective held by the majority, the government's opponents will complain that it is being "politicised". The problem, in short, is that when divisions are acute, whatever an institution does, one side will complain that it has been captured.

> A GOVERNMENT THAT WANTS TO BE RESPONSIVE WILL EMPHASISE ITS MANDATE, WHILE THE EXPERT WILL EMPHASISE THE RESTRAINTS UNDER WHICH IT OUGHT TO ACT. NEITHER WILL SEE THE OTHER AS STANDING UP FOR DEMOCRACY

The fourth paradox concerns competence. A premise of democracy is that every individual deserves an equal vote because they have equal worth. Yet, because false or misleading information can prevent individuals from discerning and defending their interests, democracy requires public debate and discussion. But once we accept that individuals can be misinformed, then we open the door to doubting one another's competence. When a person who votes for the NDA is described as a *bhakt*, the implication is that they are incapable of reason. If such a person must be "re-educated" to become tolerable, then we are in the province of revolution.

To summarise: Democracy uses elections to confer mandates but allows doubt about whether they are genuine; it grants a majority the right to rule but limits the power it may exercise; it insulates institutions from political interference but asks that they be accountable; it views citizens as judges but permits questions about whether they are competent. Together, these paradoxes create a grave dilemma: Democracy promises responsiveness and restraint, but it cannot always provide one without compromising the other.

This leaves democracy vulnerable to breaking down. The majority asks what the point of democracy is when its representatives cannot rule; the minority asks what the point of democracy is when its complaints go unheard. Each side questions the competence of the other and fears that their opponents will seize control of public institutions.

This destructive tendency can only be restrained by a sense of decorum — a reluctance to push claims too far. It is easier to maintain such modesty when disputes are over the distribution of material benefits. When we are debating who gets what, it is possible to compromise or take turns. But the prospects of maintaining such decorum fade when disputes arise over matters — such as enacting a uniform civil code — where only one side can have its way. When the persistence of the majority or the obstructiveness of the minority exhausts patience, a trial of strength looms. It is this foreboding — that one is never far from open conflict — that makes democracy less pleasant in practice than in theory.

These paradoxes help explain the marked discrepancy between the views of ordinary citizens and those of experts when it comes to democracy in India. Citizens vote in the expectation that their representatives will make good their promises. When their representatives do the needful — for instance, by abrogating Article 370 — supporters see the fulfilment of a commitment, while critics see an abuse of power.

Thus what appears a quintessentially democratic act to one side appears wholly undemocratic to the other. The difference boils down to what each side expects democracy to do. To the expert, democracy is more than a means of selecting rulers or resolving disagreements; it is also a means of managing power. The idea is that the government must accommodate competing interests and respect institutional autonomy.

But, in a deeply polarised society, these requirements can appear to the governing majority as a demand for ineffectuality — as giving the minority a constant veto over the majority. And so, a government that wants to be responsive will emphasise its mandate, while the expert will emphasise the restraints on its freedom. Neither sees the other as standing up for democracy.

Rahul Sagar is a Global Network professor at NYU Abu Dhabi. His latest book is The Birth of Indian Liberalism. The views expressed are personal

Women's turn to visit a doctor need not come last

Nikhil Tandon

Many women in India live for years with illnesses and ailments they never mention to anyone. They know what these are, and often know exactly what these are doing to their bodies. But within their households, their illness is never made a priority.

In most cases, school fees might come first, followed by textbooks, and maybe the husband's medicines. Poorer households internalise this order early, where every rupee is already accounted for.

More often than not, a woman's own health often settles at the bottom of the household ledger because something else always feels more urgent, more important whenever a choice has to be made.

That old hierarchy, I believe, is now being rewritten at a systems level. The Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (AB PM-JAY) made an unprecedented design choice: It set no limit on family size. Earlier insurance schemes, government and private alike, capped how many members a single policy could cover.

In large households, that ceiling had a predictable effect — wage-earning men and sons received coverage, and the women were the ones left out of it.

AB PM-JAY covers every member of an eligible family, whatever its size or composition, for cashless secondary and tertiary care up to ₹5 lakh a year.

For much of India's public health history, a woman met the system chiefly through her reproductive role — antenatal visits, institutional deliveries, family planning — services built out systematically on the logic that a healthy mother meant a healthy child.

Since then, screening programmes for non-communicable diseases, cervical and breast cancer, along with HPV vaccination drives have scaled well beyond that original focus. However, beyond that a woman's claim to health care has often depended on her family's discretion.

AB PM-JAY cannot be expected to undo decades of that conditioning in one fell swoop, but it does mark a meaningful departure: treating a woman's health as an entitlement in her own right, independent of pregnancy.

Routine pregnancy care and uncomplicated deliveries still remain the work of Janani Suraksha Yojana (JSY) and Janani Shishu Suraksha Karyakram (JSSK). AB PM-JAY complements this by covering high-risk pregnancies, complications needing tertiary care, or gynaecological conditions unrelated to pregnancy.

More than 1,900 procedures across secondary and tertiary hospitalisation cover gynaecological surgery, oncology, cardiac care, and orthopaedic conditions, arriving at any age, for every eligible woman. The dignity in this shift carries a weightage that is as significant as that of the monetary relief to the household.

Cashless treatment means a woman no longer has to ask her family for money before treatment, and that difference has a direct effect on timely treatment. For too long, women's use of hospital services in India ran well below what their disease burden would predict.

For even longer, women depended on a male family member to authorise their care. I think it is by no means a small win that women who have spent a lifetime with little to no economic agency are finally beginning to have an equal footing inside the health care system.

There's also a small army of women who have long connected India's rural, remote households to the health system. We know them as ASHA and *anganwadi* workers. They carry different names across the breadth of our country: *Mitanins*, *Jaankar Mahilas*, *Sanginis*, *Sahiyas*, *Tais*, *Didis*. These remarkable women literally cycle/walk the last mile of public health delivery, often underpaid for the hours this truly takes. AB PM-JAY extends coverage to this workforce as a recognition that those carrying India's public health system deserve to be covered by it too.

By no means do I intend to imply that the effort is complete, or that structural challenges have disappeared.

An entitlement, by itself, is not access, just yet. What turns entitlement into access is the wider reform now under way with digital health records, work on hospital quality, and overall systems strengthening. What AB PM-JAY has already done is dismantle one of the most stubborn barriers in a woman's path — the treatment expense.

What began as a health insurance initiative is steadily morphing into a vehicle for social dignity. For millions of women, it means their turn to visit the doctor no longer comes last.

Nikhil Tandon is the director of AIIMS Delhi. The views expressed are personal

Reviving the rhino: A true conservation gain

Raj Kumar Bajpai

As the Indian Forest Service marks the 60th year of its inception, the spectacular revival of the rhinoceros in Indian jungles is one of the greatest conservation success stories in modern history.

Centuries ago, the animal roamed freely across the Indo-Gangetic Plain. Relentless hunting and rapid agricultural expansion left just 20 animals surviving in Assam's Kaziranga by the early 20th century. By the mid-2000s, India's herd stabilised at 2,500. The Indian Rhino Vision 2020 (IRV2020) was launched in 2005 to push up the population to 3,000 across seven protected areas in Assam. Today, the count exceeds 3,200, with Kaziranga alone housing 2,600.

This resurgence has occurred alongside a broader environmental milestone: India significantly expanded its green cover despite a growing human population.

To anchor these habitat gains, the Wildlife Institute of India is currently mapping a National Grassland Atlas. This initiative supports India's 2070 net-zero carbon target, a goal that the rhino naturally champions. Using its prehensile upper lip to pluck grass cleanly without uprooting it, the rhino mirrors sustainable land management. Protecting them also safeguards dense grasslands, which act as vital carbon sinks.

Unlike elephants, rhinos rely on a solitary, reactive, and localised instincts, depending entirely on intense, site-specific territorial attachment. Consequently, saving the species requires strict, localised "fortress protection" rather than expansive landscape corridors.

While Africa holds larger populations across its vast savannas, India's rhinos are packed into tiny, high-density sanctuaries in Assam, West Bengal's floodplains, and Uttar Pradesh's Dudhwa National Park. Operating under immense demographic strain, the available area per animal in Pobitora has shrunk drastically, resulting in the highest rhino density in the world. Surrounded by human settlements, these sanctuaries have become ecological islands. Under IRV2020, translocating rhinos to restored habitats like Assam's Manas National Park has successfully mitigated epidemic risks.

When organised poaching syndicates targeted the park, the threat forced a swift enforcement evolution. The forest department deployed armed police commandos, drone surveillance, and advanced real-time satellite tracking. Today, the annual poaching rate in Kaziranga has dropped to zero.

Crucially, this model was built alongside local communities. The government publicly burned thousands of confiscated horns to shatter medicinal myths, while forest departments transformed local youth into active anti-poaching stakeholders. Tourism revenue now funds village schools and health care, ensuring that when rhinos stray into fields, communities herd them back safely. Karbi elders tell a beautiful folktale: "The Goddess Kajir used the rhinos to till her heavenly fields. When a rhino wanders into our paddies and eats our grain, it is not a loss; it is the footprint of the Goddess bringing good fortune."

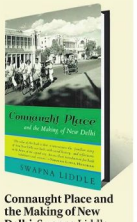
Yet, challenges loom. Trapped on disconnected ecological islands, rhinos are forced by annual monsoon floods to migrate toward higher ground, crossing heavily trafficked roads where their predictable tracks make them easy targets. Expanding secure wildlife corridors remains imperative to ensure that the rhino's resonant, primitive bellow never falls silent in our wild landscapes.

Raj Kumar Bajpai is a senior officer of the Indian Forest Service. The views expressed are personal

{ EDITOR'S PICK }

HT's editors offer a book recommendation every Saturday, which provides history, context, and helps understand recent news events

NEW DELHI, THEN AND NOW



Connaught Place and the Making of New Delhi: Swapna Liddle 2018

The strict security measures, rolled out in the national capital in response to recent protests, served as a refresher on the city's geography. Connecting roads and lanes, landmark buildings, "round-abouts", all assumed a new character for the police and protestors alike.

It is this New Delhi that comes alive in historian and author Swapna Liddle's *Connaught Place and the Making of New Delhi*. The book traces the national capital's origins as a bureaucratic enclave meant to house the Raj after it decided to shift out of Calcutta following the disastrous partition of Bengal. The conurbation we see today, Liddle writes, would perhaps never have happened if those who saw Delhi little other than a "lifeless backwater of the Punjab province" prevailed in the pre-shift discussions. Iconic buildings and what they started out as, feuding architects, and many such tales of New Delhi then and now will make the reader understand the city better.

RNI No. MAHENG/2005/15186, AIR SURCHARGE: Ahmedabad, Nagpur and beyond by Rail or Road - Rs. 2/-.
PRINTED AND PUBLISHED BY MANHAR KAPOOR for and on behalf of HT Media Ltd., 9th Floor, Tower 3, Indiabulls Finance Centre, Senapati Bapat Marg, Elphinstone Road (West), Mumbai-400013 at HT Media Ltd. Press at Plot No. 6, TTC Industrial Area, Thane - Belapur Road, Navi Mumbai - 400 708.
PHONES: BOARD: (022) 66134000/01 ● CIRCULATION: (022) 67764242 ● FAX: (022) 66134322
EXECUTIVE EDITOR: MEENAL BAGHEL - Responsible for selection of news under PRP Act, @ All rights reserved. Reproduction in whole or in part without written permission of Publisher is prohibited.

{ FROM PAGE 1 }

'INTEGRATED' HOSTELS

for Maratha students. As a result, in September 2022, the state government decided to build 72 government hostels for OBC students, one for boys and one for girls, in each of the 36 districts in the state.

The political fight over reservations and welfare schemes for backward youth has since turned into a bitter race between communities over government benefits. This heightened caste-based politics in Maharashtra and fuelled election politics along caste lines. Many leaders say these conflicts have driven a wedge between the youth of these communities, with students refusing to trust each other.

Now, the state hopes to address this by building hostels blind to caste. "The initiative will not only provide students with quality accommodation and infrastructure but also strengthen the social fabric, mutual interaction and a sense of equality among young people," Bawankule told officials at the meeting.

He underlined that the land parcels must aim to meet students' needs rather than merely make government property available for these institutions. Accordingly, they should be located in areas that offer easy access to educational institutions, transport connectivity, healthcare facilities, markets and other amenities, the minister said.

The meeting also reviewed the availability of land for hostels proposed by the Mahatma Jyotiba Phule Research and Training Institute (MahaJyoti) and district collectors were directed to submit proposals to the state government.

{ AMID OPPN CRITICISM }

Govt defends EAM-Rubio meet

HT Correspondent
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Union government on Friday dismissed the Opposition's criticism of external affairs minister S Jaishankar travelling to Mumbai to meet his US counterpart Marco Rubio next week by saying it has been the practice over the past decade for foreign dignitaries to be hosted outside New Delhi.

Leaders of the Congress party criticised the government after US ambassador Sergio Gor said at a public event that "we expect... Jaishankar to be joining us [in Mumbai]" for the US secretary of state's visit. Rubio is set to travel to Mumbai and Jamnagar, and the Capital is not part of his itinerary.

Responding to questions on the Opposition's criticism that the external affairs minister had been "summoned" to Mumbai by the US, external affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal told a regular media briefing that Jaishankar is set to host the United Arab Emirates (UAE)'s deputy prime minister, Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan, in Mumbai during October 19-20 before holding talks with Rubio.

S Jaishankar and Marco Rubio

Noting that Jaishankar will also attend a celebration in Mumbai of the 250th anniversary of the independence of the US as the guest of honour, Jaiswal said: "It has been the practice for the last decade or so that we have hosted foreign dignitaries outside Delhi."

In this context, he said that Prime Minister Narendra Modi has in the past hosted his Spanish counterpart in Baroda, German Chancellor Friedrich Merz in Ahmedabad, and the Mauritius PM Navinchandra Ramgoolam in Varanasi, while the external affairs minister has hosted the foreign ministers of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) in Goa, the Botswana foreign minister at Kevadia in Gujarat, and the Heart of Asia conference in Amritsar.

Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and Jairam Ramesh had questioned why the US envoy had announced the external affairs minister's meetings.

Jaiswal said that Sheikh Abdullah's visit is an opportunity to review all aspects of India-UAE cooperation under their comprehensive strategic partnership.

Comments on SIR interference in electoral practices, says MEA

NEW DELHI: India on Friday rejected US Congresswoman Pramila Jayapal's criticism of its electoral roll revision as "unwarranted and uninformed", saying it amounted to interference in the electoral practices of a fellow democracy.

External affairs ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said, "We find the remarks of the Congresswoman unwarranted and uninformed and tantamount to interfering in the electoral practices of a fellow democracy," adding that her remarks undermined democracy itself

Pramila Jayapal

Jayapal, an Indian-origin Democratic lawmaker, had expressed concern over the removal of 130 million people from electoral rolls, comparing the exercise to efforts by the Trump administration.

She also backed non-violent protests against "anti-democratic efforts in India."

CALL ON U.S. TO ENSURE SAFETY OF INDIANS: MEA ON TEMPLE INCIDENT

Press Trust of India
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Describing the alleged plot to carry out a mass shooting targeting a Hindu temple in Illinois as a matter of "deep concern" for New Delhi, India on Friday called on the US to ensure the safety, security and well-being of Indian nationals in that country.

Ministry of External Affairs Spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said this in response to a query during a media briefing.

A 19-year-old was arrested in Palatine near Chicago for allegedly planning a mass shooting at the Sri Venkateswara Temple in Aurora, Illinois on Sunday. The plan failed as the gun carried by the teenager jammed and could not fire. He appeared in court on October 14 and was charged with one count of making a terrorist threat and one count of unlawful possession of weapons. The MEA spokesperson described the Illinois incident as a "matter of deep concern". India said it was deeply concerned by reports of an alleged plot to carry out a mass shooting targeting a Hindu temple in Illinois in the US.

Private teachers can be roped in for Census as Centre amends rules

Prawesh Lama
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Friday notified the Census (Amendment) Rules 1990 allowing states and Union territories to include teachers from aided and unaided private bodies as enumerators during the Census.

The notification issued by Registrar General of India, Mrityunjay Kumar Narayan, and Census commissioner said that clerical staff and any other person appointed by state and Centre could also be roped in as enumerators.

Before Friday's notification, according to The Census Rules, 1990, the officials who could be roped in as enumerators were not explicitly specified, and were noted as — teachers, clerks or any official or any other person.

According to Friday's notification, "In exercise of the powers conferred by sub-section (1) of section 18 of the Census Act, 1948 (37 of 1948), the Central Government hereby makes the following rules further to amend the Census Rules, 1990, namely:—

"(i) Teachers of any educational institution of the Government, local authority, aided or unaided private bodies, societies or trusts.

(ii) Clerks or any official of the Central Government, State Government, local authority or establishment (including public sector undertakings, statutory bodies, banks, companies, institutions, societies and trusts).

(iii) Any person, as the State Government or the Union territory Administration may consider suitable, to perform the duties as an Enumerator."

PETITIONS IN VARIOUS HIGH COURTS HAVE CHALLENGED THE DEPLOYMENT OF TEACHING STAFF FROM PRIVATE SCHOOLS FOR CENSUS DUTY

MAHARASHTRA INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION
(A Government of Maharashtra Undertaking)
RFP Gem Portal Notice No. GEM/2026/B/8160469(Mumbai)

RFP is invited for below work for consultant.

Sr. No.	Name of Work
1	Selecting and on-boarding Consultant for Goods & Service Tax (GST) Compliance

The blank tender forms for above works will be available from **21.10.2026** to **19.11.2026** on following website **https://gem.gov.in/**

Maharashtra Industrial Development Corporation
(A Government of Maharashtra Undertaking)
E. Tender Notice No.39/2026-2027 (Mumbai)

E Tenders are invited for below work from registered contractors.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost
1	Expression of Interest for Appointment of Architect for preparation of Elevations along with cost estimate for the Proposed Construction of "Ratan Tata Udyog Bhawan" MIDC (HQ) along with Printing Press Building at Charni Road, Mumbai.	Rs.0.00

The blank tender forms for above work will be available from 16/10/2026 to 29/10/2026 on GoM's Website **https://mahatenders.gov.in**

Interested agencies may upload their queries before 22/10/2026 on above mentioned website of GoM. Answers to the queries / MIDC Clarification will be available from 26/10/2026 on above mentioned website of GoM.

South East Central Railway
Railway Recruitment Cell, GM Office Campus, Bilaspur (C.G.) 495004
Employment Notice No. P-HQ/RRC/762/2026-27

INDICATIVE NOTICE
RECRUITMENT AGAINST Scout & Guide Quota 2026-27

Date of issue/Opening date: 17.10.2026	Closing date: 16.11.2026 (23:59)hrs.

Online applications are invited from the eligible and meritorious Scout & Guide candidates for filling up of 02 (Two) posts in Pay Matrix (Level-2) 7th CPC and 06 (Six) posts in Pay Matrix (Level-1) 7th CPC against Scout & Guide Quota 2026-27 over South East Central Railway.

Details of posts :-

Sl. No.	Posts	No. of Posts	Distribution
1.	Group "C" post, Level-2 (7th CPC)	02 (Two)	Over South East Central Railway.
2.	Erstwhile Group "D" post, Level-1 (7th CPC)	06 (Six)	02 Posts each for Bilaspur, Raipur and Nagpur Division.

For complete details please see Employment News issue date 17.10.2026 to 24.10.2026 and log on to SEC Railway website : **www.secr.indianrailways.gov.in**.

CPR/10/439A
Chairperson
RRC/SECR/Bilaspur

South East Central Railway @secrail

MADHYA PRADESH PUBLIC HEALTH SERVICES CORPORATION LTD.
(A Government of Madhya Pradesh Undertaking)
Oil Fed Building, 01, Arera Hills, Bhopal
URL : https://mpphscl.mp.gov.in, Phone : 0755-2578915
Dated : 16.10.2026

TENDER NOTICE

Tenders for following item/Services floated on website and Portal from dated **16.10.2026 to Next 30 days** :-
1. Tender Ref.No. T-963/MPPHSCL/Indelible Ink Marker Pen/RC/2026 Upload on Date 16.10.2026
2. Tender (s) for Various Drugs.
3. Tender (s) for Various Consumables.
4. Tender (s) for Various Ayush Consumables and Drugs.
5. Tender (s) for Various Equipment.

All Prospective bidders are requested to visit **www.mptenders.gov.in, https://mpphscl.mp.gov.in, https://gem.gov.in** for further details.
M.P. Madhyam/128667/2026 CGM (TECHNICAL)

Mumbai Railway Vikas Corporation Ltd.
INVITATION FOR TENDER: MRVC-W-277
(Single Packet e-Procurement Tender Process)
Mumbai Railway Vikas Corporation Ltd. (MRVC) having its corporate office at Second Floor, Churchgate Station Building, Mumbai–400020, invites e-Tenders for the **"Provision of KAVACH (TCAS) alteration (M/s Medha make) in connection with 5th & 6th line work in Borivali (BVI) –Virar (VR) section and 3rd & 4th line work in Virar (VR)–Dahanu Road (DRD) Sections."** Details of Tender and Tender document are available on e-procurement website https://www.eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app The last date for completed e-Tender submission at website https://www.eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app is **17.11.2026 up to 15:00 hours. Corrigendum, if any, will be posted on the website only.**

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Office:- Chief Engineer/P&M, PSPCL, Ludhiana)
CIN: U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in
Tender Enquiry No. 21/CE/P&M/2026

CE/P&M, PSPCL, Ludhiana invites e-Tender for Manufacture, Testing, Supply & Delivery of 760 no. master trip & Restricted Earth fault (REF) relays for 11KV breakers and 66KV power Transformers installed at various 66KV Substations. For detailed NIT & Tender specifications please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 17.10.2026 (1100 hrs) onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
RO No. 1079/12/2026/27/16284 C989/26

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
(Office:- Chief Engineer/P&M, PSPCL, Ludhiana)
CIN: U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in
Tender Enquiry No. 20/CE/P&M/2026

CE/P&M, PSPCL, Ludhiana invites e-Tender for Manufacture, Testing, Supply & Delivery of 155 no. SCADA Compatible Numeric Differential Relays for 66 KV Power Transformers. For detailed NIT & Tender specifications please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 17.10.2026 (1100 hrs) onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
RO No. 1079/12/2026/27/16283 C988/26

bida निवाड़ी इंटिग्रेटेड विकास प्राधिकरण
एच-5, मल्टीपर्पस बिल्डिंग, निवाड़ी, उत्तर, तृतीय :- 01493-230819
ई-मेल :- bida.bhiwadi@rajasthan.gov.in
क्रमांक – बीड़ा/अभि./3255/26 दिनांक – 12/10/2026

Notice Inviting Bid

Bid for "बीड़ा (तत्कालीन यूआईटी) द्वारा विकसित बस स्टैंड एवं सेक्टर. 3 स्थित ईडब्ल्यूएस आवासीय परिसर में भवन मरम्मतए पार्क विकास एवं बाह्य मरम्मत कार्यों", is invited from interested Bidders up to 02.00 PM date 03.11.2026 Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal **http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in** & **http://sppp.raj.nic.in** of the state; and **https://bida.rajasthan.gov.in** departmental website. **UBN: BDA2627WLOB00068**

राज.संवाद/सी/26/12035 अधिशासी अभियन्ता, बीड़ा, भिवाड़ी

पनवेल महानगरपालिका, पनवेल
शहर अभियंता विभाग
दरपत्रक

जा.क्र.एमपा/बांधकाम/६९२५/प्र.क्र.०१/३४६०/२०२६ दिनांक : १६/१०/२०२६

आयुक्त, पनवेल महानगरपालिका खालील नमूद कामाकरीता अंदाजपत्रक तयार करण्यासाठी खालील कामासाठी दरपत्रक (Market Rate) मागविण्यात येत आहेत.

अ.क्र.	कामाचे नाव	मुदत
१	पनवेल महानगरपालिका क्षेत्रातील खारघर सेक्टर – १६/१७ मध्ये तलाव सुशोभिकरण व चौपाटी तयार करणे.	१६/१०/२०२६ ते २३/१०/२०२६ (७ दिवस)

या कामाच्या दरपत्रकाबाबतची माहिती पनवेल महानगरपालिकेच्या www.panvelcorporation.com या संकेतस्थळावर दि. १६/१०/२०२६ रोजी प्रसिध्द करण्यात येईल. सदर बाबींचे बाजार भाव स्वतःच्या लेटरहेडवर महानगरपालिका कार्यालयात अथवा pmcbandhkamdept01@gmail.com या ई-मेलवर मुदतीत पाठविण्यात यावे ही विनंती. **सदर दर हे अंदाजपत्रक तयार करण्यासाठी आहेत. याची कृपया नोंद घ्यावी.**

सही/-
शहर अभियंता
पनवेल महानगरपालिका

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited
Regd. Office: PSEB Head Office, The Mall, Patiala-147001
Corporate Identity Number: U40109PB2010SGC033813
Website: www.pspcl.in
(Contact No. 96461-22185)

Tender Enquiry No. 391/SS(D)-408/Spares	Dated: 16.10.2026

Dy. CE/Substation Design/TS Organization, PSPCL, C-1, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites E-tender for Manufacturing, Testing and Delivery of 250.80 KL Naphthenic Base Transformer Oil. For detailed NIT & Tender Specification please refer to **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in** from 19.10.2026 (11.00 AM onwards).

Note: Corrigendum and amendments, if any, will be published online at **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**
RO No. 1079/12/2026/27/16289 C991/26

कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियंता सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग
खण्ड-आमेट, जिला राजसमन्द

क्रमांक:–2031 दिनांक:– 14.10.2026

संशोधित निविदा सूचना संख्या 12/2026–27

इस कार्यालय के पत्रांक 1827 दिनांक 29.09.2026 द्वारा जारी निविदा सूचना संख्या 12/2026–27 दिनांक 29.09.2026 को दिनांक में निम्नानुसार संशोधन किया जाता है।

क्र.सं.	पूर्व में जारी दिनांक		संशोधित दिनांक	
01	ऑनलाईन निविदा आवेदन / डाउनलोड करने की दिनांक	दिनांक 30.09.2026 से 15.10.2026 सांय 06:00 बजे तक	ऑनलाईन निविदा आवेदन/डाउनलोड करने की दिनांक	दिनांक 30.09.2026 से 21.10.2026 सांय 06:00 बजे तक
02	ऑनलाईन निविदा जमा कराने की दिनांक	दिनांक 30.09.2026 से 15.10.2026 सांय 06:00 बजे तक	ऑनलाईन निविदा जमा कराने की दिनांक	दिनांक 30.09.2026 से 21.10.2026 सांय 06:00 बजे तक
03	DD व BG अथोरेन्समाधकारी कार्यालय में व एक अपर कार्यालय में जमा कराने की दिनांक	दिनांक 16.10.2026 दोपहर 12:00 बजे तक	DD व BG अथोरेन्समाधकारी कार्यालय में व एक अपर कार्यालय में जमा कराने की दिनांक	दिनांक 22.10.2026 दोपहर 12:00 बजे तक
04	ऑनलाईन निविदा खोलने की दिनांक	दिनांक 16.10.2026 सांय 04:00 बजे	ऑनलाईन निविदा खोलने की दिनांक	दिनांक 22.10.2026 सांय 04:00 बजे

निविदा की अन्य शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी।

DIPR/C/17838/2026 अधिशाषी अभियंता
सा. नि. वि. खण्ड आमेट

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
Open E-Tender Notice

Sr. DEN/CO/WCR, Bhopal acting for and on behalf of the President of India, invites E-Tenders against following works, upto 15.30 hours on the dates mentioned against each tender. The complete tender documents and detail information regarding tender, is available on the website http://www.ireps.gov.in. NIT can also be seen on the notice board of DRM (W)/WCR/Bhopal office. Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders. For any correction, in these tenders, if necessary, corrigendum will be uploaded on website prior to tender opening date and copy of corrigendum will be placed on Notice Board of this office, which may be seen upto the date of tender opening. Tenderers are requested to offer their rates and submit tenders according to the provisions of GST ACT 2017. **NIT No. WCR-BPL-W- :** 26 27-W-27-114, **Date :** 09/10/2026, **Name of work including Location :** White washing, colour washing, ordinary repairs, maintenance work of all residential and service buildings under the jurisdiction of SSE/W/Shajapur section as per DSR 2023 for the year 2026-27 under ADEN/M/Shajapur, **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 10000000.00 , **Earnest Money :** 200000.00, **Completion period :** 12 Months, **Last date for submitting tender :** 02/11/2026, **NIT No. WCR-BPL-W- :** 26 27-W-28-115, **Date :** 09/10/2026, **Name of work including Location :** White washing, colour washing, ordinary repairs, maintenance work of all residential and service buildings under the Jurisdiction of SSE/Works/Shivpuri section as per DSR 2023 for the year 2026-27 under ADEN/M/Shivpuri., **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 10000000.00, **Earnest Money :** 200000.00, **Completion period :** 12 Months, **Last date for submitting tender :** 02/11/2026, **NIT No. WCR-BPL-W- :** 26 27-C-19-116, **Date :** 09/10/2026, **Name of work including Location :** Repair and maintenance to Washable Apron of Bhopal and Rani Kamlapati Stations under ADEN/M/Bhopal section, **Published cost of tender (Rs.) :** 8533076.69, **Earnest Money :** 170700.00, **Completion period :** 06 Months, **Last date for submitting tender :** 02/11/2026

Divisional Railway Manager (W), Sr. DEN(W), West Central Railway, Bhopal

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

{ GURMEET SANGHA RAI }
ON ANIMALS BY RAGHU RAI

Raghu Rai captured images truthfully. That's the kind of person he was. The work is him and he is his work.

On the Books & Authors podcast

HT

{ SEÁN HEWITT } AUTHOR, OPEN HEAVEN

'Love is a great spur to fiction'

The award-winning poet on the texture of memory, William Blake, and his novel that is both queer-centric and pastoral

Saurabh Sharma
letters@hindustantimes.com

1 You once said that you "kind of ran out of life", having already leveraged your experiences in poetry and memoir.

I think perhaps, more than having "run out of life", I felt at the time that I had run out of events, which necessitated the invention of events that lends itself to fiction. Inevitably, and positively, I think all literature carries the marks of its maker, whether that's in some power of observation or a particular viewpoint, even if the maker has to invent characters or plot lines in order to be themselves differently, or more fully. We have singular experiences, though not as many as we might think, since all experiences share common threads across people, but what is really singular about us is the way we think, and the best writing carries the mark of that mind, or tries to.

2 You invoke William Blake in the epigraph. What does his work mean to you?

I find Blake's work so powerful, not only for its bizarreness — and no one could argue that he was not a bizarre writer and painter — but for its radical counter-culturalism. So much of his writing, and I'm thinking particularly about *The Marriage of Heaven and Hell*, offers shocking and transgressive ideas about love, sex, desire, and joy.

I remember reading him when I was younger and being shocked but also liberated by his ideas, especially his proverbs. Like: "Sooner murder an infant in its cradle than nurse unacted desires." I was in love with the simplicity and infallibility of lines such as: "Dip him in the river who loves water." But, most of all, I think he gave me licence to experience the joy of making things, and the joy and necessity of expression.

I have a T-shirt with his painting of Newton on it. And, above my desk, the line "Exuberance is beauty."

3 In the Prologue to *Open, Heaven*, you write about the "imagined reversal", the "return" towards one's past, as both an exercise in fictionalising the real and realising the fictional, making what had transpired somewhat bearable. Do time, and the distance it provides, have a role to play in this novel?

I was interested in giving this texture of uncertainty to *Open, Heaven*. As much as it is about the thing that is returned to, it is also about the act of returning, the failure to return (or the inability to return), and the ways in which the narrator elides certain things, so that the reader is set the task of figuring out what is real and what is not.

I liked having two timelines for the novel, 2002-03, and 2022, though we only visit 2022 twice, briefly. Mainly, this was because it set up a sort of echo over time, and gaps that could only be filled with suggestion and recurrence. We all have our own fictions; I would go as far as to say the majority of our life is a sort of fiction. And love, which is the real core of *Open, Heaven*, is a great spur to fiction.

When we fall in love, we tell ourselves stories about the person we fall in love with, and we hope that the story we've told ourselves comes true. But in *Open, Heaven* the truth sometimes remains unclear, and is lost in the gaps between memories, or between characters.

Days of the Devi

An idol of goddess Durga in a pandal on the first day of the Durga Puja festival. The goddess represents divine feminine energy and symbolises power and the triumph of good over evil. RUPAK DE CHOWDHURI / NURPHOTO VIA GETTY IMAGES

Old patterns in a new age

Historian Deana Heath and political scientist Jinee Lokaneeta, co-editors of *Policing and Violence in India*, discuss the use of force and the suppression of dissent

Chintan Girish Modi
letters@hindustantimes.com

Deana Heath of the University of Liverpool, UK (left) and Jinee Lokaneeta of Drew University, USA.

Your book grew out of a workshop series at University of Liverpool and Jawaharlal Nehru University between 2016 and 2019. What went into making it accessible for non-scholarly readers?

We started with the premise that the book needed to include insight into the cutting-edge research on policing and violence in India that has emerged over the past decade or so, and reveal the work that human-rights lawyers, activists and others have been doing, and to bring these into dialogue. However, when we started getting chapter drafts and doing interviews for the book, it became apparent that we were all skilled at talking to our own particular audiences but less so to a general public, since we all had our own language and approach to the issues that we explore.

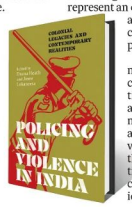
It took time and effort on everyone's part to get us all speaking the same language, and making that language as accessible as possible.

There is a long tradition of human-rights groups in India, that have brought out insightful fact-finding reports, and lawyers, who have done incredible litigation that doesn't always connect with the academic or popular realm. A number of former detainees have written powerful memoirs and prison diaries, and so have some police officers who have attempted models of democratic accountability. The attempt in our book was to connect all these efforts in a unique format with essays as well as shorter discussion pieces and interviews.

What similarities and differences do you notice between police crackdown on non-violent protests under British rule, and protests after Independence?

Post-Independence India, as in the case of India under British rule, has relied heavily on pre-emptive criminalisation, colonial-era statutes such as sedition laws, and heavy-handed force to suppress dissent, in addition to sharing the fundamental objective of protecting state power and socio-political hierarchies from popular challenge.

However, significant differences mark the post-colonial era, not least that police crackdowns have come to operate under the framework of a democratic constitution, which forces the state to rhetorically justify its actions through the lens of national security, public order, and sovereignty. Furthermore, contemporary crackdowns increasingly leverage modern technologies, such as facial recognition, digital surveillance and telecommunications shutdowns, that far exceed the technological capacities of the colonial state.



Policing and Violence in India
Edited by Deana Heath, Jinee Lokaneeta
368pp, ₹799
Speaking Tiger

What efforts are being made with respect to police reform in India, especially to address custodial violence faced by LGBTQ+ people, Dalits and minorities?

Efforts towards police reform in India — championed largely by civil-rights lawyers, activists, and grassroots organisations — include pushing for judicial compliance with landmark Supreme Court directives such as mandatory CCTV installations in police stations and strict arrest procedures. However, systemic impunity remains a formidable barrier, particularly when addressing custodial violence targeting vulnerable groups such as Dalits, Muslims, and LGBTQ+ individuals.

Legal infrastructure and bureaucratic hurdles often work to shield perpetrators rather than deliver justice, which makes institutional reform an ongoing, uphill battle. One of the ironies of police reform in India has been that landmark cases such as the 2006 Prakash Singh vs Union of India one have been initiated by the police themselves. The focus here is more on ensuring autonomy of the police from political interference, which is definitely a challenge. However, that has also meant that accountability for police violence has remained even more elusive than usual.

Amid the use of facial-recognition technology during protests around the NEET-UG paper leak, what scholarly directions are you drawn to?

We approach such a question as a historian and a political scientist respectively. When it comes to history, it's valuable to think about how contemporary technologies, such as facial recognition, represent an evolution of the technological authoritarianism rooted in colonial surveillance and penal apparatuses.

It is fascinating that technology also comes with its claims of modernity and scientific progress and sometimes as more "humane" than other methods. Yet, as we know, in addition to questions of the validity and reliability of these claims, facial recognition technology raises serious concerns regarding legal ethics and privacy.

How do you view your work in the context of how pro-Palestine campus protests are being crushed in the US and UK?

Viewing contemporary campus crackdowns alongside our own work underscores how Western liberal democracies have come to deploy authoritarian policing tactics when student movements challenge institutional endowments, financial investments, and corporate ties.

While US institutions have frequently opted for spectacular, militarised police raids and mass arrests, UK universities have relied more on a quieter mix of administrative surveillance, private security, and punitive academic measures. Such developments demonstrate that the impulse to crush student dissent is not an isolated anomaly, but part of an architecture of state and institutional control.

Chintan Girish Modi is a journalist, educator, literary critic and arts writer based in Mumbai

{ HT PICKS } NEW READS

GUNS AND PHILOSOPHY

When Bhagat Singh was arrested in 1929, the pistol he carried became a crucial piece of evidence, leading to his conviction for the killing of British police officer JP Saunders. Soon after the trial, the silver-grey .32 Colt went missing.

More than eight decades later, an investigative journalist chances upon a newspaper article that gets him thinking about what might have happened. Driven by curiosity, Jupinderjit Singh decides to follow the trail. This is a book about that quest, its unexpected resolution, and more.

The book traces the arc of Bhagat Singh's intellectual evolution from an idealistic young nationalist to a revolutionary deeply influenced by global currents of socialism, anti-colonialism and rational thought. Drawing on his writings and debates with contemporaries, it illuminates the philosophy that shaped the young man's vision of a free India. Part biography, part intellectual history and part mystery, *Bhagat Singh's Pistol* is as much about a historical relic as it is about how a nation remembers its heroes.

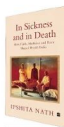
Bhagat Singh's Pistol
Jupinderjit Singh
160pp, ₹350, Westland

DISEASE AND THE FRAGILITY OF COLONIAL CONTROL

When the British first arrived in India in 1608, they knew that deadly diseases lurked in the tropical subcontinent. What they did not foresee was how swiftly these pathogenic forces would puncture European medical hubris.

Sahibs and soldiers, armed with muskets, ledgers and scientific arrogance, found themselves struggling to stay alive. With recurrent public health crises disrupting business, straining infrastructure and draining resources, disease became a central problem of British governance. Over two centuries, the relentless toll shattered the illusion of the invincibility of the white race.

Ipshita Nath's *In Sickness and in Death* draws on a vast body of research to examine how disease reshaped colonial policy, contested imperial ambition, and altered everyday life in the subcontinent, and to show that the politics of disease — determined by fear, force and power structures — are present even today, in the post-pandemic era.



In Sickness and in Death
Ipshita Nath
409pp, ₹799, HarperCollins

RECORD OF A WORLD TRANSFORMED

India is not simply the setting of Rumer Godden's childhood. It is the landscape that shaped her imagination, sense of home, and life as a writer.

Bringing together selections from Godden's autobiographical writing, *Every Least Thing* traces her journey from an unconventional childhood in Bengal to marriage, motherhood, work and the difficult beginnings of her literary career. It follows her through family homes and convent schools, dance classes and tea gardens, periods of hardship and solitude, and the years in which writing gradually became both vocation and escape. Intimate, vivid and sharply observed, these pages reveal the experiences behind some of Godden's best-loved fiction, while recording a world transformed by time, memory and history.

The tales form the portrait of a woman learning to make a life on her terms, and of a writer whose connection to India endured long after she had left it.

Every Least Thing
Rumer Godden
480pp, ₹699, Speaking Tiger

ontheweb

READ: The End of Everything by M John Harrison, which is on the 2026 Booker shortlist, is a work of speculative fiction that is also a literary novel, social satire, and a philosophical meditation on what it means to be human when the world that gave meaning to human behaviour is changing and, in some respects, disappearing.

Scan the QR code to read the review by Pranavi Sharma

{ NON FICTION } AN INTELLECTUAL SELF-PORTRAIT

Narcissists, tyrants and liberal life

Nawaid Anjum
letters@hindustantimes.com

Francis Fukuyama, who will turn 74 this October, begins *In the Realm of the Last Man: A Memoir* on January 20, 2025, the day Donald Trump was sworn in as President of the United States. His second term, the American political-scientist writes in the Preface, marked "a major shift in global politics".

Fukuyama accuses Trump of bypassing Congress through executive orders, issuing unconstitutional diktats, siding with Russia against liberal democracies, and imposing arbitrary tariffs on friendly countries. Only months into the presidency, he writes, "It is hard not to recognize that he is trying to turn the United States into an authoritarian country".

It is a revealing opening for the memoir of a man whose best-known work has haunted him for nearly four decades, as accusation, joke and supposed proof of intellectual folly.

Since his 1989 essay, *The End of History?* and the 1992 book, *The End of History and the Last Man*, every war and democratic collapse has been presented as evidence against him. "None of the individuals asking have read more than the title of my essay or book," he writes.

They missed the five concluding chapters, where he considered how liberal democracy might fail and suggested that "History, rather than ending, had simply paused on its way to an uncertain future".

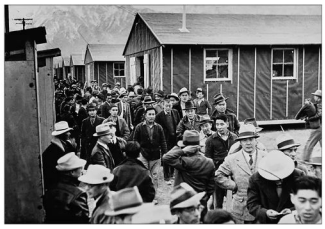
His original claim was narrower than its popular version. Fukuyama argued that liberal democracy might represent the "end point of mankind's ideological evolution" and the "final form of human government".

History meant the development of political ideas. Events would continue and countries could return to dictatorship. No rival to democracy, he maintained, had offered a better answer to the demand for liberty, equality and dignity. The second half of the 1992 title mattered just as much. Fukuyama's *Last Man*, taken from Nietzsche, is the person produced by a secure and prosperous liberal society.

In the Realm of the Last Man: A Memoir
Francis Fukuyama
256pp, ₹699, Hachette

Fukuyama describes himself as "a creature without pride... content with petty pleasures and material well-being". Peace has removed the causes for which earlier generations fought, leaving him restless and short of purpose. At the centre of this argument is the struggle for recognition. People want their equal dignity acknowledged, a desire known as isothymia. Democratic rights answer it by giving citizens a voice and a share of political power.

Equality does not satisfy everyone. Some seek superior recognition, or "megalothymia". This can drive achievement and can also feed narcissists and tyrants.



Detainees at the Manzanar War Relocation Center in California in 1942. The US put about 80,000 American citizens of Japanese origin in prison camps during World War 2. GETTY IMAGES

Fukuyama sees populism as a revolt against the "flattened horizons" of liberal life. Material hardship exists, he says, but anger also grows from humiliation and the suspicion that educated elites look down on ordinary citizens. The man who appears to have everything may still want a battle.

Fukuyama ended his 1989 essay with a line that now reads like forewarning: "Perhaps this very prospect of centuries of boredom at the end of history will serve to get history started once again."

There is an element of self-defence in this reading. If every authoritarian reversal can be described as a pause, the end-of-history thesis becomes difficult to disprove. Liberal democracy can fail repeatedly while remaining humanity's theoretical destination. The thesis shifts from historical prediction towards political conviction: no other system is more desirable.

Fukuyama's claim that his critics failed to read him also dismisses serious objections from those who did.

Early in the memoir, Fukuyama writes briefly about his family. After the attack on Pearl Harbor in 1941, his relatives were interned, regardless of their American citizenship. The family lost property and savings. Fukuyama's defence of liberal rights grew in a family that had seen the state suspend those rights when fear made injustice convenient.

Fukuyama believes the lesson was never fully absorbed. In 2025, he writes, the government returned to mistreating suspected undocumented migrants whose rights should have been protected.

In the Realm of the Last Man is an intellectual self-portrait rather than the traditional autobiography some readers may expect. That reserve keeps the book fixed on the argument Fukuyama wants to settle.

He does not recant the end of history theory. Liberal democracy is now presented as a hard-won arrangement that can be weakened from within, even by the country that once claimed to lead the liberal world. The certainty surrounding 1989 is gone. What remains is his belief that equal rights and accountable government have no better replacement, and his fear that too many people have grown restive regardless.

Nawaid Anjum is an independent journalist, translator and poet. He lives in New Delhi

HT brunch
RELAX. THE WEEKEND'S HERE

Girls who stick together

The Indian women's hockey team took the losses, weathered the trolling and came back swinging. At the Asian Games, they've won Gold after 44 years. Behind the comeback: Precise training, tactical rejigs and a team that learnt to have each other's backs, on and off the field. Squad goals!

Christalle Fernandes
christalle.fernandes@hindustantimes.com

Champion! Champion! Champion!"

After the Indian women's hockey team defeated China 1-0 at the Asian Games this month, they had a victory dance in the locker room. The song: Champion, by Dwayne Bravo. There were shouts of joy. There were celebratory huddles. But there was barely any disbelief. "Going into this tournament, our mindset was fixed," says captain Salima Tete, 24. "We were going for gold, not silver."

It was an ambitious play. The last time Indian women lifted the Asian Games trophy for hockey was in 1982. In May 2025, the 20-member team lost four out of their five matches on the Australia tour. The following month, they ended the FIH Pro League season with eight losses and an army of trolls. "We were losing every match, and with it, our confidence," recalls Tete.

And yet they dreamed of Gold. Because they spent the last year honing not just their play, but themselves too. See how they turned their fate around.

Turning a corner

The Indian Women's hockey team has always been strong, says hockey historian K Arumugam, but routinely missed victory at the last moment. "It's as if there was some kind of jinx," says Arumugam.

When Sjoerd Marijne, their old coach, returned to the team after four-and-a-half years in January , he knew that the women needed to fix their confidence before anything else. "We discussed everything that had gone wrong in the past two years, both on and off the field," says goalkeeper Savita Punia, 36. "He gave us matching bands to wear to remind us that we're a team, and that we're playing for India, not for ourselves." That lesson extended to the small details too: Marijne made the women load and unload their own luggage onto the buses instead of letting the staff do it.

On the field, Marijne's training sessions were precise and demanding. The women alternated between green and red sessions every week. Green meant strength-building and hand-eye coordination exercises. Red was for learning to work around less-than-perfect gameplay conditions: Fewer teammates, passing the ball in a too-narrow space, faster attack and defence. The coaches would split them into teams and have them attack and try to win the ball from each other. They'd repeat it about five to six times. Their performance coach, Wayne Lombard, estimates that each player would run about 25km to 30 km in an average week. "It drains your energy," says forward Navneet Kaur, 30. "But it's an important part of training because that's exactly what happens in an actual game."

Goal in sight

Lombard made them pledge to not eat sweets, chocolates or fast food until the LA 2028 Olympics. Psychologist Ben Wienk introduced team-building exercises: An obstacle course, in which one player led the other blindfolded across the hurdles. But the most important thing to fix was their penalty corner defence. Taeke Taekema, who previously coached the Chinese team, was brought in to teach India's goalkeepers how to sling the ball low against the ground before flicking it across the field in one sharp, forceful move.

The tide had begun to turn as early as June. The team won the FIH Hockey Women's Nations Cup, defeating New Zealand 2-0. Then at the World Cup, they scored two goals against one of their toughest rivals, China, pushing the match to a draw. And during the second quarter of the Asian Games match in October, Punia judged accurately that China's Zhang Ying would shoot to the left, and was able to stop it. It was one of many moments in that match that changed everything.

Arumugam, also the founder of Stick2Hockey.com, says the current Indian women's hockey team has honed their game to the point where "their defensive tactics are unmatched." The team, meanwhile, have taken to calling Marijne, Shah Rukh Khan, after the Asian Games win, a reference to the popular film Chak De where the actor plays a hockey coach.

Curved upwards

There's been a change in how the team bonds with each other. The women hail from as far away as Punjab and Mizoram. They learnt to talk to each other about being homesick or what the coach thinks of their performance. "We share the best and worst times we've had," Punia says. When they're not thinking of hockey, they break out into dance or karaoke sessions.

Marijne is also the one who's always lurking behind corners, waiting to jump-scare the players. "I love scaring Lalremsiami [Hmarzote] especially. Her reactions are Bollywood-level dramatic."

Tough love

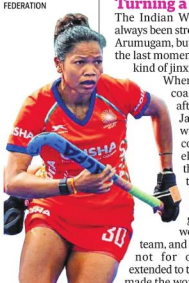
What really turned the team around, Marijne says, was getting the players to see themselves as one unit, sharing the load rather than being bogged down by their own baggage. "If you focus on the team's goal, you will fulfill your individual goals. The other way around will not work."

This lesson was put to the test at the Asian Games, when Sakshi Rana passed the ball to Lalremsiami Hmarzote, who was closer to the goal, knowing she would have a better chance at scoring.

Arumugam calls it a shift from the usual strategy of Asian teams, which is built on individual brilliance, towards a European playing style, which focuses on synchronised effort. "We'd gone over the motions so many times over the past few months, that it was almost automatic," says Kaur.

Bringing the Asian Games trophy home after 44 years has brought renewed attention to the game. Bravo reposted the video of the celebration on his X account, calling them champions. Gautam Gambhir, coach of the national men's cricket team, called them the nation's pride, on X. When Tete opened her WhatsApp after the match, it was inundated with messages. "I haven't even checked them all properly."

They'll carry this moment with them to the Olympics. Hmarzote says "this match has given us all the confidence to believe we can win."



Forward Lalremsiami Hmarzote (above right), who scored the winning goal at the Asian Games, with defender Lalthanthuangi. The women celebrated in their locker room after the win (right). Captain Salima Tete (below) says the team is now fully in sync with each other. Coach Sjoerd Marijne (bottom) came back to the team after four and a half years. PTI, HOCKEY INDIA, ASIAN HOCKEY FEDERATION

column { *rude food* }

Course correction

Delhi, India's food capital, has watched Mumbai and Bengaluru steal its thunder. But a new batch of chef-led restaurants might just give the city its crown back

VIR SANGHVI

Delhi's Dum Pukht (above) serves a biryani that nearly every north Indian restaurant copies. The first chef-driven restaurant of consequence was Ritu Dalmia's (left inset) Diva in Delhi. ITC was the first Indian hotel company to put a picture of a chef Imtiaz Qureshi (below centre) in a national ad. Chef Floyd Cardoz (bottom), is one of the founders of Bombay Canteen. ADOBE STOCK, HT ARCHIVE

There was a time when foodies would compare the merits of Delhi and Mumbai. Delhi usually won. Then, things began to change. Mumbai was seen to have the edge. Bengaluru suddenly joined the race and became recognised as a foodie haven.

I have often wondered (frequently on these pages) why Delhi let its advantage slip. After all, no Indian city has been as influential in food terms as Delhi. What much of India regards as north Indian food was created in Delhi: Tandoori Chicken was popularised here, and Butter Chicken was invented by Delhi's Moti Mahal. The original Moti Mahal dal was refined by Bukhara and remains the single most served dish at Indian restaurants abroad. Just when tandoori cuisine had taken over, Delhi's Dum Pukht popularised the food of Awadh, serving a biryani that nearly every north Indian restaurant now copies and serves.

Even the trend for projecting chefs began in Delhi. ITC was the first Indian hotel company to put a picture of a chef in a national ad. (The chef was, of course, Imtiaz Qureshi.) The first owner/chef-driven restaurant of consequence was Ritu Dalmia's Diva.

So, if Delhi was so far ahead, then how did it fall so much behind?

My theory is that it comes down to the owners of Delhi's restaurants. For most of the last century, large hotel companies such as Taj and ITC were willing to take risks and explore new cuisines and revive old ones. But once the action moved out of the hotel sector, any advances depended on individual restaurant owners. Too many of these people were unwilling to take many risks. As significant was their unwillingness to promote their chefs.

In contrast, nearly every newish restaurant of note in other cities is chef-driven. Sometimes the chefs are owners (with investors, of course) like Alex Sanchez of Mumbai's Americano and Otra. But even when the chefs are not owners, they are allowed to call the shots. Sanchez started at The Table, where the owners Jay Yousuf and Gauri Devidayal were happy to promote his cooking. They have done the same with Will Aghajanian, their current chef.

The chef Floyd Cardoz was one of the founders of The Bombay Canteen and he created a culture where such chefs as Hussain Shahzad are better known than the other partners; and everyone likes it that way. At Masque, the founders Aditi and Aditya Dugar wanted a chef-led restaurant, and they made both Prateek Sadhu and Varun Totlani famous. Riyaaz Amlani takes more pride in the success of his longtime associate Gresham Fernandes at Bandra Born than he does in his own considerable achievements.

In Bengaluru, nearly every highly regarded restaurant is known for its chef. At Farmlore, it's Johnson Ebenezer. At Lupa, it's chef-owner Manu Chandra. At Naru Noodle Bar, it is Kavan Kuttappa. At Karavedi (part of the Taj group) it's Naren Thimmaiah.

Even in Kolkata, a city that has no tradition of adventurous chef-driven restaurants, the success of Sienna is attributed to its two chefs Koyel Nandy and Avinandan Kundu. The Blue Poppy is now nationally famous but perhaps its chef-owner Doma Wang is even more famous than her restaurant.

I have long believed that unless Delhi sheds its Lala culture of owner-driven restaurants and gives chefs the place they deserve, the city will never recapture the foodie imagination. But perhaps that's happening now. The biggest opening of the year has been Gaggan Anand's Raga. But there is also the acclaim that Manish Mehrotra's Nisaba has been greeted with.

Mehrotra's rise is an example for Delhi's restaurateurs to study. He invented an entire school of modern Indian cuisine when he was chef at Rohit Khattar's Indian Accent. He created Comorin in Gurgaon for Khattar's company. He took his fame with him when he opened his own Nisaba. But here's the thing: Even though Nisaba is such a success, both Comorin (headed by chef Dhiraj Dargan) and Indian Accent (run by chef Shantanu Mehrotra) do well.

And in fact, nearly all the best restaurants in Delhi are now chef-driven. Kikli is run by chef Amninder Sandhu. Tres is owned by the Burman group's LiteBite foods, but chefs Julia Desa and Jatin Mallick run it like their own baby. A former Tres chef, Jamsheed Bhote now owns Plats with his chef wife Hanisha Singh and it's my favourite neighbourhood restaurant in Delhi.

At hotels too, the best restaurants are the ones where chefs have a free hand. Delhi has the best Japanese restaurant in India: Megu at the Leela Palace. It also has the best Chinese restaurant: The China Kitchen at the Hyatt Regency. At both places, the chefs call the shots: Shubham Thakur at Megu and Zhang Hongsheng at The China Kitchen.

Will the trend continue? I don't know. In a way, Delhi's restaurant business is a little like Mumbai's film business. Entrepreneurs raise funds from rich guys attracted by the glamour of the business. And when the restaurant fails, they just turn it into a bar and tell the investors that this is even more glamorous.

It's a great way to raise money but not such a great way to serve good food.

The views expressed by the columnist are personal

Delhi is finally recognising chefs more with Gaggan Anand's (above right) Raga and with Kikli, run by chef Amninder Sandhu (centre right). In Bangalore, nearly every highly-regarded restaurant is known for its chef, such as Manu Chandra's Lupa (bottom right).

This week we're...

Feeling our age

High School Musical is 20 years old now. So, it's roughly as old to Gen Zs as Grease was to their parents in 1998. Both smash-hit musicals. Both more camp than Christmas. It's hard to make high-school movies with a goofy, unserious vibe today. So, there won't be a similar movie that kids will worship 20 years on. Filmmakers, you better shape up, up, up...

Sugar-dusting

Put your high score away. Bihar's 19-year-old Shubham Kumar has entered the International Book of Records for reaching level 22,222 on Candy Crush. He's ventured into parts of the game unknown to mankind. He's seen more candy than Willy Wonka. He's our hero.

Splitting up

Two blockbuster clashes are headed our way next month – The Hunger Games: Sunrise on the Reaping and Percy Jackson and the Olympians. And Dunesday is coming for us all on December 18, with Avengers: Doomsday and Dune 3 releasing on the same day. The combo-costume ideas will be insane. We're watching.

Dressing up

Zendaya walked the red carpet so Alexander Skarsgård could run. The actor is promoting Wicker, in which he plays a sexy straw man, and his press-tour wardrobe is bomb. He kicked things off in a gold suit and sheer lace shoes. In the past, he's also given us glittery sleeveless tops, thigh-high boots and teeny-tiny shorts. What's next, Alexander?

Going to prom

A fifth adaptation of Stephen King's Carrie (the first TV series) is here. It's blood-splashingly good. The bullying plays out on Insta, Carrie gets a homeschool backstory to make high-school life seem tougher. Just one complaint: Why does Carrie get skinnier and prettier in every adap? King wrote her as fat and acne-ridden. Even telekinesis can't fix that.

WANT TO READ MORE?
Check out the second page of HT Brunch in the epaper. And dive into stories about life, love, good times and good vibes in the digital magazine, out every Saturday. We're also on hindustantimes.com/lifestyle/brunch, and the HT app (it's free!)

READ the e-mag here!

{ PLAYBOOK }

Splurge, save or just stall

Is a mattress topper or AI assistant truly life-changing? Or is it just a persistent targeted ad? Before you add to cart, see what's worth the buy, and for whom

Shubhangi Bajpai
letters@hindustantimes.com

Sneha Manikyam (right) uses her walk pad for 15-minute after every meal. Yashvardhan Jindal (below inset), who bought a robot vacuum for everyday home cleaning, says it can get stuck or miss spots. Personal assistant services (left) still require time and mental bandwith. SHUTTERSTOCK

Your bank account knows things your therapist doesn't. Like why you spent ₹1,200 on a candle that smells like "rain" when you could have just opened a window. Or why you sprang for a ₹6,990 mattress topper even as your ₹1,499 gym membership sits unused.

Adult money is tricky. Flash sales can make "thoughtfully designed" products feel essential. We've rounded up the products and services everyone's been thinking about, and whether they're worth the splurge. You're welcome.

Breakfast-delivery subscriptions

The claim: You pay upfront for a restaurant to deliver breakfast to you every morning, instead of ordering separately each day. Plans run from three to 30 days and are offered by most food-delivery apps, such as Zomato and Kiaan in Bengaluru. Subscriptions are typically cheaper – anywhere from 10% to 25% less than retail.

In Delhi, designer Alisha Verma, 28, has spent ₹5,505 trying out the service for a month. She booked Chaayos's three-day plan at ₹232 per meal and Caterspoint's 15-day plan at ₹367 per meal. She says it turned out to be cheaper than ordering every day, during a busy work period, when her typical order would cost as much as ₹500 with surge pricing. "Having breakfast sorted saved me time and effort," she says. Sahibjeet Singh Sawhney, marketing head at Zomato, says their weekday breakfast subscriptions have been the most successful in the capital.

Our verdict: If you already have a cook or prepare the meal yourself, compare the subscription with what you'd spend on ingredients, fuel, cooking and cleaning. But if you spend ₹300–400 on individual orders anyway, it can make sense to book a subscription when life gets busy or your cook is away.

Shashank Singh bought a mattress topper (above left) to fix the pain caused by his soft mattress. Alisha Verma (right) says that for her busy life, breakfast subscription services are cheaper than ordering in every day.

Mattress toppers

The claim: A topper, essentially a cushioned, removable top layer for your existing mattress, aims to change how your bed feels. There are firm ones to counteract a too-soft mattress and vice versa. They're also easier to clean than whole mattress. Prices range from ₹3,500 to ₹15,000.

Shashank Singh, a 32-year-old merchandiser in Delhi, was looking to fix the stiffness and pain his soft mattress was causing. A new one would cost ₹30,000; his doctor recommended a two-inch latex topper from Dreamzee for ₹10,500. "I'm of the opinion that a firm mattress is the way to go," says Dr Ramneek Mahajan, orthopaedic surgeon at Max Super Speciality Hospital, Saket. "The back needs to be well supported."

Our verdict: A topper is a cheap fix, but only for a small set of problems. A topper cannot fix a sagging mattress. A too-soft top layer might cause more problems than your bed. Memory foam filling traps heat and might just make sleeping less comfortable, while polyester offers no pressure relief, and will flatten out quickly. Get a topper that secures to the mattress so it doesn't slide around. If pain is driving your purchase, get medical advice first.

Walking pads

The claim: Compact, ultra-slim, they're like a treadmill you can walk but never run on. The ads sell the fantasy that you can casually walk for hours at home, while you binge Netflix or work, getting 10,000 steps in. Expect to pay ₹10,000 for brands such as Lifelong and Cult.

Sneha Manikyam, 31, a software engineer in Bengaluru, bought Lifelong's Fit Pro to do 15-minute walks at home, after every meal. "I don't have an excuse now," she says, "even when it rains. But her machine heats up after 30 minutes. Dr Mahajan says that walking pads can break up sedentary time, but should complement, not replace, cardio and strength training.

Our verdict: A walking pad runs on speeds of 1.6kmph to 3.2kmph. That's not even a brisk walk. Even if you use it every day, you only amble. YouTube has more serious home-workout walking videos that don't need a machine (Brunch loves old-school Leslie Sansone!). If you already have a way to get your steps in, don't spring for the pad. It's not an exercise or weight-loss device. But it will do well for older folks, or those recovering from illness.

Robot vacuum cleaners

The claim: Brands such as Xiaomi, Eureka Forbes and Dreame sell devices that offer vacuum cleaning and floor-mapped, wet-mopping. Prices range from under ₹10,000 to more than ₹50,000 depending on the frills.

Yashvardhan Jindal, 24, a tech consultant in Gurgaon, bought a Xiaomi Robot Vacuum Cleaner S10 for ₹24,000 in December 2024. He uses it to clean up after a house party and for everyday light upkeep. He can "put it on duty and relax", he says, though he still has to empty the device and refill the water tank himself. The cleaner occasionally gets stuck and misses spots.

Our verdict: The robot can only clean the floor – it can't dust the walls and furniture.

So, consider how big the home is, what the floors are made of, what kind of mess is created every day and whether there are pets, spills, tight corners, carpets, high thresholds, stairs and construction dust.

Most robot cleaners struggle with liquid clean-ups, can't reach corners and tight spots. They clean carpets and pick up hair better than they do debris from tiled floors. Bots have been known to knock over vases. Plus, they're noisy. Get one if you are willing to clean the device when needed and there's a human to work the areas a robot cannot.

Personal assistant services

The claim: AI-based automated systems let paid subscribers outsource reminders, follow-ups, appointments and errands to people within their circle. Faff offers a free first month, then charges ₹399 + GST for up to eight tasks or ₹1,999 + GST for unlimited tasks, says co-founder Anirudh Mittal.

Priyanka Kartari, 38, a Mumbai-based therapist and founder of The Thought Co., is on the unlimited plan. She has used it to plan a trip to Lonavala with her four-year-old son, and track expenses. It also handles follow-ups within her team and household (AI voices do the calling and reminding, and report back if the calls go unanswered). Mittal says common requests include vendor coordination, customer-care follow-ups and restaurant or doctor appointments. "I'm paying to take away my mental load," says Kartari.

Our verdict: If tasks regularly pile up and need chasing or coordinating, paying for AI to do it can make sense. But don't automatically choose the unlimited plan. Try out the cheaper version to see if you and those you are coordinating with are open to communicating with AI several times a day. Also, like most AI, this service means giving up some of your data: Scheduling, location data, payment information, texts, contacts. If well-trained human assistants seem like unicorns, this might be a good alternative.

{ RANT AGREEMENT }

Who's calling the shots?

Never mind what Nolan intended. Let the cinema freaks worry about 4K screens and aspect ratios. Let's watch what we like, how we like. They're just movies, after all

Kritika Kapoor
kritika.kapoor@hindustantimes.com

Avatar (top) was supposed to be watched with special glasses only in theatres, with no interval. India doesn't have a single 70mm IMAX screen to watch The Odyssey (above) like Nolan intended.

Turns out, we've been watching movies wrong. All these years, we've been sitting in the dark, eating popcorn, having a good time, oblivious to the fact that we might be missing half the movie. We discovered that this July, when side-by-side stills from The Odyssey on a regular screen and in 70mm IMAX revealed that most of us were watching just the tip of Nolan's cinematic iceberg. In the mass-released version, heads were lopped off, skies were missing, and the FOMO was real.

India doesn't have a single 70mm IMAX screen to watch the movie The Way Christopher Nolan Intended. There are less than 45 IMAX 70mm screens in the world, 25 of them in the US. He deliberately made a movie that the majority of viewers couldn't watch properly anyway.

With epic sagas such as Oppenheimer (2023), Dune: Part 1 (2021), Part 2 (2024), the soon-to-be-released Part 3 (2026) and The Odyssey (2026), booking the right screen has never been more important. We're not just debating the storylines and the performances.

The format we watch the movies in is suddenly also part of the conversation. We're comparing screens, projectors, aspect ratios, sound systems and film stock. Even IMAX digital comes with homework: Check the aspect ratio, make sure it's 4K, find out what projectors the cinema uses. Booking a movie ticket requires more research than buying a laptop.

It's all part of the PR machine. If the goal is to get people back into cinemas, studios are making the viewing experience sound exclusive and technically superior.

According to IMAX's own research, simply knowing that a film had an IMAX theatrical release made 62% of respondents more likely to watch it at home, because they assumed it had higher production quality. Around 70% said seeing the IMAX logo on a poster made a film seem superior, while 90% saw "Filmed for IMAX" as an even stronger endorsement. Many were also willing to pay an extra $3 for a premium screen.

The phenomenon has reached TV too. When the Battle of Winterfell left everyone squinting cluelessly at the screen during the final season of Game of Thrones, cinematographer Fabien Wagner blamed viewers for not knowing how to tune their televisions properly, or for being dumb enough to watch the "cinematic" show on their iPads. For those who are re-watching Friends — originally shot in 4:3 for the boxy TVs of the time — on wide-screen HD TVs how, there are boom mics, stage lights and the edges of set walls in the frame. How to find the "right" format when it doesn't exist today?

Cinematographer Kaushal Shah, whose credits include An Action Hero (2022) and Gehraiyaan (2022), believes IMAX can add to a film's visual spectacle, but it isn't a prerequisite for enjoying it. "It works best for films like The Odyssey, where the scale of the story and the way it is presented on screen go hand in hand. If a film isn't shot on that scale, watching it on IMAX may not make much of a difference."

And the crop rarely makes an impact on general storytelling. "A good film remains a good film, regardless of the aspect ratio you watch it in. You're still seeing the core of the story — the actors, the performances and the action."

Meanwhile, consider the Mile-High Cry phenomenon: The increased tendency for fliers to get weepy while watching films in an airplane. Researchers have explored how cabin conditions, fatigue and the strange intimacy of watching a story unfold in your own little screen bubble can potentially make us more involved in a movie, more susceptible to tears. No IMAX or giant screens there.

So go on. Watch that movie on your laptop, with a bucket of popcorn, subtitles on and your phone within reach. Cry if you want to. Pause for a bathroom break. Watch it on a screen that doesn't require breaking the bank. You're not doing it wrong. You're just watching a movie.

Friends was originally shot in 4:3 for the boxy TVs of the time. On wide-screen TVs, you can see the stage lights and boom mics. PHOTOS: ADOBE STOCK, MOVIE MISTAKES

{ LISTICLE }

Side-eye these sidelines

These queens, goddesses, spies and scientists deserved more than the roles they got stuck in. Do better, writers!

Arshia
letters@hindustantimes.com

Joi, in Blade Runner 2049 (2017)

Denis Villeneuve casts Ana de Armas as a mass-produced companion for K, a replicant or a bioengineered humanoid (Ryan Gosling). This is a pretty pairing, but Joi shows hints of a more complex interiority than K. Still, she is reduced to cooking, cleaning, and essentially morphing into whoever K wants her to be. K gets all the existential crises and quests. Joi gets to be a cog in K's wheel. What a waste.

Sharon Tate, in Once Upon a Time in Hollywood (2019)

How do you cast a queen like Margot Robbie, get her to play the only central character based on a real person, and still sideline her? You get Quentin Tarantino to direct. His movie focuses on fictional men, actor Rick Dalton (Leonardo DiCaprio) and his stunt double Cliff Booth (Brad Pitt), in 1960s Hollywood. He rewrites Tate's fate by letting Rick and Cliff save her from a serial-killer. Even with the creative license, she doesn't get to save herself.

Aafia Yusufzai Bhinder, in Zero (2018)

OK, this is an SRK film. He's short and this defines him and his ambitions. But Aafia (Anushka Sharma) is a wheelchair-using scientist working on a Mars mission. Sharma worked with an occupational therapist and audiologist to create Aafia's movements and speech. And yet, Aafia is pushed to the margins the minute the hero finds a new love interest, and she stops serving his purpose. A missed opportunity the size of Jupiter.

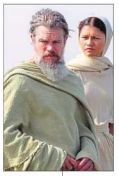
Shruti Sengupta, in Jagga Jasoos (2017)

Imagine being the narrator and still playing second fiddle to a character whose credentials also can't match up to your competence. Ranbir Kapoor plays Jagga, while Katrina Kaif plays the investigative journalist trying to crack an international arms-smuggling racket. She brings her own network, knowledge and wit, which ultimately collide with Jagga's search for his lost foster father. Eventually, her quest gets absorbed into Jagga's mission, serving only as a sidebar to his adventures. Boo!

Nomi, in No Time to Die (2021)

Bond girls have, over the years, had meatier roles in the movies. But Nomi (Lashana Lynch), the agent who has taken the 007 designation after Bond's retirement, gets an all-too-brief chance at wowing MI6. Bond is dragged back into the field to save his old lover and their daughter. But Nomi, his professional equal, is there just to anchor the weight of Bond's fame. She's made to ultimately hand back the 007 badge; just a piece in Bond's ceremonial swansong.

Helen of Troy and Athena, in The Odyssey (2026)

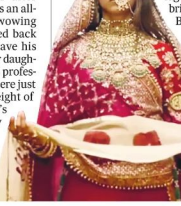


There are no great women in Christopher Nolan's films. With Homer's epic, there was a chance to change that. Instead, the tale turns out to be just Odysseus (Matt Damon) on an eventful journey home after the Trojan War. Helen (Lupita Nyong'o), over whom the war was fought, only gets to rage about what men have done in her name, and kill her husband. Goddess Athena (Zendaya) fares worse. She's a protector, but appears intermittently, to do sweet nothing.

Elizabeth de Burgh, in Outlaw King (2018)

Florence Pugh is dynamite enough to shine even in a small part. She plays Elizabeth, Scottish king Robert the Bruce's second wife, in this 14th-century period drama. There's scope for firey cinema when she is captured by the English, and would rather be locked in a cage than renounce her husband. And Pugh brings wit, humour and resolve to her role. But the film never gives her enough room to shine or tell a real story.

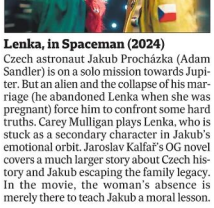
Rani Padmaavati, in Padmaavat(2018)



As the title suggests, the movie is literally about a Rajput queen: A skilled hunter, shrewd politician and strategist. We know Deepika Padukone can handle complex roles. And yet, much of the movie is about her husband Ratan Singh, and Sultan Alauddin Khilji (who's obsessed with her, sight unseen). She gets little screen time and even less agency. She's stuck being an ideal instead of a person. Do we even know what made her heart sing?

Geetanjali, in Animal (2023)

Sandeep Reddy Vanga cast Rashmika Mandanna to play the woman who holds a batshit, dysfunctional family together. Even then, she's basically the background, there to balance Ranvijay (Ranbir Kapoor) an emotionally stunted man with daddy issues. Take him away from the screen, and Geetanjali ceases to matter. Her emotions are only a response to her husband's violence and toxicity. She's never more than an afterthought.



Lenka, in Spaceman (2024)

Czech astronaut Jakub Procházka (Adam Sandler) is on a solo mission towards Jupiter. But an alien and the collapse of his marriage (he abandoned Lenka when she was pregnant) force him to confront some hard truths. Carey Mulligan plays Lenka, who is stuck as a secondary character in Jakub's emotional orbit. Jaroslav Kalfař's OG novel covers a much larger story about Czech history and Jakub escaping the family legacy. In the movie, the woman's absence is merely there to teach Jakub a moral lesson.

WORLD

Russia hits Ukraine as Zelensky's ties with Trump slump

Agencies
letters@hindustantimes.com

BRUSSELS, KYIV: European leaders on Friday rallied around Ukraine's Volodymyr Zelensky as Kyiv's ties with US President Donald Trump have nosedived and worries grow that US leader is increasingly siding with Russia, AFP reported. Russian attacks on nine regions of Ukraine caused emergency power outages for hundreds of thousands of households and damaged numerous homes, wounding at least 15 people, officials said Friday, Reuters reported.

Relations between Kyiv and Washington have soured since last week, when Trump eased sanctions on Russia in exchange for Moscow releasing large amounts of diesel onto global markets.

Zelensky infuriated Trump further by ordering Ukraine's forces to restart strikes on Russian oil refineries in defiance of Washington's demands.

'Disgrace'

Zelensky has had to endure a rollercoaster relationship with Trump since the mercurial US leader returned to office last year vowing to cut Washington's support for Kyiv.

Trump on Thursday branded renewed Ukrainian attacks on Russian oil infrastructure a "disgrace" and said Kyiv was driving up global energy prices.

"I think I find Zelensky to be more difficult to deal with than Putin," the US leader said in an interview with Newsmax. The Kremlin has sought to capitalise on the latest breakdown between Kyiv and Washington, blaming Ukraine for derailing US peace efforts by resuming its strikes on refineries.

Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelensky (right) with EU leaders on the sidelines of an EU summit in Brussels. AFP

Trump: Neither me nor Musk responsible for Ukraine Starlink

Reuters
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump said on Friday that he did not think either he or Elon Musk was responsible for Ukraine losing Starlink access in a way that affected its military operations against Russia.

The reduction in services provided by the satellite company interrupted communications with headquarters and caused internet speeds to drop.

Trump, speaking to reporters as he left the White House on a trip to Georgia, said neither he nor Musk was responsible for Ukraine losing Starlink access. Any limit to Ukraine's access to the Starshield system was not imposed by the US, Trump added.

Europe must tackle Starlink dependency, EU leaders say

EU leaders grappled Friday with how to tackle Ukraine's dependence on Starlink satellite communications supporting its battlefield operations. The bloc's foreign policy chief Kaja Kallas said Europe did not have a readily available alternative to technology controlled by Elon Musk's SpaceX, as she arrived at an EU summit where the issue will be high on the agenda.

"Starlink is really necessary for Ukraine and unfortunately in (the) short term Europe can't replace this capability," Kallas said before the talks.

U.S. TEMPLE ATTACK BID: SUSPECT'S CAR SIGHTED IN TEMPLE PARKING LOT HRS BEFORE HIS ARREST

Associated Press
letters@hindustantimes.com

CHICAGO: Illinois authorities believe a 19-year-old man charged with planning a mass shooting at a Hindu temple in suburban Chicago entered the building's parking lot on Sunday, hours before police arrested him near his home after receiving a tip about the alleged attack plan.

Authorities said Wednesday that they had arrested Alexandros Paporakis. The leaders of Sri Venkateswara Swami (Balaji) Temple said a security threat had "targeted our Temple". Police said a red Acura RDX registered to Paporakis entered a temple parking lot on Sunday around 12.25pm and left less than 15 minutes later. He was seen alone inside the car around 2pm near his home in another suburb.

Paporakis faces felony charges of making a terrorist threat and unlawfully possessing a rifle. Prosecutors have said his co-workers at a Taco Bell location called 911 after Paporakis told them he "couldn't wait to kill Indian people" and said Sunday would be the "special day."

Paporakis told a coworker on Sunday afternoon that his gun jammed and he left quickly, but promised to "retry," according to prosecutors. He sent the coworker a video showing an AR-style rifle and a photo of himself wearing a tactical vest, they added. Paporakis also sent the coworker an eight-page document in which he used racial slurs to describe non-white people and outlined a plot to kill as many of them as possible. He also described himself as a white supremacist and a neo Nazi who fantasized about mass murder.

Police arrested Paporakis later that day near his home in Palatine, which is located 64.37km northeast of the temple.

Detectives who searched his home found an AR-style rifle, loaded magazines and ammunition, a gas canister labeled with a slur referring to South Asians, and Nazi symbolism.

Trump tells new WH press secretary to reconsider role

Agencies
letters@hindustantimes.com

WASHINGTON: US President Donald Trump said on Friday he told new White House Press Secretary Katie Zacharia she should reconsider her role, Reuters reported. He added that the White House's spokesperson role may not be for Zacharia.

Zacharia's future had appeared after three lackluster interviews with friendly outlets failed to beat back controversy over her claims to be a lawyer, as well as a stumbling debut at the briefing room podium, AFP reported.

Zacharia has described herself as a lawyer during television appearances and on social media, and listed herself as general counsel of a California-based conservative nonprofit. But the 41-year-old acknowledged Thursday she had failed the bar exam, a prerequisite for practising law in the US.

Katie Zacharia

In another interview on Thursday, Zacharia denigrated China when asked how she balances her personal life with her work responsibilities. That led to a lengthy response in which she said Trump's 2016 victory put America back on the path to greatness. "I remember this very distinctly, having just come from China, thinking, 'How is China the next country on the horizon? They don't even have proper toilets,'" Zacharia said.

Zacharia previously lived in China with her husband, moving to the country after graduating in 2011 from Pepperdine Law School in California and subsequently working at the Zhong Lun law firm.

In response, China's foreign ministry on Friday suggested she may want to make another trip to the country. "We welcome her to visit China more often when she has the opportunity," spokeswoman Mao Ning told reporters, fighting back a smile.

Zacharia's debut performance on Tuesday lasted barely 15 minutes. Much of this was taken up by Zacharia reading out -- at an unusually slow pace -- what she said were Trump achievements. She then took questions from only three journalists.

{ FOR FIRST TIME SINCE 1953 }

Pakistan to chair IMF, WB boards next year

Press Trust of India
letters@hindustantimes.com

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan was named the incoming chair of the Boards of Governors of the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank Group (WBG) for 2027, returning to the position for the first time since 1953, the country's ministry of economic affairs said on Friday.

Minister for Economic Affairs Ahad Khan Cheema, who is also Pakistan's governor to the World Bank, was formally announced as the incoming chair during the plenary session of the 2026 WBG-IMF Annual Meetings in Bangkok.

The ministry termed the development a "historic milestone" and said the chairmanship would provide Islamabad an opportunity to contribute to global economic and development discussions and facilitate constructive dialogue among member countries. The IMF-WBG annual meetings, being held from October 12 to 18, have brought together over 15,000 participants from 191 countries.

Pakistan is engaged with the IMF under a USD 7 billion Extended Fund Facility (EFF) and a USD 1.4 billion Resilience and Sustainability Facility (RSF). Pakistan is borrowing under the EFF to address its balance-of-payments needs and support economic reforms, while the RSF provides longer-term financing to help the country address climate-related risks and strengthen its resilience.

Pakistan is also expected to receive about USD 1.2 billion from the IMF, subject to approval by its Executive Board, after IMF staff and Pakistani authorities reached an agreement on the latest reviews of the two loan programmes.

16-YR-OLD KILLS 4 IN U.S. ELEMENTARY SCHOOL SHOOTING

Associated Press
letters@hindustantimes.com

BEND: A 16-year-old shot his way through locked doors to get into an elementary school in Bend, Oregon, on Thursday, killing three children and a teacher. He was then shot by a person at the scene who followed him inside, authorities said.

The suspect was found dead inside the school minutes after the shooting was first reported, Bend Police Chief Mike Krantz said. The three children killed were aged 5, 8 and 11. Another child, 7, and a teacher, 54, were injured and taken to the hospital in critical condition, he said.

The first 911 call came just before 1pm from a person in a vehicle outside Silver Rail Elementary who reported being shot at by someone with a long gun. The attacker, who police identified as a Bend resident, was shot and went down inside the school shortly after officers arrived, police said.

HT

Trump: Talking denuclearisation with Russia, China

WASHINGTON: Donald Trump said on Thursday Washington is holding talks with Moscow and Beijing aimed at denuclearising the states with the biggest stockpiles of nuclear weapons. During an interview, "I'd love to denuclearise if possible, but we're talking to Russia...and China about that," he said. REUTERS

Astronomers amazed by newly found green star

WASHINGTON: Astronomers have found a green star, a white dwarf that became a ghostly shade of chartreuse after ingesting rocky debris from planets that once had orbited it. The star, named WD J1330+6435, is 280 light-years from Earth in constellation Draco. REUTERS

'Under attack' from fragrance, Hanoi cuts trees

HANOI: Authorities in Vietnam's capital Hanoi began cutting back some of the star-shaped white blossoms of Hanoi's milkwood trees after an outcry from residents over "overpowering" fragrance. AFP

Indian national arrested for US voter fraud

WASHINGTON: The US arrested Mukeshkumar Somabhai Chaudhari, an Indian citizen, for allegedly voting illegally in the 2024 US general election after making a false citizenship claim. He faces five years in jail on each count. HTC

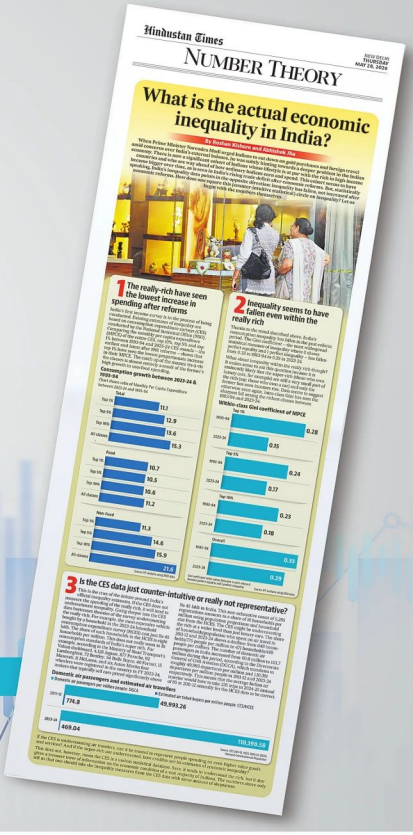
Hindustan Times FIRST VOICE. LAST WORD.

EVERYONE HAS A THEORY OURS HAS THE NUMBERS

Hindustan Times
NUMBER THEORY

Go beyond opinions with evidence-backed insights that uncover hidden trends, challenge assumptions and reveal a deeper understanding of the stories shaping India and the world.

READ NUMBER THEORY IN HINDUSTAN TIMES



hindustantimes htTweets www.hindustantimes.com

Sebi's curbs on gold MF could have an ETF catch

Srushti Vaidya
srushti.vaidya@livemint.com

MUMBAI: India's market regulator has directed mutual funds to bar fresh investments in gold mutual fund schemes, a move likely aimed at curbing demand for the precious metal, but it has left gold exchange-traded funds (ETFs) untouched, a gap that experts say could blunt the curbs because investors can still buy gold through the stock market.

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) has asked MFs to stop accepting fresh lump-sum investments, systematic investment plans (SIPs) and systematic transfer plans (STPs) into gold ETF fund-of-funds (FoFs) from 16 October, two industry officials told Mint. The curbs do not apply to gold ETFs.

The move may be aimed at curbing gold imports and easing pressure on the rupee, which has hit a string of record lows this year. But the curbs may achieve little if investors go for direct gold ETF buys.

"The intention is to curb fresh investment in gold," said Kartik Sankaran, founder of Fiscal Fitness, a mutual fund distributor. "However, halting gold FoF inflows while allowing creation of new ETF units could defeat the purpose."

The distinction matters because investors can buy gold ETFs directly on stock exchanges, although they need a demat account to do so. Gold ETF FoFs, by contrast, invest in gold ETFs and allow investors to gain exposure to the precious metal without opening a demat account.

Gold ETFs account for 66% of the industry's gold assets, while 34% sits in gold funds currently affected by the restrictions. ISTOCKPHOTO

Higher gold imports raise demand for US dollars, putting pressure on the rupee. They also widen the trade gap and, in turn, the current account deficit, increasing the need for external financing. If capital inflows are insufficient, the rupee can weaken further.

Gold prices moved sharply in the first quarter of the year. MCX spot gold rose 20% between 31 December and 11 March. Prices have since cooled and are now down 8%.

An email to Sebi seeking comment went unanswered.

Gold ETFs account for about 66% of the industry's gold assets, while 34% sits in gold funds currently affected by the restrictions, according to Value Research.

"This would rather result in redirecting volume from one investment source, Gold FoFs to another," said N.S. Ramaswamy, head of commodity and CRM at Ventura.

Anil Ghelani, head of passive investments and products at DSP Mutual Fund, said stopping inflows into gold ETFs would require asset management companies (AMCs) to delist the funds from stock exchanges. This would also prevent investors from selling units on the exchange, he said. If fresh investments are to be curbed without hurting investors' ability to exit, then gold FoFs is the only way AMCs can stop new flows, Ghelani said.

An AMC official said fund houses could also restrict fresh investments in gold ETFs by halting issuance of new units. However, this could cause the ETFs to trade at a premium to their net asset value if supply of units is short of demand.

The rationale for Sebi's move remains unclear, particularly as India's gold imports fell in the September quarter, an industry official said.

Gold imports fell 27.3% to $10.27 billion during April-September, from $26.51 billion a year ago. In September, imports were at $1.80 billion versus $9.61 billion a year ago.

Gold-related MF investments make for only a small part of India's overall gold demand, dominated by physical purchases of jewellery, bars and coins, said Ramaswamy.

"Additional gold backing for the gold FoF is sourced not necessarily via new bullion imports; it is also managed from existing domestic inventories. Restricting MFs only slows down one financial stream. It doesn't control physical retail jewellery buys, direct bar-and-coin buying, or existing systematic investment plans (SIPs), which still account for bulk of India's massive annual gold consumption," Ramaswamy said.

Gold ETFs attracted ₹45,951 crore in net inflows in the year to September, as per the Association of Mutual Funds in India. January saw for the largest share, at ₹24,029 crore.

In June, large fund houses had also restricted high-value investments in gold ETFs and FoFs, primarily limiting investments of ₹10 lakh or more. The move followed Prime Minister Narendra Modi's appeal to Indians to buy less gold to help protect the rupee from further depreciation.

Battered IT stocks shrug off weak earnings as AI fears ease

Jas Bardia
jas.bardia@livemint.com

BENGALURU: India's beaten-down information technology (IT) stocks are rebounding as fears that artificial intelligence (AI) will disrupt traditional tech services ease and investors turn to Indian IT amid a global tech sell-off, even after a weak September quarter for the sector's top names.

Shares of India's four of five largest IT services companies rose by as much as 8% on Friday, extending gains even after a muted September quarter. Three of the top four—Tata Consultancy Services Ltd (TCS), HCL Technologies Ltd and Wipro Ltd—posted their weakest September quarter performance in three years.

The rally came as tech stocks saw a sell off in South Korea, with the Kospi's 14% decline this week pointing to a shift in global investor positioning. Easing concerns over AI and a rotation in global tech investments appear to be lifting sentiment toward Indian IT, whose valuations had been under pressure since the AI boom stoked disruption fears, analysts said.

AI stocks came under pressure globally amid concerns that slowing revenue growth, rising infrastructure costs and tighter financing conditions could undermine lofty valuations. The Nasdaq 100 has fallen 3% since Monday.

The sentiment back home also got a lift from finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman's remarks this week that she was open to views on taxation in capital markets.

"One of the factors may be the finance minister's comments that foreign portfolio investors may be exempted from capital gains tax. Should this happen, IT stocks may benefit, given their relatively beaten-down valuations, especially if it is accompanied by the unwinding of the AI trade globally," said Pramod Gubbi, founder of Marcellus Investment Managers.

The Nifty IT index, a gauge of software firms, surged around 12% this week, while MSCI World Information Technology Index fell 4.5%, per Bloomberg data.

Shares of Wipro and Tech Mahindra Ltd rose 6% and 7%, respectively, on Friday, a day after they reported their September-quarter results. TCS and HCLTech, which reported earnings last week, gained nearly 3% and 8%, respectively.

The gains came despite modest revenue growth . Wipro, India's fourth-largest IT services firm, reported a sequential revenue decline, while the other three recorded growth of no more than 2.1% sequentially. TCS, HCLTech and Wipro also reported their weakest September-quarter performance in three years.

TCS's revenue rose 0.2% sequentially to $7.64 billion,

Shares of India's four of five largest IT services firms rose by as much as 8% on Friday. PTI

while HCLTech and Tech Mahindra each saw about 2% growth to $3.72 billion and $1.69 billion, respectively. Wipro's revenue fell 0.1% to $2.61 billion. Wipro retained its guidance for the December quarter, forecasting constant-currency revenue growth of up to 0.5%. HCLTech retained the upper end of its full-year revenue growth guidance at 4% in constant-currency terms. TCS and Tech Mahindra do not provide revenue guidance. Constant-currency growth excludes impact of exchange-rate fluctuations.

"Expectations were very low for IT. The compression in the legacy business line is not as severe as expected, which is also getting some relief due to inorganic expansions," said Shubham Dalia, lead IT analyst at Ashika Institutional Equities.

"The market is expecting that things might not get worse from here, and thus we are seeing positive momentum. This, coupled with the Kospi sell-off, is pushing Indian IT stocks higher."

The Kospi sell-off also put pressure on tech shares globally, potentially nudging investors to reassess exposure to AI trade and consider Indian IT services firms whose valuations have already corrected.

A relook of the assumption that AI rise will erode the value of traditional IT services firms is also a support. Investors are questioning if the spending on AI infrastructure will bring commensurate returns.

"Pace of capital expenditure by hyperscalers renting out compute to OpenAI and Anthropic is coming under question as monetization through enterprise and consumer AI adoption falls short of expectations, particularly in the context of the expected IPO valuations. Second, as interest rates rise and financing gets tight, the hurdle rates for the capex go up and become harder to justify. Coupled with question marks on the ability to monetize this capex given slow AI adoption, the AI trade could unwind. IT stocks which got hammered by AI's rise could benefit from this unwind," Gubbi said.

Lower valuations and Indian IT companies' efforts to expand their AI businesses are also lifting the sentiment.

Reliance welcomes Starlink, stresses law compliance

Press Trust of India
feedback@livemint.com

NEW DELHI: Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL) on Friday said it does not fear competition and welcomes it in satellite communications sector, including from Elon Musk's Starlink, but asserted that every player must abide by Indian laws.

The company issued a statement to "place the facts on record", its first direct response after a recent spate of public barbs by billionaire Elon Musk over competition in India's satellite communications market. Musk had criticised Reliance and argued that greater competition would benefit consumers in satcom space.

"In light of recent remarks about Reliance and the Indian market, we wish to place the facts on record...At Reliance, we have never feared competition. We see it as the truest test of who serves the customer best," the statement said.

Jio itself entered India's crowded telecom market in 2016 as the newest player, with not a single customer, and in a matter of just ten years, earned the trust of over 530 million customers, offering Indians some of the best digital infrastructure and most affordable data in the world, the statement said.

It added: "We welcome competition in satellite communications, including Starlink. Every player, Jio included, must serve the people of India and abide by the laws and policies of the land".

Like every Indian enterprise, Reliance said, it too has grown in an India that welcomes investment and innovation, homegrown or international, that improve the lives of the people.

"That openness rests on the rule of law. As Government of India has stated, it applies the same process to every applicant, Indian or foreign. Jio's own satellite services await clearances," the statement said.

YES BANK FLAGS CAPITAL HIT AS SC BACKS AT-1 BOND REINSTATEMENT

Subhana Shaikh
subhana.shaikh@livemint.com

MUMBAI: A day after the Supreme Court quashed the March 2020 write-off of Yes Bank's ₹8,415 crore additional Tier-1 (AT-1) bonds, the private lender said on Friday that the decision is expected to erode its common equity tier-1 (CET-1) capital ratio by 250 basis points, including profits, as of 30 June 2026. However, the bank's overall tier-1 capital ratio is expected to remain unchanged at 14%, it said in a statement.

CET1 capital is a bank's highest-quality, core regulatory capital that absorbs financial losses immediately when they happen without forcing the bank to cease operations. Introduced under the Basel III framework, it acts as the primary safety cushion to protect depositors and maintain financial stability.

The Supreme Court's decision brings a six-year legal battle over the bonds to a head. In 2020, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) took control of the struggling private lender to facilitate a bailout, appointing an administrator who wrote off the bank's AT-1 bonds worth ₹8,415 crore. The Bombay high court had quashed the write-off in 2023, and the apex court on Thursday said it found no reason to reverse that.

The bank said that it was reviewing the Supreme Court's 15 October judgment and its implications, and would make suitable disclosures in due course. The bank did not specify the revised CET1 ratio following the reinstatement of the AT1 bond principal.

For the quarter ended June, the bank was well capitalized with its capital adequacy ratio at 15.1% and CET-1 ratio of 14.0%. This has come as Japan's Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp. (SMBC) last year bought a 24.22% stake in the Mumbai-based mid-sized bank. During the period, its net profit was ₹1,071 crore, up 34% on the year.

AT-1 bonds aggregating ₹8,415 crore, had been written down in March 2020 in connection with the reconstruction of Yes Bank.

AT-1 bonds are perpetual debt instruments that qualify as additional Tier-I capital under Basel III. These trigger points are linked to a bank's capital and earnings. If these triggers are breached, interest payments may be stopped. This situation could even lead to the conversion of the bond into equity. The SC's Thursday order also stated that the annual coupon payments on the AT-1 bonds would remain unaffected by the outcome of the appeals and must be made in accordance with the relevant information memoranda.

China ready to address trade concerns after FM's remarks

Press Trust of India
feedback@livemint.com

BEIJING: China on Friday said it was ready to work with India to address "each other's" economic and trade concerns after Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman criticised Beijing's restrictions on market access for the country's products.

"What I can tell you is that China never aims for trade surplus", Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Mao Ning told a media briefing, replying to a question on Sitharaman's comments reiterating China's stand on India's concerns over the trade deficit.

"We stand ready to work with India to address each other's economic and trade concerns in a balanced way and promote the steady development of bilateral relations", she said, stating that the question is to be addressed to relevant Chinese authorities.

Reacting to India's trade deficit with China crossing USD 100 billion in the first nine months, Sitharaman on Friday said the growing trade imbalance and persistent restrictions on market access for Indian products remained major concerns, despite years of engagement with Beijing.

Nirmala Sitharaman, finance minister. PTI

India has consistently sought market access in China for products such as generic medicines, bovine meat, vegetables and other perishable goods, but made little progress despite years of engagement, Sitharaman said in an interaction with the Atlantic Council on the sidelines of the IMF-World Bank annual meetings in Bangkok, Thailand.

"Non-tariff barriers are the biggest hurdle in the trade between India and China," she said, adding that China had used phytosanitary measures and other non-tariff restrictions despite the potential for discussions and investigations to resolve such issues.

She said India had not adopted the approach of imposing punitive tariffs on trading partners to correct large trade imbalances, preferring instead to pursue negotiations, even if the process was time-consuming.

Sitharaman was reacting to nine-month trade data released by China Customs on Wednesday, revealing India's trade deficit with China widened to $105.93 billion, which is a 20.7% increase compared to last year.

The total bilateral trade grew to $144.45 billion, registering 25.4%, according to the data for January to September released by China Customs.

China's exports to India touched USD 125.19 billion, registering a 23.3% increase.

Indian exports to China too continue to grow, touching $19.26 billion, registering a 40.7% increase compared to the same period last year.

Over the years, India has been demanding that China open its IT, pharma, and agricultural produce, which are India's strong areas, but with little success.

RBI OKAYS NBD INDIA BRANCHES' MERGER WITH RBL

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank on Friday said it has sanctioned the scheme of amalgamation of Indian branches of Emirates NBD Bank (P.J.S.C.) with RBL Bank. The effective date of the amalgamation will be December 1, 2026, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) said in a statement.

"All the Indian branches of Emirates NBD Bank P.J.S.C. will function as branches of RBL Bank Limited with effect from December 01, 2026," it said.

In May, the Finance Ministry had granted approval to the Dubai-based Emirates NBD Bank (P.J.S.C.) for the acquisition of up to a 74% stake in RBL Bank. In 2016, Emirates NBD received the approval of the RBI for opening the maiden bank branch in Mumbai. Emirates NBD commenced its operations in India in July 2017. PTI

{ FROM PAGE 1 }

LEARJET CRASH

VT-DBL, crashed while landing on runway 27 on September 14, 2023, on a non-scheduled flight from Visakhapatnam. All eight people on board were seriously injured.

"The probable cause of the accident was the flight crew's decision to continue the un-stabilized approach under marginal weather conditions and inappropriate handling of aircraft which led to an aerodynamic stall at low altitude from which the aircraft did not recover," the report said.

Several factors contributed to the accident. The crew did not monitor airspeed against a rising low-speed cue, and the monitoring pilot was late in calling for a go-around. Rain impaired the crew's visual cues, the aircraft had a high tailwind, and the crew showed "undue commitment" to land before restrictions at Mumbai took effect. Both engines were working normally, and the aircraft's serviceability did not contribute, the report said.

During the recurrent training of some of the company's Learjet pilots, investigators found, skill checks on critical emergency items were not carried out "in toto" in the one-year cycle.

"The internal audits were not carried out diligently by the company," the report said.

Audit and surveillance reports of the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) reviewed by investigators did not contain the findings that emerged during the probe.

After the Baramati crash, the civil aviation ministry said the DGCA's last audit of VSR, in February 2025, had raised no level-I findings, the most serious category.

TRICOLOUR RALLY

cil, the protesters marched on the road around it.

Dipke was picked up in the afternoon. Around 2pm, a police team served him a notice at a friend's house in Jhandewalan, and in a video released by the CJP an officer can be heard telling him about the march and warning that legal action could follow. Dipke signed the notice. At 4.45pm, as he left the house, he was put into a police car and taken, CJP members said, to Jatarpur Kalan police station. Senior police officers said late on Friday that he was still in custody and would not say when he would be released.

AAP had begun its own march earlier, between 12.30pm and 1pm, carrying a 270-foot tricolour in front of Rashtrapati Bhavan and raising slogans of "Inquilab Zindabad" and "Bharat Mata ki Jai".

By 4pm, hundreds were gathering at Palika Bazaar and around the inner circle of Connaught Place, students and CJP supporters, almost all of them carrying flags, alongside activists of AISA, the Indian Federation of Trade Union (IFTU) and environment activism group Himkhand. Some were pushed back by security personnel on the way but made it through, and the police, with buses parked along the road, could not hold the crowd back.

The crowd spanned generations. "This is the first time I've seen Connaught Place like this. I've never joined a protest and I'm not a CJP supporter but it's good to see kids fighting for their rights. We have been hearing of irregularities in SIR for a long time now. I feel government should fix it now," said Vinod Bajaj, 53, a businessman from Ghaziabad who said he had come only to watch.

Suhana Khan, 22, a student, said she had been detained more than 13 times in the past month.

MODI TO VISIT CANADA

during Canadian foreign minister Anita Anand's interactions with Indian interlocutors in New Delhi this week. "The dates for the visit are presently under discussion and we will announce the visit at the appropriate time," he said, indicating that the two sides were yet to lock down the exact schedule.

Anand was the first to formally announce the visit on Wednesday, saying Canada looks forward to welcoming Modi in December.

Carney also spoke on the phone with Modi on Tuesday, and the two leaders agreed to build on the positive momentum in relations and work towards concrete outcomes in trade, energy, technology, security and people-to-people ties.

People familiar with Modi's schedule said the PM will meet Carney and Canadian business leaders in Ottawa and attend a diaspora gathering in Toronto before travelling to the US for the G20 Summit. Besides travelling to Canada and the US, Modi is expected to go to the Belgian capital of Brussels during December 16-17 for the signing of the India-European Union (EU) free trade agreement.

India and Canada are expected to announce the conclusion of negotiations for the comprehensive economic partnership agreement (CEPA) during Modi's visit. The fifth round of trade talks were held in Ottawa last week. Officials are expected to review outstanding issues in November while the items agreed upon undergo legal scrubbing. HT first reported earlier this month that India is eyeing Carney as the chief guest for the Republic Day celebrations in January 2027.

HINDI MBBS

semester exams in English after switching to English medium in the second year.

So far, 85 students have chosen Hindi medium out of the total 1,000 who have enrolled for MBBS at Bhopal's GMC since 2022-23. Out of these, 65 have already switched to English.

Others are considering whether to follow suit. A second-year student said they have been told that marks will be awarded for medical knowledge and not language. "Our seniors told us writing the exam entirely in Hindi may not fetch good marks. When I got stuck with English grammar, I wrote in Hindi. I am learning to learn and answer in English only," the student added.

In 2022, Union home minister Amit Shah released the country's first Hindi MBBS syllabus and three books, initiating medical science learning in Hindi. Vishwas Sarang, the then Madhya Pradesh medical education minister, described the books as sort of Hinglish in Devanagari script.

The Hindi MBBS course was started after a committee of parliamentarians recommended Hindi as the language for higher education in states such as Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, Rajasthan and Gujarat under the new education policy in 2022. In its 11th report submitted to President Droupadi Murmu in September 2022, the Committee of Parliament on Official Language recommended that medium of instruction in all technical and non-technical institutions in Hindi-speaking states should be Hindi, and in other states their respective mother tongue / local language.

The idea was termed a paradigm shift towards easing education for Hindi-medium students. The Hindi MBBS textbooks were introduced after failed attempts to start engineering in Hindi in MP.

Tesla's flying Roadster could test regulators

Vishal Mathur
letters@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: A few milestones are important. In November 2017, Tesla unveiled the second-generation Roadster with what was termed a "SpaceX Option Package" that envisioned adding around 10 small rocket thrusters around the car to dramatically improve acceleration and cornering. In 2025, Elon Musk dropped hints about a hover-capable prototype involving SpaceX technology, slated for a future reveal. Now, Tesla has given us a first glimpse of an electric car that can be driven upside down, one that briefly hovered, and can do 0-60km/h acceleration in 1 second.

Tesla Roadster pre-bookings are now live in India. The Performance package, defined as "road ready with a seating for two; includes active aero and a multi-mode suction system, is priced at ₹45,05,000. A higher-spec Thrust variant, described as "race ready with seating for two; includes Performance active aero and a multi-mode suction system, plus acceleration thrusters," is priced at ₹2,45,24,000.

The top-tier Rocket option which includes everything from Performance and Thrust plus a "full flight system," is invite only at this time, and its pricing remains unknown. Tesla accepts payments via credit card or UPI. However, before committing to this preorder, it may be prudent to wait-and-watch for actual delivery estimates and regulatory approvals for the suction system as well as the full flight systems for Indian roads.

This may well be the next-generation of an otherwise elusive second-generation Roadster expected to go into production in 2028, and the entire thing which unfolded earlier today on a stream, felt something closer to a stunt spectacle than an actual product unveiling. It will be 9 years since the Roadster's previous iteration, which since that moment in 2017, has never actually gone on sale. The first generation Roadster was on sale between 2008 and 2012.

Tesla unveils its long-delayed Roadster in Texas, US. REUTERS

Tesla says the Roadster's design was inspired by the Lockheed SR-71 Blackbird and the Lockheed Martin F-35 high-performance aircraft. There seem to be three key party tricks for the Roadster concept as it stands today. Upside-down driving capabilities, mid-air flips, and leaping over other cars. It is difficult to say how many of these features will be found road-legal in countries around the world, but nothing stops Elon Musk's Tesla from dreaming and building.

The Roadster drove up a multi-story curved ramp that angled sharply gradually, and used immense downward suction to cling to the surface as it drove vertically upward. Once at the top of the ramp, it flipped over using cold-gas thrusters that gently brought it back to the ground. The Roadster demoed a fan-based suction system that has been built by SpaceX—this is mounted on the underside of the vehicle, and is capable of generating up to two Gs of suction force. The rear wing also has high drag and high downforce modes, something we see in racing cars too.

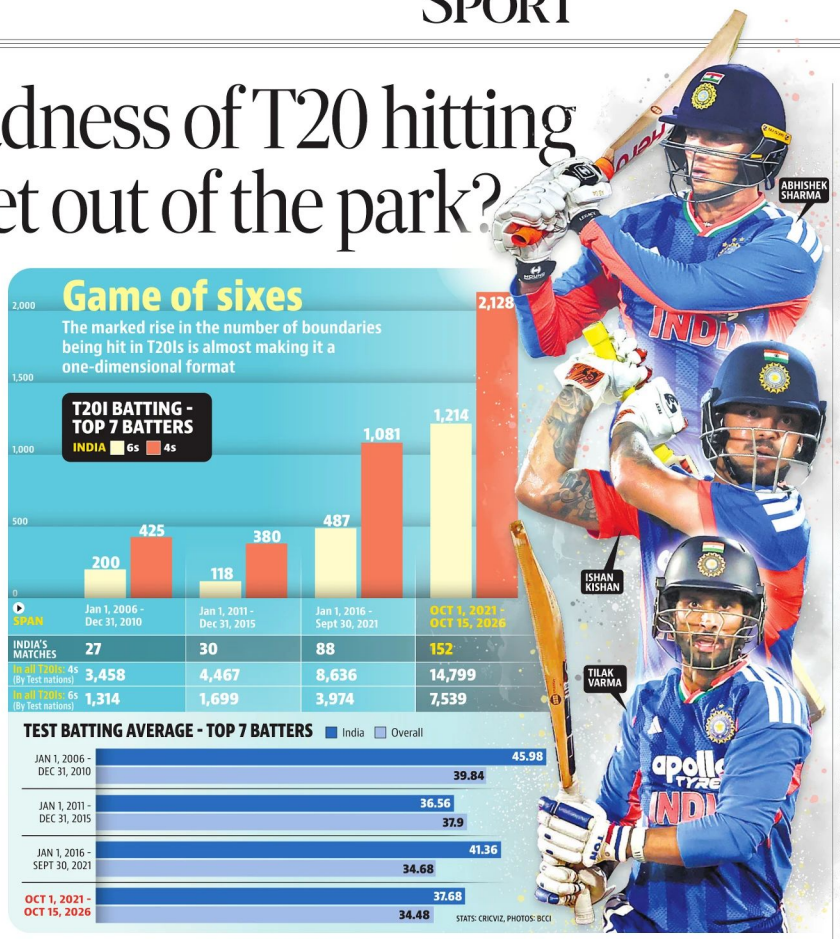
Later, the Roadster flew over its Tesla siblings, the Model 3, Model Y, Cybertruck, Semi, and Cybercab, using attitude-control thrusters and main thrusters mounted towards the rear of the car, for a rocket-like flying trajectory. "It can basically fly like a rocket," Musk said, adding, "It can do, like, crazy gymnastics. Whatever you want."

There is an understanding within Tesla that some of the showcases may not be safety-optimised and will not get the permissions for road-legality. But they're happy having made something that Musk says is "11 out of 10 on the fun meter".

Is madness of T20 hitting cricket out of the park?

The licence to thrill in T20s has brought joy to many fans but it has also come with some drawbacks and perhaps the first wicket to fall has been batting technique

Ashish Magotra
ashish.magotra@hindustantimes.com



NEW DELHI: Between October 1, 2021 and October 15, 2026, India's top seven batters smashed 1,214 sixes in 152 T20Is. One thousand two hundred and fourteen, a number that seems intimidating on its own. But it seems even more so when compared to the previous five-year cycles.

Between 2016-2021, India's batters hit 487 sixes in 88 T20Is. The 2011-2015 cycle saw 118 sixes (in 30 T20Is) while in the 2006-2010 period 138 maximums were hit (in 27 T20Is). The jump in India's six-hitting prowess is astounding, yet worrying at the same time.

Worrying, because in the corresponding cycles, according to data provided by CricViz, India's Test batting average (batters 1-7) has gone from a high of 45.98 in the 2006-2010 cycle to 37.68 in 2021-2026.

This decline in the Test arena is not restricted to India alone. Rather, it is part of a larger global trend that has seen the overall batting average for the top-7 batters for the 12 Test-playing nations drop to just 34.48.

So, before anyone asks 'Are you entertained?,' one perhaps need to wonder how the T20 format is starting to impact cricket as a whole. The India-West Indies series has already seen 98 sixes smashed in four matches and made many wonder whether bowlers have been reduced to being little more than bowling machines.

The evolution of modern sports is a double-edged sword, driven by massive technological leaps, shifting cultural values, and unprecedented commercialisation.

And depending on who you ask, cricket is either entering a golden age of performance and inclusivity, or losing the raw, unpredictable soul that made people fall in love with it in the first place.

In cricket's case, evolution is T20 cricket. The licence to thrill in T20s has brought joy to many fans but it has also come with obvious drawbacks and perhaps the first wicket to fall has been technique.

In T20, the only technique that matters is the one that gets the ball to the boundary line and once technique loses the primacy it deserves, fewer players will practice it. Once fewer players practice it, the standards will start to drop.

In 2024, just after India had lost the Pune Test to New Zealand by 113 runs, Gautam Gambhir touched upon the issue. "Sometimes you're so used to muscling the ball that you end up forgetting the soft hands which probably used to happen eight or 10 years back," the India coach had said.

"A complete cricketer is a cricketer who plays T20 format and Test cricket successfully. He can adapt his game.

"Growth is not only about hitting the ball in the stands. It's also about batting sessions on a turning track where you know that you will not be able to hit in the stands but you'll be able to rotate better. For that, I think the foundation is very, very important."

He had pertinently added: "But you will see, probably going forward in future, we'll have the same issues with a lot of other teams as well because the more the T20 cricket is played, the lesser people will start defending."

This is exactly why early finishes are fast becoming the norm in Test cricket. Everyone just wants to have a hit. If defending is a grind, then the big hit is freedom.

Discussing the trend on Sky Sports during England's recent series against Pakistan, former England skipper Michael Atherton had said, "Nass (Nasser Hussain) and I played in the 1990s, and the number of games that finished in three days or less was around 7%, and that is now at 20%, so that is a big difference. In the last decade, there have been nine occasions where Test matches have finished in two days, and there wasn't a single occasion of a two-day Test between 1946 and 2000. So, I think, the general starting point is that Test matches are going quicker."

T20 has certainly made cricket more popular and even helped it become part of the Olympic family. But, at the same time, it cannot be denied that it has also robbed the game of some of its charm.

In the years gone by, there used to be a certain amount of awe that a six would evoke. It was about timing and power. It could earn a batter a reputation.

But now, with the potent mix of technology and intent, no stand is out of reach for even the tailenders.

This is also why the moving ball poses such a huge challenge to the batters of this era. Why defend or play tight when it might be easier to hit a quick 30 and move on? The 'everybody's doing it' defence has no real value as an argument because many fans have seen other batting greats do it right and do it better.

The last of the generation that started learning the game before the focus moved firmly to T20 cricket is getting ready to hang up their boots. With them, will the old ways die too?

As things stand, the madness of T20 is making the game richer, yet poorer. And that should be reason enough to alarm the International Cricket Council. They need to strike a balance. Maybe many cricket boards feel that popularity is the only way forward but perhaps they should also wonder where that leaves the sport that we all grew to love.

Bhuvi's possible India comeback in final T20I v WI

Sanjeev K Samyal
sanjeev.samyal@htlive.com

MUMBAI: With shorter boundaries and a pitch offering bounce, Bengaluru's M Chinnaswamy Stadium is a venue most bowlers dread to play on. However, ask Bhuvneshwar Kumar for his choice, he will be more than happy to bowl at the historic ground.

The final match of the India versus West Indies series, tied at 2-2, will be played in Bengaluru Saturday, and due to a turn of events, there's a big chance Bhuvneshwar may find himself leading the Indian attack.

Originally picked for the New Zealand T20 series on the back of his 45 wickets across 30 matches for RCB in their victorious 2025 and 2026 IPL editions, India have added the 36-year-old to the squad as cover for Arshdeep Singh. The left-arm pacer suffered a blow to his bowling shoulder towards the end of the fourth T20I in Hyderabad on Wednesday.

Bhuvneshwar, who has been recalled after four years into the T20I squad for the New Zealand tour, is expected to boost the home side's struggling bowling attack. The attack will look up to the pacer for inspiration, having come under heavy fire from the West Indies power-hitters, who won two games by amassing 252/4 in 18.3 overs in the second T20I and 247/3 in the fourth.

The stage is set for another run-athon, although the forecast is for weather interruptions. However, Bhuvneshwar could make a difference. While most bowlers struggle on the batting-friendly ground, it brings out the best in the Uttar Pradesh player. Ever since dream T20I debut with a spell of 4-0-9-3 against Pakistan in 2012, he has thrived in the Bengaluru conditions. He provided proof of this special connection earlier this year in IPL, taking 11 wickets, including three 3-fors, in five games for RCB.

In T20s, getting regular breakthroughs is important and that is where the importance of a crafty wicket-taker like Bhuvneshwar lies. He always had mastery with the new ball, and he has reinvented his game in the last two seasons where he is effective in the later overs too, including death bowling.

In the fourth T20I that India lost, they could take only three wickets in 20 overs, their lone wicket in Powerplay coming after a stand of 52 in 4.2 overs. In the second T20I, India took only four wickets.

In both their wins, West Indies skipper Shai Hope led from the front with brilliant hundreds. He is the leading batter in the series with 261 runs at a strike rate of 190.51. Getting him early could be half the battle won.

In the first four games, apart from Arshdeep, Mayank Yadav and Prince Yadav were the frontline fast bowlers in the squad. Mayank has cranked up impressive speeds and picked up wickets but they will be fully tested at the Chinnaswamy Stadium. Hence, Bhuvneshwar's battle with Hope could prove decisive.

India bowling coach Morne Morkel welcomed Bhuvi's return. "I am very excited to have him back in the mix. His experience will add a lot of value to a younger bowling attack," he told the media on Friday. As for Arshdeep, Morkel said a final call will be taken before the match. "Arshdeep is recovering well, so he is definitely not ruled out. But they will make a call tomorrow at some stage."

The India team management could rethink their combination, and perhaps add wrist spinner Kuldeep Yadav ahead of all-rounder Naman Dhir. Also, considering that the series has been reduced to a power-hitting contest, there's a case for Vaibhav Sooryavanshi and Abhishek Sharma's spin to fill in for the fifth bowler.

Bhuvneshwar Kumar could make an early comeback today. BCCI

Deepti, Niki steer India home versus Zimbabwe

Samreen Razzaqui
samreen.razzaqui@hindustantimes.com

Deepti Sharma (L) and Niki Prasad after the match in Raipur. BCCI

NEW DELHI: Not even four overs into the innings, India were in deep trouble. It was hardly the ideal start to Smriti Mandhana's captaincy tenure as Zimbabwe, facing India for the first time, put the hosts' top order under immense pressure, leaving them reeling at 19/4 in the first T20I at Raipur on Friday.

In the end, India, who had restricted Zimbabwe to 114/5, won by four wickets, reaching 116/6 in 15.4 overs. Niki Prasad's debut ended up being baptism of fire but she took India home for a four-wicket win. The former India U-19 captain, however, had been in a similar situation during her Women's Premier League debut for Delhi Capitals in 2025.

With DC needing 89 off 65 balls and their top four back in the dugout, Prasad rose to the occasion, producing a match-winning 35 off 32 balls against Mumbai Indians in Vadodara to earn the player of the match award.

She again showed composure under pressure, scoring an unbeaten 39 off 35, joining forces with the ever-reliable Deepti Sharma to stitch together a crucial 82-run partnership and pull India out of trouble. With her experience and composure, the seasoned allrounder guided the youngster through a difficult phase, helping India steady the innings after a disastrous start.

Deepti was dismissed for 49 by Ollinder Chare but Prasad stayed on till the end, taking the team across with the line, the winning runs coming off her bat with 4.2 overs to spare.

Earlier, India's bowlers pulled things back impressively after Zimbabwe made a promising start, restricting the visitors to 114/5. Zimbabwe were comfortably placed at 60/1 at the halfway stage, with Kelis Ndhlovu and Modester Mupachikwa building a solid platform.

Ndhlovu led Zimbabwe's early charge, striking seven fours in her 42 off 44 balls. She found the boundary regularly in the first half of the innings, while Mupachikwa provided support scoring 16. The pair appeared to have laid the foundation for a competitive total before India's bowlers wrested control.

Spinner Shree Charani was effective again, dismissing Mupachikwa and finishing with economical figures of 1/14 from her four overs. Ndhlovu raced to 42 off 32 deliveries before pacer Arundhati Reddy bowled her with a full toss.

There was some drama just before Ndhlovu's dismissal, when debutant Niki Prasad's diving effort at long-off was initially ruled a catch. Replays showed that the ball had touched the turf, allowing the batter to continue until before Reddy broke through.

With Zimbabwe struggling to find momentum, Sharne Mayers took responsibility for the late acceleration, scoring an unbeaten 43 off 33 balls, providing the innings much-needed impetus. Despite the big hits, Zimbabwe found it difficult to rotate the strike as India maintained their grip and held them back at 114/5.

Brief scores: Zimbabwe 114/5 (Kelis Ndhlovu 42, Sharne Mayers 43, Nandani 2/11). India 116/6 in 15.4 ovs (Niki Prasad 39, Deepti Sharma 49, Nyasha Gwanzura 3/18). **India won by 4 wkts.**

GILL, RAHUL TO MISS LAST 2 ODIS, BUMRAH RETURNS FOR NZ TESTS

HT Correspondent
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Shubman Gill will lead in the first three ODIs and then leave to prepare for the two Tests that follow, an assignment that holds great importance for India's chances to qualify for the WTC final. BCCI said while naming the ODI and Test squads for the NZ tour. Shreyas Iyer will lead India in the fourth and fifth ODIs.

The players released after the first three ODIs are likely to play the third and final unofficial Test between India A and New Zealand A, which gets underway on November 7. The ODI series begins on Nov 4 and ends on Nov 15. The first Test is scheduled to begin in Wellington on Nov 19.

Besides Gill, KL Rahul too will miss the fourth and fifth ODIs. Jasprit Bumrah has not been named in the ODI squad, and he will only play the Tests. The ace speedster last played a Test against South Africa last November, where the Proteas defeated India 2-0.

Prasidh Krishna's inclusion in the ODI squad for the first three matches will depend on fitness clearance. Rishabh Pant, who was ruled out of the first two unofficial Tests against New Zealand A due to a left side strain, is in the Test squad, but his eventual availability will depend on his recovery.

India's Test squad: Gill [C], Jaiswal, KL Rahul [VC], Padikkal, Pant [WK]*, Jurel [WK], Jadeja, Anshul Kamboj, Bumrah, Prasidh, Akash Deep, Sai Sudharsan, Nitish Reddy, Washington, Kuldeep, Siraj.

With Rabada's return, Proteas look to bounce back from Durban debacle

Prateek Srivastava
prateek.srivastava@htdigital.in

RABADA IN TESTS

	Matches	Wickets	Best	Average	Economy	Fifers
OVERALL	73	340	7/112	22.03	3.34	17
vs AUS	11	58	6/54	21.39	3.44	4

NEW DELHI: Australia thumped South Africa in the first Test at Kingsmead, Durban earlier this week, but now with Kagiso Rabada back after recovering from a hamstring problem, the equation will be a little different.

South Africa missed Rabada in the Kingsmead Test. The bowling lacked teeth in his absence.

The hosts had reduced the Aussies to 187/6 on the opening day but overnight batsman Matt Renshaw, who hadn't scored a Test century since 2016, went on to rack up 190 on the second day. The Proteas didn't recover after that and eventually lost the contest by 214 runs.

If Rabada was there, things may have perhaps turned out differently for the hosts. The fast bowler's record against the Aussies is exceptional.

Last year in the World Test Championship final at Lord's, the pacer took nine wickets (5/51 and 4/59) and helped the Proteas stun the overwhelming favourites.

In his 11 Tests against Australia, Rabada has taken 58 wickets at an average of just 21.39. By comparison, Dale Steyn, arguably the greatest South Africa pacer, has taken 70 wickets in 15 games at an average of 27.47.

Among all the Proteas bowlers who have taken 50 wickets or more, Rabada boasts the best average.

And it is quite the list. Apart from Steyn, it features Allan Donald, Makhaya Ntini, Morne Morkel, Jacques Kallis, Vernon Philander and Shaun Pollock.

The Sandpapergate series in 2018 — the last time the Aussies played a Test rubber in South Africa — saw Rabada take 23 wickets in four games at an average of 19.26, including a 10-for, to help the Proteas to a 3-1 win.

The 31-year-old's importance for the South Africa team can't be overstated. Naturally, the Aussies are worried. Assistant coach Matthew Wade, who worked with the South Africa pacer at IPL side Gujarat Titans last year, expects him to make a difference.

"The thing that stands out with him is his competitiveness. He takes it to the opposition. He'll be in our face. He'll keep coming for the whole Test match – we really know that. With him coming back in... it gives them great versatility.

"The hosts went in with the two spinners (Keshav Maharaj and Simon Harmer) last time, but they can bring the quicks in. He and Nortje can basically take one quick spot, bowl short spells, and really attack us hard if they want to," Wade told reporters ahead of the second game that starts on Sunday at Gqeberha.

"It's going to be a challenge every single Test match to be able to get on top of their attack. Thankfully, we found a way in the first Test, but we're under no illusions here that it's going to be a tough game for us," he added.

In the absence of Rabada, teaway pacer Anrich Nortje played at Kingsmead, his first Test in three years. He took four wickets (2/88 and 2/56) but lacked the penetration and consistency that Rabada has.

The other two pacers in the team were Marco Jansen and Wiian Mulder, and they didn't have a great game either but they can bat effectively which is something South Africa can't ignore. So, it's clear who is going to sit out as Rabada comes in.

The Aussies were very good in the opening Test, and if anyone can stop them in their aspirations to beat South Africa in the rainbow nation for the first time since 2014, it's Rabada.

This sets the stage up for what promises to be a mighty battle.

BCCI conducts selector's interview

MUMBAI: The interview process for the fifth selector who will replace Ajit Agarkar was completed, which may clear the decks for Pragyan Ojha to take full-time charge as chief selector. One of two former India cricketers from Mumbai, Ramesh Powar (2 Tests, 31 ODIs) and Salil Ankola (1 Test, 20 ODIs), are in contention to get the job, it was learnt.

Amruta storms into U23 Worlds final

LAS VEGAS: India's Amruta Pujari entered women's 72kg final at the U23 World Wrestling C'ships. She beat Kazakhstan's Sabyrzhanova 7-1 and then defeated China's Wenjin Qiu 10-8 in the semis. Komal won bronze in the women's 59kg with a 7-2 victory over Kazakhstan's Viktoriia Khusainova.

ISL: Bagan rally to beat SC Delhi

NEW DELHI: Mohun Bagan came from behind to beat SC Delhi 2-1 in ISL. After Lalrinliana Hnamte gave Delhi the lead, Lee Erwin and Miguel Figueira struck within four minutes of each other to earn Bagan full points.

Chola Chiefs upset Rajputana Royals

HYDERABAD: Chola Chiefs beat holders Rajputana Royals a 5-3 in the Archery Premier League on Friday. The defeat leaves Royals on eight points with just one match remaining.

BWF World Juniors: Jagsher bags bronze

CAIRO: India's Jagsher Singh Khangurra won bronze in the junior World Badminton C'ships after going down in the boys' singles semi-final against Radithya Bayu Wardhana of Indonesia. Khangurra fought hard before losing the match 6-15, 15-13, 3-15 in 49 minutes.

'No strategy', Faldo laments as raw power takes over golf

Shantanu Srivastava
sportsdesk@hindustantimes.com

NEW DELHI: Nick Faldo has just sipped some electrolytes, spent half an hour talking golf with Sachin Tendulkar and Kevin Pietersen for the official studio show of the DP World India Championship. By the time he settles down to speak on the sapping Friday evening, the 69-year-old is panting and sweating.

There are, however, a few things that get him going in an instant, such as the mention of his most famous major win — the dramatic 1996 triumph at The Masters — and the argument of brute power taking over touch play from the sport.

More of that later, because before he got talking on golf, Faldo let slip an important trivia. "I just bowled to Sachin, he hit straight back and I caught it. Gone, first ball! I got Sachin first ball," he laughed.

Tendulkar c&b Faldo might be an almighty fluke, but the golf legend is certain of one thing — "You don't need strategy on the golf course anymore."

The steady rise in driving distances has been the Englishman's pet peeve for years, and the sight of pros hitting upwards of 350 yards still hurts the golf tragic in him.

"It's a shame. You no longer need a strategy to conquer courses. I don't know how we rein in things. I'm trying my best to bring back classical ball striking skills. I suggest we try different heads, different lofts. Maybe we stop at 56 degrees, maybe we don't have anything less than 10 degrees of the driver," he said.

Nick Faldo (R) with former England cricketer Kevin Pietersen in New Delhi on Friday. DP WORLD

The six-time major winner is also a proponent of restricting tee height to one inch from the current 2¼-inch to reduce distance off the tee. A shorter tee tends to lower the ball speed and carry without re-engineering the golf ball, shifting the competitive advantage back to pure ball-striking skill, touch, and course management rather than power.

"One-inch tees would be fantastic, because you have to tee it low and you can't get there that easily. Nowadays, they tee it up this high and hit it over the moon, so, little things like that could change it. We've been talking about it for about three decades, we might as well talk about it for another decade, couple more, couple more..."

Remembering 1996

Thirty years is a long time, but if you are Faldo, it's as recent as yesterday. The delight and perspicuity with which he recounts his Augusta Masters win back in 1996—where he entered the final day six shots behind the leader Greg Norman and went on to win the competition by five shots after Norman imploded—is indicative of how dearly he cherishes it. Faldo, on sinking the final putt, embraced Norman and desisted from celebrating, a compassionate ode to a fellow heartbroken sportsperson.

"Oh, that's the famous one," he smiled. "It was all about consistency for me on that final day. I had a really good goal in my mind — they call it a gameplan now — which was to get within three shots after nine holes," Faldo recalled. "I actually did better, I got within two, and by the time we'd stood on the 12th, I realised things were getting serious for me. I was just comfortable churning it out hole after hole. My 67 was my lowest round of the weekend, in fact it was the best in the whole field. The greens were like rock, and you had to position it. It was perfect for my style of play, but more importantly, you've got to believe that I can still do it."

But before the high of '96 came the examination in the mid-80s when Faldo decided to rework his swing in the middle of the season. He calls it "crazy" and "daft" 40 years later, but back then, "it was something I needed to do."

A fairly successful player on the tour, albeit without a major win until then, Faldo worked with coach David Leadbetter to get a more compact backswing and a stable clubface, which ultimately gave him better accuracy. "You have to be brave," he said.

Two seasons down the line in 1987, his muscle memory tuned to the new biomechanics, Faldo won his first major at The Open. Five more would follow over the next nine years.

"It's been a great journey and I have loved every part of it. I want the game to go to new geographies. I want youngsters to pick up golf the way I picked it up after watching it on TV," he concluded.

{ HEADS OR TAILS }
Vivek Jain

Jaandaar, star of the Pune Derby spectacle

With the Pune Derby done and dusted, the racing season starts to wind down. On a particularly hot afternoon, the star of the show was Jaandaar, with not much on the sidelines to take the attention away from the equine.

Vijay Shirke's all-conquering colt extended his unbeaten run to five, and won all the plums of the season for horses of the classic age – FD Wadia, SA Poonawalla and the Derby. Interestingly, three years ago, another Sohna bred got abroad, Enabler, had also added the Pune Derby to his win in the SA Poonawalla. With Enabler also going on to win the Indian Derby, would history repeat itself?

The amiable late Sultan Singh, who ran Sohna, has an unbelievable strike rate in producing champions with its got abroads. The farm produced Jacqueline and Juliette, two of the greatest fillies to grace our turf, and after Enabler came Jaandaar. Pesi, who trains Jaandaar, also has the champion filly Margaretta, another Sohna bred got abroad who won the PBMM but has been rested in the monsoon. The Derby winning colt has a lightning turn of foot but could be tested over the Indian Derby mile-and-a-half by the filly.

Coming to last week's Pune racing, I must commend the conduct of Chairman of the Stewards, Ram Shroff, who had to use his casting vote to award the race to Yinisurk. It was not the decision per se, and having chaired the Stewards body in the past, it was a decision I would have made in a jiffy as severe interference was visible even to a layman. But in Ram overruling the contrarian view of three stipes and giving his colleagues the chance to opine first and vote last (something I have long advocated so as to not inhibit the others), it was impressive.

The Prix de l'Arc De Triomphe, run in Paris two Sundays ago and one of the most valuable races in the world, went to The Aga Khan family home bred, Daryz, in a canter to establish himself as one of the best thoroughbreds. Though he has since retired, his prospects as a stallion are intriguing. The son of another champion, Sea the Stars scooped the £2.5 million purse to take his career earnings past the £5 million mark.

Soon, the studs of Usha and the Poonawallas will have their private sales of yearlings. The loss of two racing clubs notwithstanding, new records with dizzying prices are on the horizon as the demand for top pedigrees appears insatiable.

Vivek Jain is former chairman of the RWITC

Pal takes 11-wicket match haul

HT Correspondent
sportm@hindustantimes.com

MUMBAI: Golu Pal claimed an 11-wicket match haul as Dyandeep Seva Mandal beat Parle Tilak English School by an innings and 95 runs on Day 2 of their second round U-16 Harris Shield match on Friday. **Brief scores: Dr Ambedkar Vidyalaya** 309 drew with **Anjuman Allana CSMT** 252/8 (Devashish Ghodke 72, Umar Khute 43; Advit Tiwari 5/96). **Anjuman Khairul Islam** 283/9d drew with **High School Sanpada** 71 (Kedar Patil 32; Aashish Tiwari 5/21) 210/6 (Advait Jadhav 56, Vedant Bomble 50, Adarshraj Singh 31; Tanishk Bhosale 4/49). **Parag English School** 67 & 168 (Shaurya Navale 62, Smit Bhadra 56; Swaraj More 5/43, Sparsh Gholap 3/14) lost to **General Education Academy** 242/2d. **Chembur Karnataka** 117 & 117 (Harshal Sonawane 41, Daiwat Kambli 6/38) lost to **Swami Vivekanand International Goral** 145 & 90/2 (Harshit Bobade 48). **Parle Tilak English School** 35 & 112 (Golu Pal 6/15) lost to **Dyandeep Seva Mandal** 240/8d. **IES VN Sule Guruji** 267 drew with **Sitaram Prakash HS Wadala** 79 (Rajveer Lad 3/10, Aaradhya Kadam 3/16) & 54/2. **Al Barkaat MMI** 116 & 65 (Nikhil Gurav 7/11) lost to **New English School Bandra** 176 (Shreyas Khilare 99*, Aditya Pandey 4/57) & 7-0. **Rizvi Springfield** 77 & 115/9 (Varsheet Kanhurkar 34; Lakshya Bhoir 3/27) drew with **Modern English School** 96 (Abdullah Khatri 6/40, Swaroop Ambre 3/27).

Three share lead on second day at DGC

N Ananthanarayanan
anantha.narayanan@htlive.com

NEW DELHI: Spain's Angel Hidalgo, Poland's Adrian Meronk and Joost Luiton of the Netherlands shared the clubhouse lead at eight-under par on a frenetic second day of the DP World India Championship at the Delhi Golf Club course.

After a five-hour rain delay on Thursday threw the schedule off course, Day 2 ended with several players yet to finish their second round. Six-time Major winner Rory McIlroy (4-under) and defending champion Tommy Fleetwood (4-under), playing together, had completed four holes when play halted.

Angel Hidalgo. PTI

The cutline is currently at par, and former Masters champion and Road to Dubai Rankings leader Patrick Reed would hope it stays that way. The American shot 3-under par 69 but will hope he ensures he does not lose momentum heading into the final three events on the DP World Tour.

His hot pursuer Eugenio Chacarra, however, resumed from where he left off on Thursday. Starting late in the afternoon like McIlroy and Fleetwood due to the schedule logjam, the Spaniard, who shot 5-under 67 overnight, was two-under after five holes. He was 7-under for the tournament and one shot off the clubhouse lead.

US PGA Championship winner Aaron Rai, who began his first round with an eagle and finished it on Friday at 3-under 69, went three-over in the second round.

Anirban Lahiri is also on 1-under (70, 73) while Om Prakash Chouhan heads the thin list of Indians who are in the reckoning to make the cut. Chouhan, who shot 68 in the first round, was par after two holes.

NISSAN
A NISSAN
FOR EVERY DRIVE
ASSURED GOLD COIN WITH EVERY PURCHASE
CELEBRATION COMES HOME IN A NISSAN
MAGNITE
TEKTON
GRAVITE
MAGNITE NOW AVAILABLE WITH CNG
MAGNITE RANGE STARTS@
₹5.69 LAKH*
BOLD INSIDE OUT SUV
BENEFITS UP TO ₹1 20 000*
TEKTON RANGE STARTS@
₹10.49 LAKH*
MAKE WAY FOR THE UNMISTAKABLE
BENEFITS UP TO ₹1 00 000*
GRAVITE NOW AVAILABLE WITH CNG
GRAVITE RANGE STARTS@
₹5.73 LAKH*
THE NEW CLASS OF TOGETHERNESS WITH 7-SEATS
BENEFITS UP TO ₹70 000*
NISSAN SERVICE PROMISE
FREE 3-YEAR~ ROADSIDE ASSISTANCE AND STANDARD WARRANTY
ASK FOR UP TO 10 YEARS~ OF PAID EXTENDED WARRANTY
ASK FOR 3-YEAR* PRE-PAID MAINTENANCE PROGRAMME
90 MINUTES* EXPRESS SERVICE
LIMITED PERIOD OFFER
BUY A NISSAN. GET ASSURED GIFTS.
(WORTH UP TO ₹1 CRORE IN TOTAL*)
VISIT YOUR NEAREST NISSAN DEALERSHIP TO AVAIL THE OFFER
AUTHORIZED NISSAN DEALERS: MAHARASHTRA: MUMBAI: GHATKOPAR: LAKSHMI NISSAN- 8291203618, MALAD (MUMBAI): LAKSHMI NISSAN- 8879047526, NERUL (NAVI MUMBAI): ETCO NISSAN- 8291091393, THANE: ETCO NISSAN- 8291091393, KOLHAPUR: BHARAT NISSAN- 9619894630, AHMEDNAGAR: AZTRAL NISSAN- 7039003043, NAGPUR: PROVINCIAL NISSAN- 8291046096, NASHIK: HIGHGEAR NISSAN- 8291091621, PUNE: BAVDHAN: PROVINCIAL NISSAN- 8291046598, SATARA ROAD: SILVER MOTORS NISSAN- 8291097681, MOLEDINA ROAD: SILVER MOTORS NISSAN- 9167021911, SATARA: SAHYADRI NISSAN- 9619954715, SANGLI: BHARAT NISSAN- 9619954224, AURANGABAD: AZTRAL NISSAN- 9619894629, GOA: PANJIM: PRAMUKH NISSAN- 9167298679.
*Terms & conditions apply: The scheme/benefits mentioned are applicable on select vehicles/variants of MY 2026 which will be invoiced on or before 31st October 2026 or till stocks last. All prices ex-showroom Delhi. The model shown are Magnite Tekna+, Tekton Tekna + & Limited-Edition Nissan Gravite. 1 gm. gold coin offer is applicable on selected variants of Nissan range demonstrated here. All customers taking test drive of Nissan cars will get an assured digital voucher to activate and win assured gift, however it will applicable only on completion of test drive. Further if customer purchases and takes the vehicle delivery within eligibility dates, he/she will be eligible for one more retail purchase voucher to scratch and win assured gift on retail. Dealership team will guide on participation and process of claiming the gift will be specified on the voucher. Scratch and win assured gift offer is not applicable in Tamil Nadu. Features may vary from variant to variant. Color, models are indicative and for depiction only and may vary due to printing constraints. Accessories shown may not be part of standard fitment. Please visit your nearest Nissan dealer for more information. Finance is on the sole discretion of NBFSI. #Standard warranty 3 year or 100,000 km whichever comes first and can be extended to 10 years 200,000 km on an additional cost. Offer applicable on Nissan Nissan Range and customer needs to provide certificate of deposit. ^Government approved CNG Kit full developed, manufactured & quality assured by a 3rd party. CNG kit warranty & any other related terms & conditions are applicable as specified by third party.
NISSAN FINANCE